

After Action Review

UNDP's Response to Tropical Cyclone Winston

June 2017



Photos: Tova Andersson / UNDP, @BakhodirUNDP and @UNDP

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List of Acronyms

ADB	Asian Development Bank
ADF	Australian Defence forces
CB	(UNDP) Crisis Board
CC/A	Climate Change/Adaptation
CCDRR	Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction
CERF	Central Emergency Response Fund
CO	Country Office (term sometimes loosely used in this report to refer to MCO/PO or both)
CPD	Country Programme Document (used by much of the UN detailing agency specific actions relating to UNDAF)
DIM/DEX	Direct Implementation /Execution Modality (not the common way of working for UNDP)
DM	Disaster Management
DoA	Delegation of Authority
DRF	Disaster Recovery Framework (Fiji, national document post-TC Winston)
DRR	Deputy Resident Representative (UNDP Function)
DRM/R	Disaster Risk Management/Reduction
ERCC	Early Recovery Cluster Coordinator
ERNA	Early Recovery Needs Assessment
ExpRes	UNDP's Expert Roster for deployment of pre-qualified consultants for crisis response and recovery
FAO	UN Food and Agriculture Organization
FEA	Fiji Electric Authority
FRANZ	France, Australia, New Zealand: 1992 agreement to ensure the best use of resources for Pacific relief operations
FRCS	Fiji Red Cross Society
FRDP	Framework for Resilient Development in the Pacific
GEF	Global Environmental Facility
GF-ATM	Global Fund (for Aids, Tuberculosis and Malaria)
HC	Humanitarian Coordinator (UN)
HQ	Unless otherwise stated, refers to UNDP Head Quarters in New York City.
IASC	Inter-Agency Standing Committee (UN, NGOs and other humanitarian partners)
ICRC	International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies
IHRDP	Integrated Human Resource Development Programme – with the Fijian Ministry of Trade
IRMU	Integrated Results Management Unit (UNDP PO Team)
IFI	International Financial Institution (eg. the World Bank, ADB)
IG	Inclusive Growth (UNDP PO Team)
ILO	(UN) International Labour Organization
MCO	(UNDP) Multi-Country Office – merged into PO by April 2016.
MIC	Middle-Income Country (Fiji's GDP is US\$ 4,500 per capita)
MSB	Swedish Civil Contingencies Agency (<i>Myndigheten för samhällsskydd och beredskap</i>)
M4C	Markets for Change – UN Women project with a minor component with UNDP (Fiji, Sol, Vanuatu)
NDMO	National Disaster Management Office

NGO	Non-Governmental Organization
NIM/NEX	National Implementation /Execution Modality (the common way of working for UNDP)
OCHA	(UN) Office for Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
PDNA	Post-Disaster Needs Assessment
PC	(UNDP) Pacific Centre (until end March 2016, then merged into new PO)
PFIP	Pacific Financial Inclusion Programme (Joint UNCDF/UNDP – to 2018)
PHT	Pacific Humanitarian Team (UN and others)
PICs	Pacific Island countries
PICTs	Pacific Island countries and territories
PO	(UNDP) Pacific Office in Fiji – combining previous MCO and PC from April 2016
PRRP	Pacific Risk Resilience Programme (UNDP)
RBAP	UNDP Regional Bureau for Asia and the Pacific
RC	Resident Coordinator (UN)
RESPAC	UNDP new three-year project: Regional Disaster Resilience in the Pacific Small Island Developing States
RH	UNDP Regional Hub in Bangkok
RNZAF	Royal New Zealand Air Force (RNZAF)
RR	(UNDP) Resident Representative
RSD	Resilience and Sustainable Development (UNDP PO Team)
SCEFI	UNDP project for Strengthening Citizens Engagement in Fiji
SBP	Stand-by partners (to support UNDP)
SPC	Pacific Community (Regional organization)
SPO	Strategic Planning Office (SPO) within the Fijian Ministry of Economy
SRC	Senior Recovery Coordinator (UNDP)
TC / STC	Tropical Cyclone / Severe Tropical Cyclone
UNCDF	UN Capital Development Fund
UNCT	UN Country Team (UNCT)
UNICEF	United Nations Children’s Fund
WASH	Water, Sanitation and Hygiene
WFP	(UN) World Food Programme
WHO	(UN) World Health Organization

Executive Summary

This After-Action Review (AAR) was conducted immediately following UNDP's response to Tropical Cyclone (TC) Winston in Fiji from February to December 2016. The exercise was principally intended to contribute to improving UNDP's performance in leveraging its development presence for a substantial, relevant contribution to inter-agency, post-crisis humanitarian response and recovery efforts. It is envisaged that the analysis and recommendations will help inform UNDP's corporate crisis response and recovery policy and guidance, and, moreover, assist the UNDP Pacific Office (PO) in Fiji in continuing to improve its capability in Fiji and the region.

As an innovative approach, the review was conducted in conjunction with UNDP's crisis response and preparedness training for the Pacific held in Suva from 16-20 January 2017. The review itself was also largely conducted on the ground in Suva. Most consultations were face to face, and benefitted from a cross section of direct government, UN, NGO, IFI and development partner (donor) input. As it was critical to the assessment of UNDP's performance, considerable time was taken to explore the larger question of nationally-led recovery.

The AAR specifically adds to findings from other reviews,¹ informing the revision of the UNDP's *Corporate Standard Operating Procedure for Immediate Crisis Response* (SOP) and the development of UNDP's Crisis Response Packages (CRPs). To aid easy reference, the review's conceptual framework and report format adhere to the SOP's four bands of activity: programme, operations, advocacy and HQ support.

TC Winston was the most powerful cyclone in the recorded history of Fiji. At Category five (5), with wind speeds well over 300 km/hr, Winston cut a devastating path through the centre of the Fijian Islands. Much of the impact was in remoter, poorer parts of Fiji with dispersed settlements and coastal villages. Few homes there were substantially constructed, and up to 40,000 were damaged or destroyed, along with nearly 500 schools and 88 health centres. 55,000 people were displaced and 44 killed. The destruction of crops compromised the livelihoods of nearly 60% of Fiji's population. Few mention the social and psychological impacts.

Immediately declaring a 'State of Natural Disaster', the Fijian Government drew upon internal resources and began to coordinate relief efforts.² Australian and New Zealand defence forces rapidly arrived – helping assess damage and delivering initial humanitarian supplies. Although the Inter-Agency Standing Committee (IASC) did not formally declare TC Winston as an emergency of any level, many UN agencies

¹ Three recent UNDP AARs on crisis response were reviewed as background reading: Tropical Cyclone Pam in Vanuatu in March 2015; Floods in Bosnia and Herzegovina (BiH) in May 2014; and Typhoon Haiyan in the Philippines in November 2013.

² Formal declaration provided for in Fiji's Natural Disaster Management Act (1998), empowering the NDMO and clarifying roles and responsibilities throughout Government.

treated it as a level II crisis and activated specific internal crisis-response mechanisms.³ The UN and Pacific Humanitarian Team (PHT) stepped up capacity to support Government's response with a coordinated cluster approach. UNDP promptly joined the humanitarian effort.

At the time UNDP in Fiji was in a period of transition. Two UNDP 'business units', a Multi-County Office (MCO) covering 10 Pacific Island Countries, and the Pacific Centre (PC), providing technical support to a range of regional programmes, were merging to become the UNDP Pacific Office (PO) in Fiji. Roles and responsibilities of many UNDP staff were changing – even as a significant portfolio of ongoing development programmes was actively being pursued.

Nevertheless, UNDP quickly set to engaging and defining its role in the crisis response. Staff were delegated to attend relief coordination and sectoral meetings chaired by Government focal points. UNDP requested support from HQ and the Regional Hub in Bangkok. Additional human resources were deployed and seed-funding allocated. Funds from existing projects were reprogrammed against new demands. UNDP was requested by Government to focus on Fiji's Ra Province and Koro Island - high-profile sites of devastation and top national priorities for response.

UNDP's crisis response included numerous 'early-recovery' activities: Disaster Waste Management (DWM), livelihoods and food security support, and the rebuilding of community infrastructure. Drawing upon lessons from TC Pam, where no CERF funds were accessed, UNDP joined forces with FAO and WFP under the priority *Food Security Cluster* and successfully presented debris clearance as an early recovery action necessary for farmers to return to their land. US\$ 124,000 of CERF was raised.

UNDP also provided full-time support to the national Post-Disaster Needs Assessment (PDNA) process along with the World Bank, Asian Development Bank (ADB) and partners. The PDNA was completed in a timely and comprehensive manner, estimating US\$ 905 million of total damage and losses – one fifth of Fiji's GDP.⁴ Completion of the PDNA allowed substantial IFI resources to flow to Government for recovery, and a national Disaster Recovery Framework (DRF) was initiated.

a) Successes of the response and enabling factors

A flexible programmatic approach ensured UNDP's relevance. Reprogramming resources from ongoing projects, UNDP quickly commenced a range of 'early recovery' activities. Formulating a crisis response project document, with regular monitoring and reporting, brought coherence to the overall effort. UNDP's actions helped others access the field and perform in a range of sectors.

³ Some point to a weakness in the IASC's assessment criteria of absolute numbers affected – rather than percentages of a population. Considering percentages would have clearly placed TC Winston's impact on Fiji as a major emergency in need of substantial support.

⁴ Fiji PDNA, May 2016. "The combined value of destroyed assets and disruptions in the production of goods and services is about one fifth of the country's 2014 gross domestic product (GDP).

Corporate Crisis Response Packages (CRPs) were adapted to the local context and UNDP extended comprehensive support to ensure results. To some extent, links were made to previous UNDP projects.

UNDP demonstrated added value beyond being a first-phase responder, supporting national partners, including CSOs. Government assigned UNDP to two of Fiji's most impacted provinces and was generally satisfied with UNDP's response. UNDP's crisis field work on Koro Island positively influenced longer-term funding by being showcased for future donors.

Operationally, staff were motivated, committed and actively learning. As an enabling factor, contrasting with field capacities deployed for TC Pam (Vanuatu/Tuvalu 2015), UNDP had a strong team based at its office in Fiji when the crisis hit – allowing a much quicker start-up. Many staff had recent experience with TC Pam, and were cognisant of lessons and the need to improve. Although UNDP offices were in transition, in some respects the challenges served to build teams. The small first response / Surge team was easily assimilated into the Fiji MCO, which maintained a clear lead, thus tensions experienced in other operations were not significant in this case.

Although ultimately little external funding was received, a sense of urgency for resource mobilization was demonstrated early on, with strategic thinking which secured CERF funding. UNDP succeeded in producing some personal stories and got messages into local media by 'taking reporters to the field'. Good use was also made of social media.

Government relationships were maintained and the good offices of UNDP (RR/RC) and the combined HC role helped moderate relationships overall with the international humanitarian community.

HQ and Regional Hub support worked well. Significant seed-funding was provided by HQ/BPPS in a timely manner and the comprehensive support of the Crisis Board (CB) was key. A rapid deployment of First responders, including core UNDP staff, ensured much of the immediate response's success. SBPs made essential technical and field management contributions. The addition of a UNDP Security Officer was helpful, especially considering Civil–Military coordination needs.

b) Challenges and Gaps

At the onset of the crisis UNDP was not well prepared. Staff were not aware of corporate crisis support mechanisms, tools and potential resources. Most ongoing projects lacked flexibility for substantial reprogramming. 'Early recovery' (ER) was not a team strength, nor was it known as a substantive, ongoing sector by Government. With many approaches that would typically align well with municipalities, there was no obvious alignment of ER in central government.

Crisis response actions were not well integrated into UNDP's country programme. Ongoing project commitments seldom geographically or substantively matched affected areas. With little direct field

activity, early recovery actions were started anew, and depended on imported technical staff – largely from SBPs. The opportunity to learn from SBPs, and build ongoing UNDP team capacities, was not taken.⁵

Some operational bottlenecks were experienced – largely due to rapid procurement. The crisis took place in times of structural change. More operational support could have been lent to field teams - and would have helped integrate the response into UNDP in Fiji overall.

UNDP was not able to articulate ‘Early Recovery’ or a clear ‘UNDP offer’ in terms of value in relief and recovery. ‘Early Recovery’ was not positioned high in the flash appeal. Most UNDP messaging did not reflect the magnitude of the crisis and good initial efforts on resource mobilization for crisis response and recovery were not sustained. Although some success with the CERF was achieved, a more holistic view of resource mobilization for crisis response and recovery was needed.

The scale and pace of response was modest compared to the tremendous needs. Raising just over US\$ 1.0 million (80% of which was funded internally), and with few project staff, UNDP’s response took time to progressively reach the 33 villages assigned in Ra and Koro. Essentially, at any time there were only two substantive UNDP experts in the field (from MSB), which limited the pace of response. Largely due to inflexibility in existing projects, reprogrammed funds represented only 2 % of annual PO Fiji delivery.

The needs-based nature of the response was not evident. With a lack of data to UN partners, UNDP and others largely based responses on Government requests. This issues persists today.

Government and development partners were not aware of the roles and capacity of the UN system.

UNDP, and other multi-laterals, were unable to engage in national recovery. Following initial commitment to the PDNA, UNDP and others were unable to sustain sufficient rapport within Government to ensure a valued role in ongoing post-crisis recovery. Government focal points changed and bi-lateral preferences meant few resources were available. Although substantial Government recovery is being pursued today, the status of physical, economic and social recovery is unknown.

Corporate UNDP policy and guidance for engagement in recovery was lacking. Expectations of what investments in PDNAs should yield were not clear, and further strategic support would have been required for UNDP to develop a definitive offer of value in nationally-led recovery. Yet, even then, no clear role for UNDP may have eventuated.

A development-sensitive humanitarian response, that serves also to promote national and local capacity, is very different from a standard humanitarian response. One that is based upon existing long-term presence and relationships – and that maintains these relationships in good order throughout the crisis

⁵ Some have pointed to the impracticality of also taking time out for learning from MSB/Stand-by partners whilst amid an office transition with the additional challenges of getting used to new systems.

response - is additionally complex. By including senior Government officials and others in this review, some light is shed on how UNDP managed these complexities in its response to TC Winston.

As an overall assessment, when considered in the larger context, UNDP's response was successful.

- Good use was made of corporate crisis response mechanisms.
- Although modest vis-à-vis overall needs, resources available to UNDP were not insignificant, ensuring relevance and some impact, at the same time not overburdening ongoing operations.
- UNDP focussed on what it could do and did not overextend. UNDP managed to smoothly return to its core business in Fiji and the Pacific – an important role that it fits well.
- The UNDP PO in Fiji emerges from this experience committed to engage in future humanitarian responses, and to continue to improve – including with active preparedness.

From a reputational risk point of view, considering rising public concerns about the state of Fiji's recovery, UNDP perhaps did the best it could. Engaging as it did in the inter-agency crisis response, and taking on work in high-profile, heavily impacted areas, UNDP quickly became a visible, appreciated humanitarian actor and partner to communities and Government. Without a solid donor commitment to underwrite some engagement in recovery, UNDP wouldn't have been able to deliver upon expectations, even if the door had been open to participate. Commitment to longer-term recovery is not something easy to withdraw from, and not being associated with it today allows UNDP to focus on its core risk-resilience agenda in Fiji and the Pacific – work that is important and related to the resilience of people in crises in any case.

Bearing in mind UNDP's work in the Pacific since floods in the Solomon Islands in 2014, and TC Pam in 2015, an evolution of progress is evident in the way that UNDP participates in crisis response. TC Winston was a case where UNDP clearly couldn't afford to remain disengaged. Even if the metrics of success appear modest from afar, the benefits of such an engagement with the Fijian people and authorities may well pay immeasurable dividends over time.

c) Forward-looking recommendations

Recommendations for the Pacific Office in Fiji

Although this AAR studied UNDP's response to TC Winston in Fiji, considering that the PO in Fiji has a multi-county remit, recommendations apply to the Pacific in general. With the likelihood of another such crisis in Fiji or the region being high, there are some immediate actions needed at country level:

- **Complete simplified but functional guidelines for crisis response and recovery:** guidelines that reflect corporate SOPs but also reflecting local realities. This can be tailored for each country as needed.
- **Complete a UNDP crisis preparedness plan–** including coordinating with the four (4) preparedness exercises the PHT is pursuing.

- **Ensure regular updating and refreshing of staff around SOPs and preparedness plans.** It is envisaged that this could be a light process once plans and systems are established.
- **Ensure all ongoing or future donor negotiations explore the possibility of creating greater flexibility for programmatic realignment in times of crisis response and recovery.** Programmes such as risk-resilience, climate change adaptation, environment, governance, and economic empowerment, all with strong gender elements, should have some capacity to contribute to crisis response. Comprehensive donor mapping should also be pursued in earnest on a continual basis.
- **Progressively review stocks of relevant supplies in countries and secure agreements with key suppliers** – and ensure focal points for awareness of UNDP's (and larger UN's) global stockpiles.
- **Consider, with some HQ support, gathering data on the benefits of risk-resilience work in terms of leading to less inputs for crisis-response overall** in conjunction with academic institutions in the Pacific. This would make an important contribution to UNDP's work in the risk-resilience, preparedness, response, recovery, development continuum.
- **Engage with Governments and development partners in the Pacific and Fiji on mutual understanding.** Opportunities in this regard could relate to upcoming UNDAF planning and discussions around the Framework for Resilient Development in the Pacific (FRDP).

Recommendations for UNDP corporately

- **Complete UNDP's corporate SOP for immediate crisis response, achieve full endorsement, and make available via the intranet** – situating crisis-response and recovery within a framework of UNDP's ongoing in-country development presence and overall, long-term objectives.
- **Study and provide clear policy and guidance on UNDP's engagement in recovery.** This needs to include an analysis and justification for continued participation in the PDNA process.
- **Consider approaching response and recovery more from the recovery side, bolstering UNDP's alliance with IFIs⁶** – as commenced with World Bank, PDNA partnerships. This potentially could be a better fit for UNDP than competing for humanitarian funds, yet would also need to lever UNDP's role in the established Early Recovery cluster system.
- **Provide guidance for UNDP's in-country and external messaging in crisis and recovery situations.** Guidance needs to include senior level strategic messaging – portraying the scale of crisis impacts and human needs.
- **Continue the model of crisis response training combined with active preparedness planning** as demonstrated by UNDP's CRU/BPPS team in Suva on 16-20 January 2017.

⁶ Private sector partnerships could also be furthered, yet some of the global agreements and relationships with the regional development banks and the World Bank already have a secure footing for moving ahead with.

1. Introduction

1.1 Overview

Throughout much of 2016, UNDP supported the Government of Fiji's response to the destructive effects of Category 5 Severe Tropical Cyclone (TC) Winston which impacted Fiji on 20-21 February 2016.

TC Winston had been declared as the strongest cyclone in the Southern Hemisphere and the second strongest to Super Typhoon Haiyan to ever make landfall anywhere on Earth in recorded history⁷. Wind gusts reached 325 km/h and sustained wind speeds of up to 285 km/h were recorded⁸. TC Winston killed 44 people and left a wide trail of destruction – much of it in the more remote, poorer parts of Fiji, where many lived in dispersed settlements⁹ and coastal villages.

The combined value of destroyed assets and disruptions was estimated in the PDNA at US\$ 905 million (one fifth of the national GDP), including US\$ 887 million in damage and losses to Fiji's productive, social and infrastructure sectors. Up to 40,000¹⁰ houses were damaged or destroyed, along with 498 schools and 88 health centres.¹¹ 55,000 people were displaced and 44 killed. If environmental impacts are considered effects mount to USD 1.36 billion.¹² The destruction of crops compromised the livelihoods of nearly 60% of Fiji's population.¹³

The Government of Fiji immediately declared a 'State of National Disaster' and began to implement and coordinate relief efforts. Due to the remoteness of many of the islands, assessing the situation was difficult. Defence forces of Australia and New Zealand quickly came to support and helped determine levels of damage and deliver initial humanitarian supplies. The Pacific Humanitarian Team (PHT) stepped up capacity to support Government's response with a coordinated cluster approach.

Although not a humanitarian agency, UNDP willingly and capably joined the interagency efforts. Backed by UNDP HQ's commitment to 'crisis response', as a fitting and necessary complement to securing the

⁷ http://wacop.gsd.spc.int/TC_Winston_inundation.html

⁸ TC Winston produced 1-minute sustained wind speeds of 285 km/h... compared to 270 km/hr for TC PAM. If 10-minute sustained wind speeds are used, then TC PAM (also Category 5) was slightly stronger with 250 km/h speeds recorded versus 230 km/h for TC Winston. http://wacop.gsd.spc.int/TC_Winston_inundation.html

⁹ 'Squatter Settlement' is a term often used in Fiji to refer to a semi-formal 'village' – but implies it is not a village in the traditional sense. Settlements are largely populated by Fijians of Indian-decent and/or iTaukei, Rotumans or other Fijians that have moved away from their traditional lands. Settlements are usually on land leased in varying degrees of formality and security – which has an implication on the degree a 'resident' will invest in improving land or buildings. Seven (7) percent (60,000) of Fiji's total population, and nearly 15 percent of the urban population, live in over 200 squatter settlements.

<https://www.sheltercluster.org/sites/default/files/docs/Fiji%20National%20Housing%20Policy.pdf>

¹⁰ Initially estimated at just over 30,000, the number was upgraded by the NDMO to 40,000 upon subsequent assessment.

¹¹ Government of Fiji, Ministry of Economy. Disaster Recovery Framework (DRF), Oct. 2016. p.2

¹² If the value of destroyed environmental assets and losses in environmental services are included in PDNA figures, total effects of the disaster mount to FJD 2.85 billion or USD 1.36 billion –one third of Fiji's annual GDP of USD 4.5 billion (2014 / 2015 figures). See PDNA p.11

¹³ Government of Fiji, PDNA May 2016 p.10,

foundations for sustainable development, the UNDP office in Fiji quickly moved to identify funds and human resources and focus all efforts on the crisis.

With the winding up of UNDP's response in December 2016, UNDP commissioned this After Action Review (AAR) to examine UNDP's performance during the crisis and in the initial recovery phase "...in order to obtain a comprehensive assessment of UNDP's response to TC Winston, gather facts and perceptions related to UNDP's response and further inform the continuous enhancements of UNDP's crisis response systems, tools and processes."¹⁴

The review is not an evaluation of results or an audit, and largely draws upon the impressions of stakeholders involved. Essentially, this has involved the identification of what elements of UNDP's response worked well, and what areas proved to be gaps and warrant improvement. Forward looking recommendations are drawn to inform UNDP's policy and guidance for practice, and for the UNDP Pacific Office in Fiji itself.

1.2 Report Format

The structure of this report differs slightly from some previous AARs as is largely influenced by categories of action as presented in draft UNDP's *Corporate Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for Immediate Crisis Response*. It is arranged in seven (7) sections, followed by several substantial annexes.

Preceded by an Executive Summary and list of acronyms, this introductory section gives a brief overview of the crisis situation and the AAR report itself. It also presents the format of the report and the exercises objectives and outputs. Section two (2), presents the conceptual framework within which the AAR took place. This is an important section that offers an overview of the way UNDP's in-country crisis response should ideally proceed, with a clear reference to UNDP's crisis response SOP and the associated definition of roles, expectations and timelines. A brief discussion on 'measures of success' is included in this section.

The third section (3) presents the methodology for this review – and includes the complexity and advantage of incorporating the exercise in Fiji with a week-long crisis response training and preparedness exercise. Scope and limitations of the exercise are also noted.

Sections four (4) and five (5) are the key substantive components of the report and presents the overall analysis of UNDP's response along with main findings as related to the conceptual framework's four bands of activity: programme, operations, advocacy and HQ support. Each sub-section is divided into 'what worked well?' and 'what could have worked better?' headings. These sections are then followed by a further discussion on 'Recovery and Funding Realities' (section six (6)) which intends to aid the

¹⁴ See Terms of Reference (TOR) extract, Annex B.

reader in a deeper understanding of the context. This section was developed from findings in discussion with senior UN actors, Government, IFIs and donors during the review. Presented are points essential for consideration before relevant conclusions and recommendations can be drawn.

Conclusions and recommendations are presented in section seven (7).

The report is also accompanied by a *two-page brief* for easy reference and comparison with other AARs.

1.3 Objectives and Outputs

The core objective of the review is to take stock of lessons directly from those involved in the response – accounting for successes and making recommendations for improvements where they can be made. All of the review is framed within UNDP’s corporate commitment to participating in humanitarian and emergency responses both as a function of its coordination mandate and capacity, and also with a formal IASC role to promote recovery interventions as soon as possible (early) in the humanitarian response.

Core outputs:

- An inception report (previously submitted and accepted on 10 January 2017).
- A formal AAR report – an internal UNDP document (This report).
- A summary two-pager AAR report.
- A forward-looking Action Plan for implementing recommendations from the report¹⁵.
- Briefings to UNDP management; at country, regional and HQ (NY) levels.
- A presentation of initial findings on 18 January 2017, in UNDP crisis response training.

¹⁵ At the time of the completion of this report, and related to outputs from the January 2017 training, many recommendations were already being taken on board in alignment with the PO’s work on preparedness plans. A proposed local Fiji/Pacific level Crisis Response ‘Protocol’ captures all the necessary actions recommended in this report and has been progressed on with the PO in March 2017.

2. Conceptual Framework

2.1 Concepts Defined

In relation to UNDP’s corporate commitment to provide support to UNDP Country Offices (COs) to effectively participate in government-led, inter-agency responses to crises, UNDP’s Crisis Response Standard Operating Procedures¹⁶ (SOP) largely determined the conceptual framework for this review.

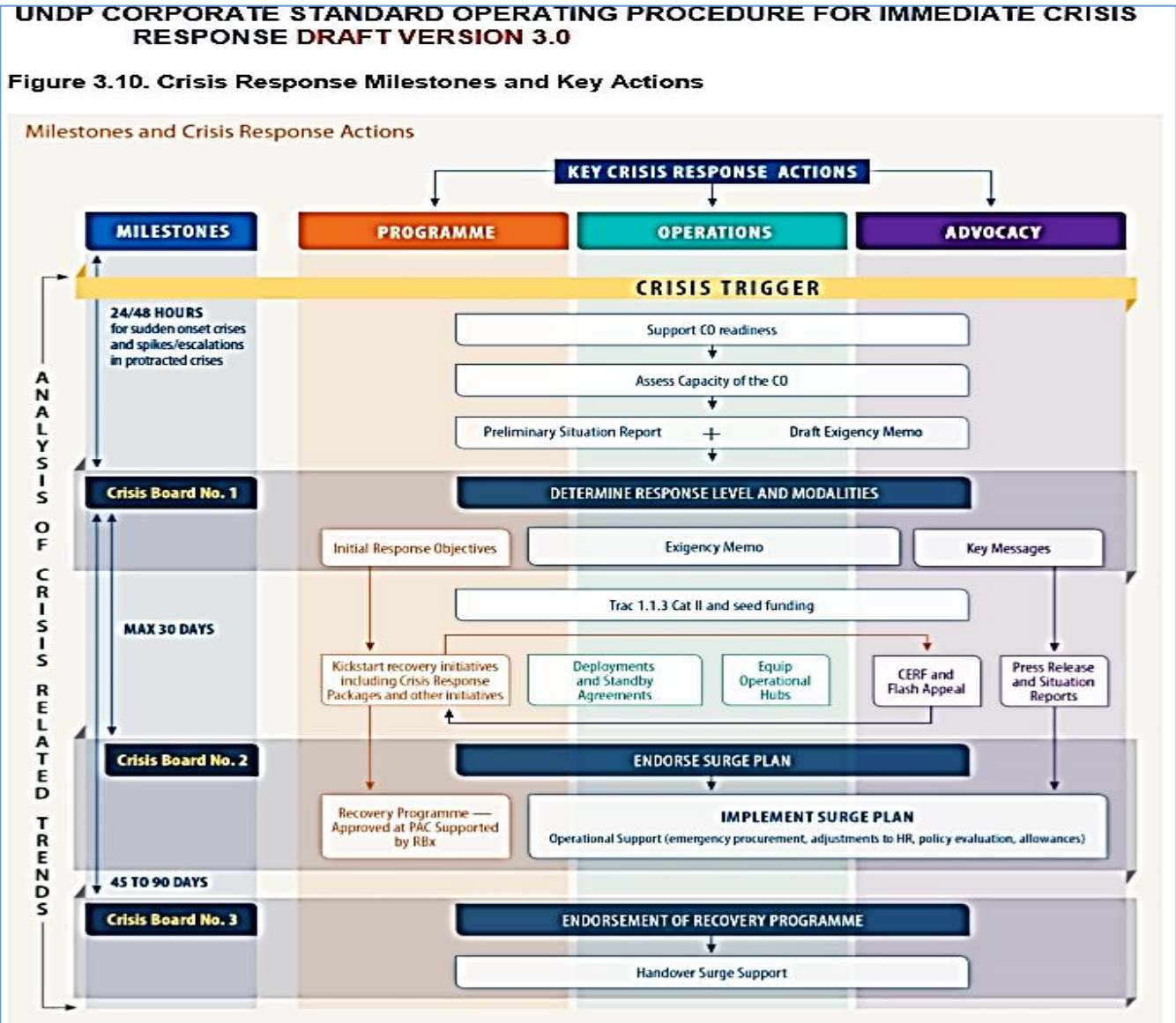


Fig. 1. Reproduction of Fig. 3.10 from UNDP Crisis Response SOP. Version 3.0 April 2016.

¹⁶ Corporate Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response UNDP Draft Version 3.0 of 14 April 2016 are referred to.

As reflected in SOP figure 3.10, (Fig. 1 above) clearly laid out are three main response action streams: Programme; Operations; and Advocacy (including communications and partner relations/resource mobilization) – all underwritten by support from HQ and the Regional Hub, with organizational unity ensured through the Crisis Board (CB). Expectations articulated in *SOP Table 5.1- UNDP Response Milestones and Humanitarian Programme Cycle (HPC) Timeline* (not reproduced in this report) along with terms of reference (TOR) for response coordination and overall management are also relevant.

Similarly, as articulated on page four (4) of the SOP, UNDP's five (5) identified goals in crisis response, designed to help define the objectives of UNDP's response to each crisis, were reiterated as areas of enquiry for the AAR. The response goals themselves have been developed to help ensure sustained focus on UNDP's dual mandate to lead and/or support coordination functions in the UN System and at the same time implement recovery programming (the dual role as mentioned earlier in this report), and to facilitate the review process.

Response goal	Areas of enquiry for this AAR
1. Provide Effective Coordination and Leadership.	To what extent did UNDP ensure effective leadership in coordination and in recovery programming through CO support, to the UN system, humanitarian clusters, government and partners?
2. Participate in Needs Assessments.	How did UNDP achieve full engagement in needs assessments at different stages of the response, including inter-agency humanitarian assessments (MIRA) and multi-sectoral and thematic assessments (ERNA, PDNA, and Gender Assessment), providing high-quality technical input for UNDP's core areas of expertise including gender and the environment?
3. Implement Timely, Sequenced and Appropriate UNDP Response and Recovery Activities.	To what extent did UNDP implement time-critical recovery programmes, applying development principles to crisis response actions as early as possible and accelerate both recovery to sustainable development pathways?
4. Ensure Safe and Sustainable Response Actions.	How did UNDP ensure proactive and current assessments of risk and programme criticality along with business continuity planning throughout the crisis?
5. Develop Suitable Resource Mobilization Plans and Financial Instruments.	What was UNDP's approach to advocacy for recovery with resource mobilisation and communication action plans / crisis advocacy messaging – and what were the results?

Table 2. UNDP crisis response goals and translated areas of enquiry. Source, UNDP Draft SOP for Crisis Response. April 2016.

Figure 2 (below) combines concepts in the SOPs, relating to both Fig. 1 and Tab. 2 above, articulating the framework within which this review took place. Recognising that crises are cyclic events in the Pacific¹⁷, it situates crisis response and recovery within a longer-term development presence, and postulates that UNDP's ultimate relevance (and success) is related to the degree that:

- UNDP crisis response actions are formulated and pursued (in a timely matter, with UNDP HQ/RH support when necessary) and soundly founded upon:

¹⁷ Cyclic: repetitive, rather than one-off unusual events. The MCO/PO was involved in Solomon Island floods in 2014 and TC Pam in 2015.

- UNDP's presence in country, knowledge of community development needs
- Established relationships with national and local authorities
- Real programmatic delivery experience and prowess
- Arrangements with suppliers, vendors, and providers of logistics
- UNDP builds upon crisis response actions to proactively pursue a programme of recovery, which is similarly founded upon in-country experience and capacity, supportive of national priorities.
- The crisis and recovery actions are designed, undertaken and deliberate phased (in a post-disaster context typically over a couple of years) back into regular development programming.
- Lessons learnt during crisis response and recovery work help build relevance in ongoing UNDP programming in country – including in design to facilitate future preparedness.
- Ongoing development programming, to the extent possible, continues during this crisis response and recovery period (and is aided by the above rather than being hampered).

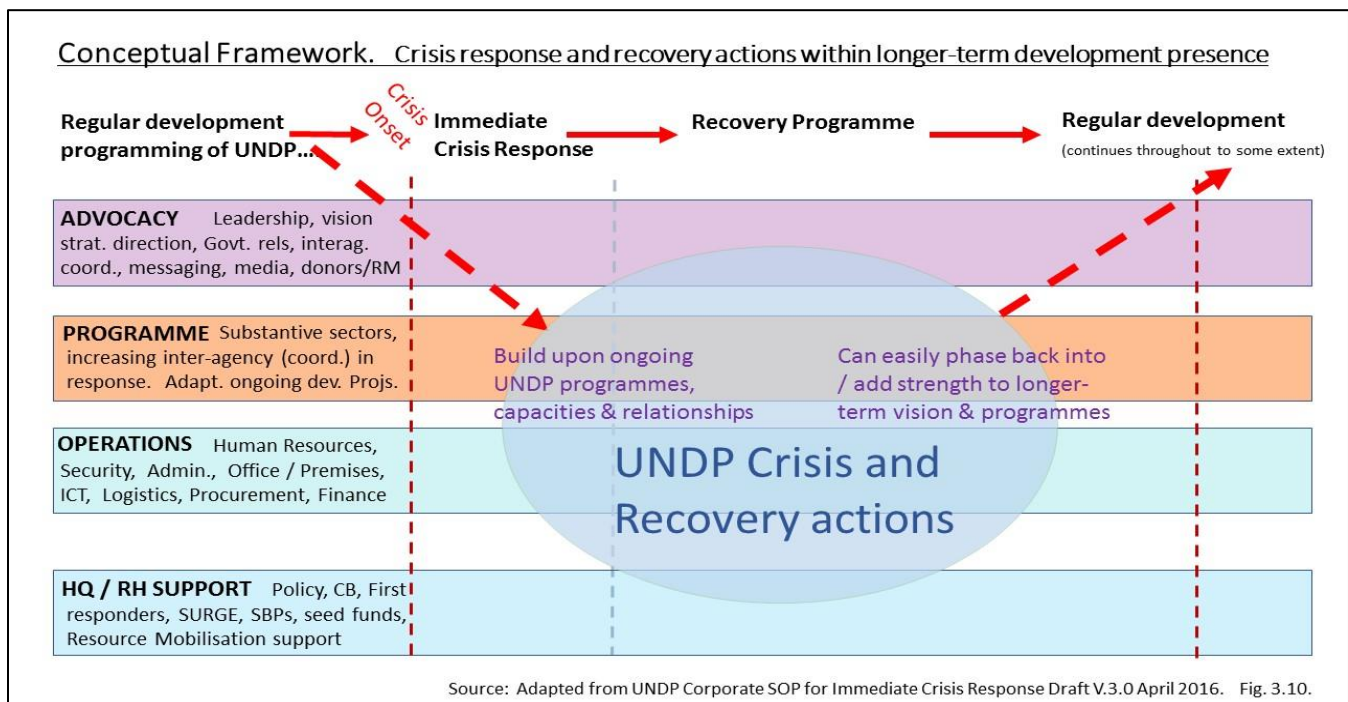


Fig. 2. Conceptual Framework employed for this AAR. Crisis response and recovery relevance within overall development presence.

Also important to note is **terminology around recovery and 'early recovery'** as interpreted for this review. As demonstrated in Fig. 2 above, (IMMEDIATE) CRISIS RESPONSE is a particular post-crisis, humanitarian phase as distinct from post-crisis RECOVERY – although there may be overlaps. Each phase has its own mechanisms of support, such as the Flash Appeal for humanitarian action, and the PDNA, National Disaster Recovery Framework (DRF) and possible pledging for recovery. Recovery phases typically take some time to commence. 'Early Recovery' actions occur within the crisis-response /

humanitarian period,¹⁸ and employ a capacity-building approach intended to accelerate ‘recovery’. ‘Early Recovery’ is the name of one of the global humanitarian clusters (that UNDP leads) yet ‘early recovery’ actions are applicable throughout any sector or humanitarian cluster.

2.2 Defining Success

Did UNDP perform well in its crisis response to TC Winston in Fiji? Defining such success involves a large degree of subjectivity. Some measures can be quantified, such as in the timeliness of actions and degree of adherence to standardized procedures, and levels of funds raised – which must be considered against the overall scale of needs.

A key measure of success, and especially relevant at UNDP HQ level from where seed-funding is provided, is the ‘return on investment’ from initial financial resources made available. Some postulate that seed-funding should form about 10 percent (10%) of UNDP’s eventual response – with the UNDP country office engaging in substantial localised resource mobilization.

Interestingly, during the one week of *Crisis Preparedness and Response Training in the Pacific*, held in Suva from 16-20 January 2017, UNDP participants prioritized measures of success for crisis response and recovery (in order of priority – with highest first) as:¹⁹

- Degree to which UNDP’s work impacts and changes people’s lives
- Level of outreach (geographic coverage)
- Coordination mechanisms being in place and functional
- National capacity and systems strengthened
- A recovery programme commences – smooth transition from crisis
- Speedy crisis response and recovery actions
- Positive evaluations, audits, AAR
- Financial targets - delivery achieved
- Resources raised

Not being an evaluation, this review cannot ascertain the impact of UNDP’s crisis response and recovery work. However, an assessment of perceptions of UNDP’s actions can be gauged in terms of timeliness and scale of response actions, and general appropriateness of the contribution to the government-led, interagency response. Although ranked the lowest by participants, resources raised outside UNDP’s internal funding is an important indicator (and objective) to secure the foundation for the ‘relevance’ of UNDP’s response overall. Yet, as discussed later in this report and largely reflected upon in the

¹⁸ Some AAR’s have not recognized this, defining ‘Early Recovery’ as a phase in itself. Yet ER is a formal humanitarian cluster, group of activities and approach, as it is an immediate crisis-response / humanitarian intervention.

¹⁹ 19 Jan. 2017. Following a plenary session participants ‘voted’ their priorities by placing stickers next to the statements. The percentage score shows the relative weight of the dots placed.

concluding comments, some balance within the overall context needs to be achieved. In this regard other indicators of success include UNDP's ability to positively negotiate space for humanitarian agencies, maintaining relationships with key government partners, support to the fund-raising of Government, and remaining focussed on long-term development and risk-reduction priorities (and being successful in maintaining credibility and raising resources for such longer-term endeavours).

3. Methodology

3.1 *Research Methods*

A practical 'After Action Review' exercise requires advanced planning, a facilitator who is ideally not a member of the response team, and a report and debriefing process that captures the lessons learned.

The concept of 'facilitation' has been key to this review – as internalized learning and increased UNDP capacity to respond to future crises in Fiji and the region are aimed for. Thus, the review has been founded in reflection from those that acted in the UNDP response to TC Winston with feedback from immediate partners in government, donors and the UN humanitarian team.

Much of the collection and compilation of data for this review relied on one-on-one interviews (face to face) and focus group discussions. Although much of the information collected was anecdotal, and based on the impressions of respondents (thus qualitative), adherence to timelines and level of resources raised provide some quantitative data.

Area	Key sources / Approaches	Location. Time-frame (status)
Pre-prep.	Meetings. UNDP Fiji management. Identification of Fiji and NY focal points.	Informal. In Fiji. Late Dec. 2016 (Done)
Substantial preparation	TOR. Identification of key responders Translation of TOR objectives to discussion points. Summary of exercise objectives. Email to individuals identified and request for interviews / discussion from 9-13 Jan. 2017	Late December 2016. 03-08 Jan. 2017. Outside Fiji. (Many individual interviews confirmed).
Desk review	UNDP SOP, Previous AAR, humanitarian / early recovery documentation	Up to Inception report 10 Jan – continuing to 24 Jan.
Submission of Inception Report	As above	9 (Draft) and 10 Jan.
In-country and remote consultations	See draft list as Annex A to this report. Follow up to commitments to interview. Suva face to face and others remote (skype / phone)	09 Jan. – 15 Feb. 2017 ²⁰ .
UNDP Crisis Response Training	Participation, probing of questions relevant to AAR. Report back on initial findings later in training session.	16-20 Jan. 2017. Suva
Submission of DRAFT FINAL REPORT and 2-page summary for comments	Circulation via CRU and allow 10 working days for comments (CRU consolidating comments)	22 Feb. 2017

²⁰ Interviews and consultations continued up to Tuesday 7 February 2017 in Suva as some important informants were not available before due to pressing obligations and/or returning from leave.

Debriefing to CO, Regional Team and HQ.		Early March 2017 depending on availability of participants.
Receipt of comments and submission of final report		End March 2017

Table 3. UNDP Fiji response to TC Winston - AAR workplan and research methods

3.2 Scope and Limitations

This AAR is limited in scope to a review of the actions of UNDP in its response to TC Winston. The review strived to understand what worked well, and areas people considered in need of improvement, in terms of UNDP's programmatic, operational, advocacy and HQ-support functions (as detailed in the next section). The performance of UNDP was examined in terms of 'what it did' and 'how it acted' – and not as a review of the results achieved. In this regard, it must be emphasized that the review is not an evaluation of results, or an audit.

The review was limited by a short time frame of consultation (nominally six weeks) overlapping with a holiday period (December 2016 – January 2017) with many of the key respondents on leave during some of the period. Many of those on loan to UNDP, or employed as project staff during the response (February – end December 2016) had since departed and few were available for interview.

A more thorough review may (or an evaluation would certainly) seek inputs from communities and local administrators in areas of UNDP's response. However, geographical constraints and time limits (and scope) determined that this AAR was limited to contact with responders and immediate stakeholders – albeit with the advantage of first-hand participation, face to face in Fiji and not only by remote, desk reviews and telephone interviews. In this manner some depth was able to be probed in certain subjects.

In relationship to the overall 'conceptual framework' presented, it must be recognised that ascertaining UNDP's performance in a crisis response is not as simple as it would be were UNDP a purely 'humanitarian' entity. In many aspects of the response, UNDP had to compete with the 'humanitarians', not only for supplies and funds, but also in promoting the basic philosophy of the response and values. A development-sensitive humanitarian response, that serves also to promote national and local capacity, is considerably different from a standard humanitarian response. One that is based upon existing long-term presence and relationships, and that maintains these relationships in good order throughout the crisis response, is additionally complex. By including senior Government officials and others in this review, some light is shed on how UNDP managed these complexities in its response to TC Winston.

4. Analysis of the Response

4.1 *Context*

Presented in this sub-section are ‘situational factors’ that influence the environment that UNDP’s response to TC Winston took place within: external issues, outside of the control of UNDP.

4.1.1 Geographical issues

Populated areas in the Pacific are dispersed over thousands of islands, many of which are extremely difficult to access. Fiji alone (the Fiji Islands) are comprised of 18,333 km² of land throughout 330 islands (of which 110 are inhabited) over 1.3 million km² of ocean.²¹ Most islands are mountains of volcanic origin or varied and contain dense tropical forest. The majority of the population lives in coastal areas. As befitting a nation of sea-farers, transport links to the outer islands are largely by boat – yet these are unreliable and do not run to schedule.²²

4.1.2 Government of Fiji Position and International Relationships

Fiji plays a prominent, highly respected role in the UN, including as a key contributor to peace-keeping operations and in leadership roles. Fiji is currently President of the UN General Assembly and recently headed the G-77, representing the Pacific on climate change negotiations. However, the past three decades have seen four coups in Fiji and relationships with the international community have been strained at times. In 2009 Fiji was suspended from both the Pacific Islands Forum (PIF) and the Commonwealth. Australia, for example, had imposed travel restrictions on members of the Fijian Government, and these were only lifted in March 2014.²³ Close neighbours, New Zealand and Australia, sent military personnel and equipment to Fiji to assist in the response to TC Winston.²⁴

Although clearly provided for in the *National Disaster Management Act* (1998), with the declaration of a ‘State of National Disaster’, Fiji’s opening up to assistance from the international community was noteworthy at this time. This in many ways demonstrated a consolidation of the normalization of

²¹ <http://www.nationsonline.org/oneworld/fiji.htm>

²² UNDP staff working on Koro Island experienced this first hand. Some were stranded for many more days than their planned missions.

²³ Australian Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade (DFAT). https://www.dfat.gov.au/geo/fiji/fiji_brief.html

²⁴ Although more visible in the response to TC Pam in Vanuatu, New Zealand, Australia and France are bound by the 1992 FRANZ agreement committing to "exchange information to ensure the best use of their assets and other resources for relief operations after cyclones and other natural disasters in the region". While cyclones remain the chief natural disaster across the South Pacific, FRANZ has in practice been an effective system against the wide range of disasters experienced in the region.

relationships between Fiji and the international community, mirroring Fiji's progressive 'return to democracy' since elections in 2014.

Internal Government strengths in Fiji are also significant. Whilst bureaucracies are well established, the devolution of authority, for example to municipality level, is 'progressing'.

4.1.3 Data and information issues

The contextual issues above combined with the state of existing infrastructure (roads and infrequent, expensive flights / shipping networks) lead to many populated areas being difficult to access at the best of times. This was also a major impediment to information gathering.

It is also important to note that the Government of Fiji managed the response to TC Winston, and the UN worked under the overall guidance of Government. During the crisis response, information was fed to the National Disaster Management Office (NDMO) via clusters and government officers. It was then assessed and compiled by the NDMO, and released back to the humanitarian community.

Where cyclone response needs aligned with existing sectoral clusters, such as in health and education, information was generally more available and reliable. In this case UNICEF's approach and long-established relationships with the Government of Fiji generally ensured a good grip on baselines. UNDP also maintained good relationships with Government – yet Early Recovery had no natural fit in Government sectors and no long-term cluster established. No data is available on overall TC Winston recovery plans or progress today.

4.2 UNDP Structure and Capacities in Country

4.2.1 UNDP/UN leadership and the UNCT

Important to consider is UNDP's 'dual role' in the context of development assistance. As highlighted above, UNDP engages in substantive areas of programme and policy support, as with most of the 20 UN entities in Fiji.²⁵ UNDP also has a role as chair of the United Nations Development Group (UNDG) – and coordinates the UN Country Team (UNCT) – or UNCTs in terms of regional support. "The UN Offices work together with [UNCTs] to coordinate the work of UN funds, agencies and organizations in support of the achievement of national development goals and to assist governments to respond to emergencies and national security issues."²⁶

²⁵ UNDP and the UN System. http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/operations/undp_un.html. Most of the UN entities listed operate regional support from their offices in Fiji.

²⁶ *ibid.*

UNDP in the Pacific is led by a single person fulfilling the role of Resident Representative (RR - head of UNDP), UN Resident Coordinator (RC) for the UNCT(s), and Designated Official (DO) for the UN System. For the humanitarian response, the UN's Emergency Relief Coordinator (ERC) also designated the RR/RC as Humanitarian Coordinator (HC) for a period of six months.²⁷ Thus, a fourth, demanding role was assumed for the response to TC Winston.²⁸ In reality this meant that much of the senior management of UNDP had to be delegated to the second in command, UNDP's Deputy Resident Representative (DRR).²⁹

Whilst the RR/RC/HC function remained consistent throughout 2016 (Osnat Lubrani), there were changes in this period with other senior management. Under the re-structured PO in Fiji, a new Country Director (CD) position was created. The previously Deputy Resident Representative (DRR), Akiko Fujii, became Acting CD and Head of Pacific Regional Policy and Programme Support on 25 March 2016, departing Fiji in August 2016. Bakhodir Burkhanov was appointed CD and Head of Pacific Regional Policy and Programme for the UNDP Pacific Office in Fiji in July 2016.³⁰

4.2.2 UNDP team capacities and ongoing programming

The UNDP Pacific Office (PO) in Fiji covers 10 countries, including Fiji itself. Related staff also support wide ranging regional policy and programme support functions. UNDP supports by coordinating United Nations activities at country level and through direct policy advice in the following areas:³¹

- Resilience and sustainable development – including Sustainable Development Goals (SDG)
- Environmental management, climate change and disaster risk management (DRM).
- Inclusive growth and poverty reduction
- Effective governance
- Gender equality

To this effect, the UNDP PO in Fiji has an executive office and operates five teams: three are programmatic: Resilience and Sustainable Development (RSD); Inclusive Growth (IG); Effective Governance (EG). All are supported by an Integrated Results Management Unit (IRMU).

²⁷ This was the third such appointment of the RR/RC as HC. The other two were for TC Pam in Vanuatu/Tuvalu in April 2015 and for floods in the Solomon Islands in April/May 2014.

²⁸ Though responsibilities for coordination of the Pacific Humanitarian Team (PHT) were supported by Mr. Sune Gudnitz, Head of the Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA) in the Pacific.

http://www.pacificdisaster.net/pdnadmin/data/original/FJI_TC_Winston_20160301_Flash_Appeal_remarks.pdf

²⁹ This point is intended to contribute to understanding the context in which UNDP undertook the response to TC Winston – which commenced in February 2017. However, there was already a decision to upgrade the DRR position to a CD role with clear delegation of authority which will strengthen UNDP's capacity in future crisis responses.

³⁰ See http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/operations/about_undp.html

³¹ UNDP Pacific website. http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/operations/about_undp.html Accessed 8 Jan. 2017

Team	No of. Staff. (Intl. / Natl. / Consultants)	Indicative budget (USD) (/ time frame) at time of TC Winston	Capacities
Executive Office	3 Internationals: RC/RR (previously designated as HC) in Fiji; CD (and regional policy/programme head) in Fiji, and; Country Manager as head of office for Solomon Islands.	n/a	Representation, coordination, resource mobilization, policy and strategy, Governmental and partner relations.
Resilience and Sustainable Development (RSD)	4 Intl. staff (. Team Leader, PRRP manager, RESPAC Manager and Energy Advisor. 1 NOC, 7 NOBs, 6 Proj. Assoc./Assts, 1 Coms Assoc. Some staff based in prog. Countries (Tonga, Vanuatu & Solomon Islands). RSD Team leader also functions as Regional Climate Change advisor. New RESPAC Proj Mgr also Disaster Response & Recovery Advisor.	28 projects ongoing ³² , US\$ 100 m (over 3-5 years), incl. Green Climate Fund (US\$ 36m) and 5 projs undergoing closure. 28 projects in pipeline worth about \$170 million.	Disaster Risk Management (DRM), Environment (Management & Conservation), Energy (Renewable & Efficiency), Climate change (Adaptation & Mitigation) competencies relatively well covered within team. DRM includes Pacific Risk Resilience Programme (PRRP) – risk governance). Seven (7) NOBs are all Masters graduates in various RSD related areas, while G7 are bachelors graduates..
Inclusive Growth (IG)	Total of 11 staff including 4 core office structure staff (1 IP, 2 NO, 1 GS), 2 Service Contract staff, 3 Project staff and 2 UNVs. Team led by Private Sector/Livelihoods Specialist. NO (Prog.) Livelihoods and Income Generation Specialist. Value-Chain Officer as project staff for M4C.	18 ongoing projects for US\$ 2.5 million annually – including Markets for Change (M4C). Regional Project (PFIP) US\$ 8 million (July 2016-Jun 2017) .	Livelihoods; Poverty Reduction, SDGs. With regional organizations and other partners, works on livelihoods, empowerment of informal economy, development of SME competitiveness, youth entrepreneurship, and women's economic empowerment in Fiji/PICs. Regional support: Pacific Financial Inclusion Programme, SDGs, Markets for Change, SDG-Fund farm-to-table
Effective Governance (EG)	26 total – incl. 1 Intl. Team leader	10 current Projects over next 3 to 5 years approx. US\$ 45m .	Parliamentary support, Gender/ Women's empowerment; Access to Justice; Anti-corruption; HIV, Malaria and NCDs (Global Fund)
Operations	25 national staff in total incl. 1 NO as Team Leader	US\$ 743,662 cost for 25 positions	Administrative and operational support to projects: Procurement, travel, logistics, finance, Hum.Res., Security
Integrated Results Management Unit (IRMU)	Jan. 2017, comprised of 8 – all local staff; one position under recruitment. 1 Team Leader, 2 M&E and Coord. Officers (NOB), 1 NOB Knowledge & Comms. Analyst 1 G6 Comms. Assoc., 1 G7 Prog. Finance Assoc. 1 PFA (G6) under recruitment; 1 UNDP Prog. Office (NOB – in Tarawa, Kiribati); 1 UNDP PO (NOB) – in Port Vila, Vanuatu.	NB. IRMU came into being April 2016, during TC Winston response. At time of TC Winston event, was “formed” - only on paper. Indicative 2016 budget US\$ 300,000	Monitoring and evaluation / results based management Communications and Knowledge networking Programme Financial Support
Total (in Fiji)	International 8 National 75 (approx.)	US\$ 31 million annual delivery target – all countries and regional.	Fiji component aprx. US\$ 8.7 million. US\$ 6.5 m dedicated to Fiji and 20% (US\$2.2 m) of regional.

Table. 4. Indicative ongoing resources (non-crisis situation) UNDP Fiji. Table combines info from 2016 and 2017, and can be treated as approximate only. Intended to indicate types of activities, expertise of staff and scale of programme and operations.

³² At the time of this AAR there were 27 current projects under RSD, approx. US\$ 80 m (over 3-5 years)

4.3 Timeline of relevant crisis events and response actions

Date	Activity	CB	Surge	Funds / Appl	Prog	Govt
2016. Sat. 20 Feb.	TC Winston makes land fall on Fiji.					
20 Feb.	Government declares State of Natural Disaster (for 30 days) and imposes nation-wide curfew (for short period)					X
21 Feb.	US\$ 1 m concept/note on Waste Management and Livelihoods Restoration submitted to Govt. of Japan by UNDP			X		
22 Feb.	Australia (DFAT) announces AU\$ 5 m assistance to Fiji			X		
23 Feb.	Crisis Board (CB) Meeting #1. Designated as Level II crisis. CRU allocates US\$ 100,000 TRAC1.1.3 to support coordination, needs assessment, and initiate early recovery framework for UNDP	X		X		
25 Feb.	US\$ 5 m concept note on TC Winston Recovery programme submitted to the Government of Sweden (by RBAP, NY)			X		
26 Feb.	CB Meeting #2. Decided light SURGE planning process - not deploying SURGE Planning Team	X				
29 Feb.	Australia announces further AU\$ 10 m assistance for TC Winston			X		
29 Feb.	IFRC launch US\$ 7 m Emergency Appeal to support Fiji Red Cross Society (FRCS) to assist 38,500 people			X		
29 Feb.	Initial 'First Responder' arrives Suva as Programme Specialist. Naoko Takasu, Desk Officer from UNDP RH in Bangkok.		X			
28 Feb.-11 March	Realignment of existing projects. & reprogramming of funds in country. US\$ 150,000 identified.			X	X	
1 March	EU announces FJ\$10 m (US\$ 5 m) for TC Winston recovery (via SPC) ³³			X		
1 & 4 Mar.	2 nd and 3 rd First Responders arrive. Noud Leenders as Senior Recovery Specialist and Romain Desclos as Communications Specialist.		X			
4 March	Flash appeal launched for Govt./UN and partners. US\$ 38.6 m (FJD 82)					
4 March	OCHA announces US\$ 8 million CERF allocation ³⁴			X		
4 March	CB Meeting #3.	X				
8 March	BPPS allocate US\$ 250,000 for debris clearance			X		
8 March	IOM launches its own 'flash appeal' for US\$ 4.1 m for 'CCCM, shelter and the protection and safety sectors.' ³⁵					
11 March	First SBP personnel arrives (Faisal Ridwan, MSB funded)		X			
11 March	CERF approval letter received. US\$ 124,174 approved for UNDP			X		
14 March	USD 250,000 confirmed from UNDP HQ for Early Recovery to Sudden Crisis' category Trac 1.1.3 funds			X		
15 March	SURGE plan submitted					
16 March	CB meeting # 4. SURGE Plan approved for 3 months with US\$ 291,000 committed.	X		X		
18 March	2 nd two SBPs arrive (Camille Laude, Tova Andersson - MSB)		X			
21 March	Government of Fiji extends State of Natural Disaster for one month					X

³³ <http://fijivillage.com/news-feature/EU-provides-10-million-to-support-TC-Winston-recovery-efforts-9s52rk/>

³⁴ <http://www.unocha.org/cerf/cerf-worldwide/allocations-country/2016>. The USD 8 million for Fiji exceeded the USD 5 million CERF allocation to Vanuatu (for response to TC PAM) in 2015 in which UNDP did not receive a CERF grant: http://www.unocha.org/cerf/sites/default/files/CERF/HCRReports/15-RR-VUT-14293-NR01_Vanuatu.pdf

³⁵ IOM Flash appeal Fiji: Tropical Cyclone Winston, 08 March 2016. <http://reliefweb.int/report/fiji/iom-flash-appeal-fiji-tropical-cyclone-winston-08-march-2016>

Date	Activity	CB	Surge	Funds / Appl	Prog	Govt
29 March	PDNA begins – scheduled for 3 weeks					X
9 April	Prime Minister announces national “Help for Homes” initiative					X
16 April	First and only support under ExPres modality arrives – Communication specialist, Tiku Kumar. (1 month gap in coms support)		X			
20 April	Australia announced add. AU\$ 20 million for longer-term recovery and reconstruction			X		
(?) May	Govt. and partners complete PDNA. US\$ 1.4 b (FJD 2.8 b) estimate of combined damage and losses presented. ³⁶					X
18 June	Last SBP assignment wraps up (lessons learnt paper 20 June)		X			
30 June	Last ‘first responder’ deployment (Noud Leenders) wraps up					
30 June	ADB announces US\$ 50 m post-crisis loan approval to Govt. of Fiji			X		X
18 July	Govt. of Fiji signs US\$ 50 m post-crisis loan agreement with WB			X		X
July – Dec.	Bulk of UNDP procurement / programming (details to be added)				X	
2 Sept.	UNDP Prodoc “Cyclone Winston Response and Recovery” finally signed by Government (but had been functional for UNDP and late signing did not inhibited work progress).			X		
15 Sept.	UNDP sign agreement Habitat for Humanity Fiji/IOM/DFAT training Carpenters on Koro Island			X		
End Dec. 2016.	UNDP Recovery project wound up.					
2017 03 Jan.	AAR commenced					
16-20 Jan.	Crisis response training in Suva.					
20 Feb.	Government holds commemoration service for TC Winston victims at Suva’s Albert Park on the one-year anniversary of the event					
22 Feb.	AAR completed (after circulation of draft for comment)					
28 Mar.	Comments incorporated and AAR final report completed.					

Table 5. UNDP AAR for TC Winston. Timeline of crisis and response actions and related events

³⁶ OCHA note total damage and losses from Winston are estimated in the PDNA at \$1.42 billion — equivalent to 31% of Fiji’s gross domestic product (GDP). <http://reliefweb.int/disaster/tc-2016-000014-fji>

4.4 UNDP Crisis-Response Corporate Structure

4.4.1 Crisis Board and Corporate Crisis-Management Mechanisms

Crisis response entity	Purpose	Note on application to TC Winston Response in Fiji
1. Crisis Board	Senior decision making forum at HQ/RH/CO level with broad inter-bureau membership	Promptly convened (CB#1) 23 Feb. 2016. Fully functional.
2. Senior Response Coordinator (SRC)	Optional role to support CB leadership at HQ/RH/CO level	Not applied.
3. Crisis Management Support Team (CMST)	Working-level for duration of crisis. Ensures single channel of response-related communication with all HQ/RH/CO	CB#1 established "Working-level Crisis Management [Support] Team" with each Bureau to nominate focal point. Fully functional
4. CMST Coordinator	Under CB Chair (or SRC) ensures prompt and high quality support from HQ / RH to CO relating to response objectives	Not designated as such but coordination assured through DRR (CO) and CRU (HQ) with RH. First responder Prog. Mgm. Specialist – acted as in some respects.
5. Crisis Response Team (CRT)	Brings together programme, operations and advocacy functions for cohesive in-county day to day response activities	Not designated yet largely functioned under DRR lead
6. CRT Coordinator	Senior member of CO under RR. Leads CRT to ensure coherence	Not designated yet role filled by DRR
7. Surge Planning Team	Established by CB#1, deployed with the support of CRU within 7-10 days for one week to support to CO planning processes	Not discussed CB#1. CB#2 decided light Surge planning process. Single person (Prog. Mgm Spec.) as 1 st resp. for "SURGE planning other tasks" ³⁷

Table 6. UNDP Crisis-related corporate mechanisms. UNDP SOP for immediate crisis response

From the seven (7) corporate crisis response mechanism provided for in UNDP's crisis response SOP, only the CB and CMST were applied as per design. (Also see annex C, List of Interviewees, with CB and CMST designations noted). The CB met four (4) times over the course of the initial crisis response between 23 February and 16 March 2016 (see details in Annex E, Crisis Board Meeting Minutes).

Senior members of the CO (PO) were already functioning as a defacto CRT, yet this was not named as such. No SRC was sought, and CMST and CRT coordinators were not designated – largely because functions were being covered by a combination of roles of the DRR in-country, with the initial support of the Programme Management Specialist deployed as a first responder. In HQ, functioning of the CB and CMST was supported by CRU and other UNDP bureaus as required.

³⁷ CB Meeting #2. 26 Feb. 2016

The surge planning exercise was not supported by a dedicated team. Although CB minutes do not reflect a specific discussion and decision, the Surge Plan itself notes that “the second Crisis Board meeting on 26 Feb decided on a light SURGE planning process instead of deploying a SURGE Planning Team.”³⁸ The single person deployed for this task was a Programme Management Specialist (Naoko Takasu), the Desk Officer covering Fiji from RBAP’s Regional Hub in Bangkok. Of concern is that CB meeting #2 of 26 February 2016 assigned responsibility to this single person for “SURGE planning and coordination, as well as programing and proposal writing support, in close consultation with other First Responders.”³⁹ Although this arrangement was foreseen to be the most strategic and cost-effective, and effectively led to a relevant Surge Plan, much reliance (and pressure) was placed on one person. Indeed all first responders made valuable inputs to the plan, as much of the office did.

4.4.2 Deployments

In total eight (8) deployments were fielded to support UNDP’s PO in its response to TC Winston.

First Responders

Four (4) ‘First Responders’ were deployed to Fiji for UNDP’s TC Winston Response. The first to arrive, the Programme Management Specialist, came within a week of the event and stepped into a multi-functional role on surge planning, resource mobilization and programme and coordination support. from RBAP’s Regional Hub (RH) in Bangkok.

Dates	Name	Title	Function in TC Winston Response
29 Feb. – 19 Mar. 2016.	Naoko Takasu	Country Programme Specialist – UNDP RH Bangkok	Programme Management Specialist for TC Winston. Surge planning, resource mobilization and programme and coordination support.
1 Mar. – 30 Jun 2016.	Arnoldus (Noud) Leenders	Consultant	Senior Recovery Advisor for TC Winston. Quickly moved to PDNA support function.
3 weeks only 04 – 22 Mar. 2016	Romain Desclois	Communications Specialist – UNDP in Jerusalem	Communications Specialist for TC Response. One week spent in field.
10 days. 29 Feb. on	Tomislav Condic	UNDP Security Specialist	Ensuring staff safety and security esp. for remote locations (UNDP security office paid)

Table 7. First Responders deployed to UNDP’s response to TC Winston in Fiji.

SURGE Advisors / ExpRes

One person arrived under the ExpRes modality , a Communications specialist (Tiku Kumar) for two (2) months from 16 April – 15 June 2016. A Surge-Plan approved Senior Recovery Advisor (P5) was put on

³⁸ Surge Plan (15 March 2016). “The second Crisis Board meeting on 26 Feb decided on a light SURGE planning process instead of deploying a SURGE Planning Team. The purpose of the SURGE planning process is to develop an integrated programmatic and operational plan for an initial period of three months.”

³⁹ CB Meeting #2. 26 Feb. 2016

hold as the request of the PO in Fiji – namely due to a lack of clear entry points for UNDP to partake in the national recovery programme.⁴⁰

Standby partners

Stand-by Partners (SBPs), in this case all three (3) provided by Swedish Civil Contingencies Agency (MSB) provided core expertise for much of UNDP's response / early recovery field work. All were Debris and Waste Management Advisors, yet the skills of one (Tova Andersson) were also put to use in support of the RC/HC function, who even provided communications materials in blog form for UNDP.⁴¹ Two additional MSB deployments beyond June 2016 were not pursued.

Dates	Name	SBP / Funding source	Function in TC Winston Response
18 Mar. – 18 Jun. 2016. Full 3 months.	Camille Laude	MSB	Debris and Waste Management Advisor
11 Mar. – 11 Jun. 2016. Full 3 months	Faisal Caleue	MSB	Debris and Waste Management Advisor
Full 3 months. 18 Mar. – 18 Jun. 2016.	Tova Andersson	MSB	Support to RC in role as HC – listed as Debris / Waste Mgm Advisor
Assignment put on hold	Kallnischkies Thorsten	MSB	DWM Advisor
Assignment put on hold	Ana Fonseca	MSB	DWM Advisor

Tab. 8 Stand-by partners deployed to UNDP's response to TC Winston in Fiji.

4.4.3 Seed-Funding

Adding to the US\$ 150,000 identified internally by the PO, about US\$ 650,000 was made available by UNDP HQ to support response efforts. This came in three tranches as listed below in table 9.

Source	Received/committed (US\$)	Use
INTERNAL UNDP FUNDING		
TRAC1.1.3	100,000	Coordination, assessments, ER framework, HC/RC support. (Submitted and approved 22 Feb.)
BPPS ⁴²	250,000	Programmatic support to TC Winston Response / Rec. Project. Released against ProDoc of 8 March to kick-start debris clearance.
SURGE ⁴³	291,000	Staff capacities / Operations support. Released against Surge plan.

⁴⁰ Some also attributed this decision as related to the non-formation of the ER cluster – yet their main role would have been to support the RC with Government identifying priorities for recovery in light of PDNA findings and recommendations. Had the right profile and character of person been found, and with an entry point available, this person could have potentially been instrumental in getting important issues for recovery (and DRR in general) on the Government agenda.

⁴¹ 07 Apr 2016 Blog: Hand in hand, we are stronger than Winston by Tova Andersson <http://www.asia-pacific.undp.org/content/rbap/en/home/blog/2016/4/7/In-Fiji-together-we-are-stronger-than-Winston.html>

⁴² Third (3rd) CB meeting minutes, 4 March 2016

⁴³ US\$291,000 was the approved budget of the SURGE plan, yet as not all actions (staff) were employed, the full amount was not expended.

From existing projects ⁴⁴	150,000	Realigned as programme support. Funding for engaging youths on CfW/ER from two UNDP projects: the Fiji Youth Strengthening Project, and Strengthening Citizen Engagement in Fiji Initiative (SCEFI, EU-funded) ⁴⁵
EXTERNAL FUNDING		
OCHA	50,000	Emergency cash grant. Debris clearance equipment.
CERF	124,000	Debris clearance within food security proposal (with WFP/FAO)
Aust (DFAT)	50,000	For seedlings. Markets for change project – a small portion of US\$ 3.5 million crisis-fund gained by UN Women as the principal M4C partner
TOTAL (US\$)	1,015,000	

4.4.4 External Resource Mobilization

Numerous efforts were made by UNDP at the country level, with some support from HQ, to raise funds for UNDP's response to TC Winston. Most of these were concentrated in the first week of the crisis – as UNDP was aware from experience of the need to quickly seize donor interest.

- 21 February: US\$ 1 million concept note on “Tropical Cyclone Winston Waste Management and Livelihood Restoration in Fiji” submitted to the Government of Japan.
 - 25 February: US\$ 5 million concept note on “Cyclone Winston Recovery programme in Maritime Islands of Fiji” submitted to the Government of Sweden.
- 29 February: For flash appeal launch on 4 March, US\$ 1.1 million of UNDP's proposals submitted: US\$ 0.9 million under Early Recovery cluster, US\$ 0.2 million under Food Security.
- 29 February: Request for US\$ 50,000 from OCHA's Emergency Cash Grant facility, submitted for the procurement of debris clearance equipment through (approved 1 March).
 - 6 March: US\$ 75,000 (shortly thereafter upgraded to USD 124,000) submitted against US\$ 8 million confirmed for the CERF.

From the US\$ 7.3 million of proposals made, only US\$ 224,000 eventuated in external funding.⁴⁶ Combined with US\$ 150,000 in reprogrammed resources, and US\$ 650,000 in internal/HQ-allocated funds, this gave the UNDP PO a US\$ 1.0 million response capacity. All of this should be treated as humanitarian response and early recovery funding within the humanitarian context. None of it was 'recovery' funding.

⁴⁴ Identified in 2nd CB meeting minutes, 26 Feb. 2016

⁴⁵ <http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/04/08/in-fiji-youth-are-key-to-cyclone-winston-recovery.html>

⁴⁶ This is largely explained in section six (6) where a further discussion on 'recovery and funding realities' is presented.

4.5 Comments on overall response design

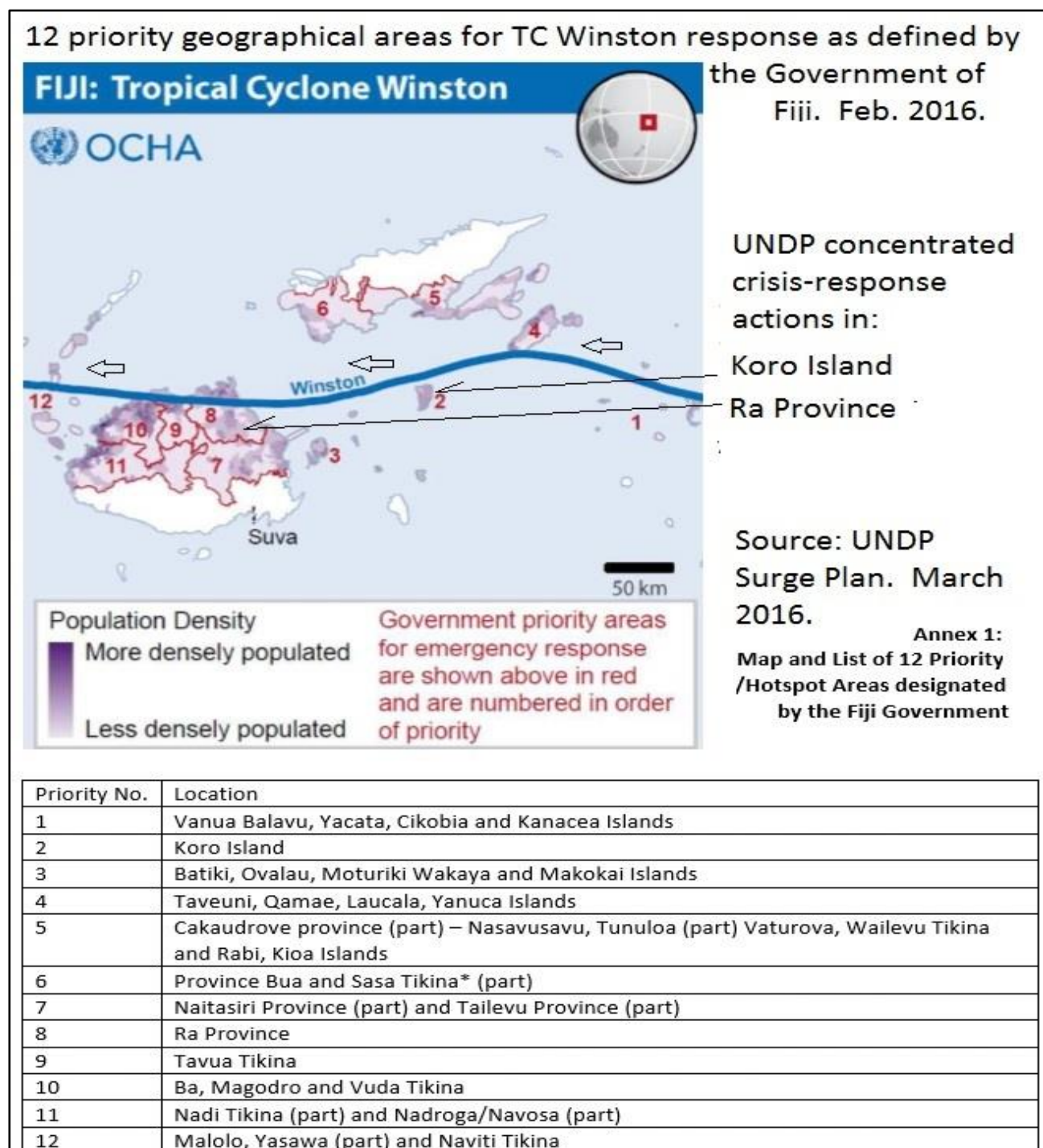
In many respects, considering the level of the crisis and the significant capacity in UNDP's office in Fiji, the design of the response demonstrated a reasonable balance of the employment of corporate mechanisms, human resources and funds. Deploying a Desk Officer from the Regional Hub as a First Responder was an essential element of success in this case (albeit with the below-noted concern over expectations and replicability). Surge planning, as a 'light' exercise, was largely appropriate. CB and CMST mechanisms worked well, and there may have been no need for CRT and specific additional coordinators. Concerns arise, however, in terms of:

1. The high degree of workload and pressure placed on the initial first responder⁴⁷ – especially considering that the DRR/CD a.i. had assumed the general responsibility for UNDP MCO/PO with the RR largely engaged as HC on humanitarian issues.
2. The amount of work put into the SURGE plan – considering it was an internal UNDP document – viz its ultimate yield (three SBPs, all from MSB)
3. The reliance on MSB as the single SBP, to provide the large part of technical capacity to UNDP's response. Ultimately this became UNDP's most visible crisis-response effort – yet it was mostly founded on two MSB experts.
4. The workload on external resource mobilization efforts during the first days of the crisis response – especially as such efforts yielded very little. This raises the question of the degree of consultation with donors beforehand and the overall strategic engagement for fund raising - an area that warrants further study.⁴⁸
5. The pressure to 'get the CERF'. Considering that UNDP will only ever be able to access a very small proportion of the CERF, and that external response and recovery funding is limited for UNDP (especially in MICs), then internal reprogramming may well be the best way to be relevant in a crisis response. This, of course, would have to be balanced with UNDP still engaging in coordination and important early assessment and advocacy such as around the Flash Appeal, and proving capability by engaging overall in early phases of the response.

⁴⁷ This person did not highlight any specific elements of pressure or stress in interviews for this report, yet it is the author's assessment that the tasks required were of 'super-human' expectations. The choice of the actual initial first responder, serving a desk function in the region, was excellent – and delivery was indeed of a super-human nature (which raises concern over this being accepted as a model to be replicated in other circumstances). UNDP need to consider how to make best use of desk officers and other experienced staff with strong links and knowledge of country situations as first responders, balancing roles and responsibilities in relation to CO's crisis response capacities and staff members' prior experience in handling similar situations. In this case it worked very well. A good decision.

⁴⁸ HQ pressure on the in-country team to raise resources for response is understood, yet in many cases this has proved an impossible task in the immediate aftermath of a disaster, taking staff resources away from coordination and delivery. More time needs to be put into donor relations before crises happen, and a better use of a pooled 'funding window' could alleviate the need to pursue donors as such.

5. Summary of Achievements: Successes and Challenges



Map 1. TC Winston track and priority government-prioritized response areas.

This is the main substantive section of the report and presents findings in direct relationship to expectations as detailed draft SOP and the Conceptual Framework (section 2), with an emphasis on adherence to UNDP Crisis Response SOPs. UNDP's crisis response included numerous 'early-recovery' activities: Disaster Waste Management (DWM), livelihoods and food security support, and the rebuilding of community infrastructure.

5.1 Programme

What worked well?

- **Considerable faith in UNDP was demonstrated (with related expectations) by Government and partners** by delegating responsibility for UNDP to be the main UN partner in Koro Island – a heavily-impacted, logistically-difficult, island location. Koro was Government’s response priority #2, second only to the very remote Lau group of islands. UNDP stepped up to the plate, accepted the challenge, and in many respects delivered on this responsibility.
- **Within existing UNDP programmes, there was some success in identifying and realigning funds to priority crisis response needs.** In total, US\$ 150,000 was reprogrammed, including for the procurement of equipment related to Disaster Waste Management (DWM): chainsaws, shovels and wheelbarrows are an example. US\$ 100,000 of this was for Koro Island.⁴⁹
- **UNDP’s crisis interventions were largely relevant** - this sentiment being reinforced also from stakeholders outside of UNDP. The bulk of UNDP’s programmatic ‘crisis-response and early recovery’ action implemented under the “Cyclone Winston response and recovery project in Fiji” addressed: Disaster Waste Management (DWM, which includes debris clearance), livelihoods, food security and the rebuilding of community infrastructure. 19 villages in Ra and 14 villages on Koro Island were targeted. The **formulation of the project document** (prodoc) itself, along with **regular monitoring and reporting, gave coherence** to the overall effort (even though Government did not officially sign off on the document until September 2016).
- UNDP Fiji, with local knowledge and community consultation, ensured **good adaptation of UNDP Crisis Response Packages to the local context.** Appreciating HQ guidance on signature products such as DWM⁵⁰ (including debris clearance), Cash for Work (CfW), and livelihoods, investigating actual needs in Koro Island and Ra province quickly led UNDP teams to add local relevance to the crisis response actions. In Koro, for example, the main income-generation source for Women in weaving of traditional mats from pandanus.⁵¹ However, as pandanus grows in low-lying coastal areas near beaches and mangrove estuaries, much of the stock of trees (growing up to 14m in height) had been wiped out by the forces of TC Winston and the accompanying tidal surge which was up to three (3) metres in this area. Through much creative effort, UNDP sourced pandanus

⁴⁹ UNDP, 18 April 2016. *Youths clear debris in Koro and regain strength for recovery.* “In Koro Island, UNDP reprogrammed FJ \$100,000 and, together with the Ministry of Youth and Sports, started a Cash-for-Work programme for up to 300 youths...”

⁵⁰ Disaster Waste Management (DWM) is a practice area that includes (but is not limited to) the clearance of debris.

⁵¹ Pandanus tectorius: a species of pandanus or screw pine native to Malaysia, eastern Australia, and the Pacific Islands – naturally grows in low lying and coastal areas, thus is susceptible to cyclone and wave or tidal surge damage.

weaving materials from less-affected areas of Fiji (such as Vanua Levu) and provided them to women's groups in the 14 villages of Koro.

- **UNDP continually extended comprehensive support to ensure project results**, such as the pandanus weaving livelihoods endeavour. Women's groups were not simply given weaving materials and left to themselves. Understanding that access to markets had been compromised by the cyclone, yet at the same time boosting demand and potential sale prices for high-quality mats, UNDP pursued the active marketing of the finished product on behalf of the Koro women. In this case, finished mats were wrapped and labelled on Koro, then transported to Suva. All 46 'sets' (nearly 200 mats) were sold with four days of diligent marketing and selling by UNDP staff supporting Government's Integrated Human Resource Development Programme (IHRDP) in Suva. FJD 45,000⁵² (US\$ 21,000) was returned by UNDP to the villages in Koro just before Christmas. Many of UNDP's crisis response actions had a **significant gender element**.
- **UNDP drew upon existing projects and relationships** reviving some specifically for the crisis response. Some cash-for-work for early recovery drew upon UNDP's work since 2012 supporting Fijian youth with the Ministry of Youths and Sports.⁵³ UNDP played a pivotal role in connecting local, national and regional dots in addressing DWM. UNDP's ongoing 'Parliament Project' successfully tapped its network and partnerships supporting a 'Committee Hearing' on Government's response to the disaster. This was the first of its kind in Fiji and helped strengthen Parliament's oversight over Government's disaster response budget and actions, improving transparency and accountability. However, as detailed below, UNDP's crisis response would have been stronger, and easier to initiate, if it had been able to identify and build to a greater extent upon existing projects.
- **UNDP in the field thought on its feet.** The AAR review uncovered some anecdotes from other partners of the capacity for UNDP to seize opportunities when they were presented. For example, on Koro island, there were times when UNDP benefitted by requesting assistance from the New Zealand and Australian defence forces for logistical support. This even extended to success in having private transport carriers, who brought building materials to Koro from the mainland (Viti Levu), in removing debris off the island in the same trucks upon their return.
- **UNDP's Early Recovery actions helped others access sites** and perform duties in a range of sectors. Noted in the AAR were several examples that extolled the relevance of UNDP's debris

⁵² Koro women involved in the weaving typically received about FJD 200 each just before Christmas from UNDP – a significant amount of cash for people living in the subsistence economy of remoter Fijian Islands.

⁵³ Funding for engaging youth was made available by reallocating resources from two UNDP projects: the Fiji Youth Strengthening Project, and Strengthening Citizen Engagement in Fiji Initiative (SCEFI, funded by the European Union). <http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/04/08/in-fiji-youth-are-key-to-cyclone-winston-recovery.html>

clearance and other DWM work in the context of hurricane force winds and tidal surge in a heavily vegetated, rural, sparsely populated area. The concept of ‘emergency access’ is relevant to all other humanitarian actions (yet, there are certainly opportunities and a need for UNDP to further highlight their function and benefits in this regard).

- **UNDP demonstrated added value beyond being a first-phase responder** – and took the opportunity to **support national partners, including CSOs**. One such example is adaptation of the UNDP ‘Strengthening Citizens Engagement in Fiji’ (SCEFI) grants project in Ra province in the West of Fiji – a priority area, heavily impacted by TC Winston. UNDP worked with the NGO ‘Friends’ helping them engage civil society with authorities. A video with the EU, donors, CSOs and the NDMO was launched to promote this.⁵⁴ This the increased capacity of CSOs to represent society – to the extent that they officially engaged in the NDMO internal review. Overall it is a good example of how UNDP can be a platform to capitalize on opportunities in times of crisis and further the role of CSOs and enhance their space in terms of disaster relief/development and the livelihoods continuum.
- **Numerous examples of active learning were demonstrated**, including specific efforts to analyse and document ‘lessons learned’ by three of the MSB stand-by partners⁵⁵ and within progress reports of UNDP’s TC Winston *Cyclone Winston Response and Recovery project in Fiji, Project report (Dec. 2016)*. Lessons were often not trivial – such as in the analysis of the application of Cash for Work (CfW). “[There is] no systematic need of cash for work program to implement debris clearance activities in rural areas. When given the choice many communities were willing to have more equipment for debris handling instead of cash. In some cases, the association of payment with community work is seen as a threat to the community system in place (communal work, traditionally called the solesolevaki system).”⁵⁶
- **Some examples of innovative work and private sector links were displayed** such as noted in UNDP’s 15 March 2016 press release, *Cyclone devastation calls for extraordinary partnerships*. Innovative use of SMS messaging was supported to enhance post-crisis communication between Government (namely Agriculture) and affected citizens.⁵⁷

⁵⁴ See. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0J2pe8swCAs>

⁵⁵ Three MSB deployees took the initiative to write an end of mission report on lessons learned for UNDP. This was shared by one of the authors with the AAR consultant. Although not all observations are positive, the fact that an active effort has been made to draw these lessons is. See Annex G.

⁵⁶ Quote directly from Dec. 2016 UNDP progress report Cyclone Winston Response and Recovery Project report (Dec. 2016).

⁵⁷ See Annex F – summary of analysis of selected communications pieces. <http://www.asia-pacific.undp.org/content/rbap/en/home/presscenter/pressreleases/2016/03/15/cyclone-devastation-calls-for-extraordinary-partnerships.html>

- **UNDP’s crisis work in the field of Koro Island positively influenced longer-term funding.** Related to comments in the section below which discuss an overall, symptomatic low-level of UNDP’s field presence, UNDP’s crisis-response work on Koro Island was used to show-case ‘what UNDP can do in the field’ and helped to secure substantial funding for UNDP’s US\$ 7.5 million, three-year RESPAC project. In programme and operational ways, and later with implications for advocacy, a focus on only two geographic areas was good.

What could have worked better?

- At the onset of the crisis, many in UNDP were **not aware of corporate crisis response mechanisms, tools and potential resources.** This resulted in extra time being taken in the start up to response actions – and defining the support required from HQ.
- **Many UNDP projects lacked flexibility for reprogramming** within their committed deliverables. This restricted the degree that resources that could be reoriented towards the immediate crisis response. Though not insignificant, the US\$ 150,000 identified for reprogramming represents only about 2% of the annual UNDP portfolio of approximately US\$ 8.7 million for Fiji.⁵⁸
- **With an overall crisis response of near USD 1,000,000, UNDP’s inputs were modest in terms of total needs.** A key indicator of this was Government’s ‘wanting more from UNDP’, however, this also attested to the relevance and appreciation of UNDP’s inputs. Unfortunately the total value of the humanitarian response couldn’t be calculated accurately, yet the author estimates this to be in the order of USD 100 – 150 million⁵⁹ – USD 22 million coming via the Flash Appeal.⁶⁰
- **Ongoing field project commitments of UNDP did not geographically match the most affected crisis-impacted areas** and the national priorities for crisis response. Government identified 12 priority zones or ‘hotspots’ for the response (as detailed in Map 1.) UNDP, with the guidance of the NDMO and cluster system, directed its crisis-response interventions to Koro Island and Ra Province. However, the Surge plan noted that “UNDP does not have project/field offices in these areas, and it plans to use local government facilities for implementation of the Response and

⁵⁸ US\$ 33 million was the targeted delivery through the MCO/PC (later PO) in 2016. Of this the Fiji component is estimated by the author (based upon figures provided by UNDP PO in Fiji) to be US\$ 8.7 million: US\$ 6.5 m dedicated to specific Fiji projects and 20% (US\$2.2 m) of the regional programming component.

⁵⁹ The value of the humanitarian response in Fiji includes significant inputs from the Government of Fiji, Australia and New Zealand defence forces, other governments, and significant funding to UN agencies, NGOs and other organizations raised outside the Flash Appeal – not to mention generous commitments from communities within Fiji. OCHA (March 2017) confirmed that the Government of Fiji had requested an overview, but that it was not put together in the end. OCHA suggested the author pursue the research ‘agency by agency’ yet this was unfortunately not possible at the later stages of AAR report preparation. The lesson was that OCHA has an overview of some humanitarian work, yet is focused on the Flash Appeal and UN, and not ON overall humanitarian analysis.

⁶⁰ The Flash Appeal for TC Winston generated 56% (USD 22m) of the USD 39 million requested. (OCHA, March 2017)

Recovery project.”⁶¹ In many ways, working with government is a positive aspect of UNDP’s modus operandi. Out of necessity, some crisis response was ‘embedded’ in national institutions.

- **UNDP was not directly undertaking much field activity upon which to found a field-based crisis response.** Relating to the paragraph above, this is largely symptomatic of the approach of the MCO/PO in Fiji, and common in a MIC such as Fiji with strong governmental institutions. The Surge plan notes that prior to the crisis there were “no specific capacity within the office in terms of debris and waste management or community infrastructure - whereas there are projects deals with livelihoods (M4C, the SDG Fund, Fiji Youth project and Private sector projects).”⁶² Perhaps ironically, as noted above, starting a field presence through the response to TC Winston actually helped UNDP convince donors of their capability and mobilize resources for later projects (See RESPAC).
- Although largely relevant when implemented (livelihoods and DWM), **UNDP’s crisis response actions were limited in their pace of outreach by field capacity** (human resources). Much relied on only two substantive UNDP experts in the field (from MSB), who progressively got to villages: 19 in Ra and 14 in Koro.
- **UNDP’s crisis response actions were not integrated into the overall UNDP country programme.** There are numerous indicators of this finding, including relating to the above three paragraphs. UNDP project activities on Koro Island and in Ra province were largely started afresh, and did not have the benefit of building upon existing long-term projects – although relationships with IHRDP, the Ministry of Agriculture, and Ministry of Youths and Sports were tapped. More of a concern is the sentiment expressed by some working on Koro that they felt that UNDP as a whole was largely disengaged from the response: that by recruiting and deploying specific staff for the project, including through international stand-by arrangements, Koro would run itself and UNDP central would move on with its regular development work. MSB, who provided much of the technical and managerial capacity for DWM, recommended that “permanent UNDP staff [be] directly involved as part of the response team during the whole intervention.”⁶³ MSB also referred to their ‘capacity building’ mandate, which required they trained UNDP staff and that projects continued well beyond MSB’s presence and became integrated into UNDP’s programmatic response overall. Unfortunately, none of this happened.
- **Many theoretical UNDP strengths could not be levered.** As participation in the crisis response training further demonstrated, many of UNDP’s oft-touted strengths remained theoretical. A comprehensive field presence, solid community relationships, good access to and thorough

⁶¹ Surge Plan (UNDP, 15 March 2016)

⁶² ibid

⁶³ MSB/UNDP June 2016. Lessons learned report.

analysis of data, strong relationships with national and local authorities, and close ties to civil society, were all exhibited in some way, but not as active, comprehensive strengths from which to found a crisis response. Squarely within the mandate of UNDP – these are opportunities yet to be fully developed.

- **More potential could have been realized with UNDP’s role in private sector engagement and technical innovation.** The above-noted example of UNDP supporting SMS messaging could have potentially been strengthened by drawing more upon in-house capacity, for example in the joint UNCDF/UNDP Pacific Financial Inclusion Programme (PFIP). PFIP deals with banks and insurance companies – their operations being critical to both crisis response and recovery. The PFIP programme manager was involved in some crisis-response UNDP meetings and provided a quick stock take of financial service providers (yet it’s unclear if UNDP this and, if so, how).
- There was a considerable **delay in getting the official UNDP prodoc signed** for ‘response and recovery’ due to Government’s non-familiarity with the process. The lack of a signed agreement for several months, however, did not stop UNDP commencing response activities.⁶⁴ Overall this point reflects a need for more active, long-term engagement with government partners.⁶⁵
- **No formal ‘recovery chapeau’ document was pursued** after a few months of crisis response despite much initial thinking around the need for UNDP’s solid engagement in recovery. This issue will be further discussed in section 6 below (Recovery and Funding realities) which considers that practicality of UNDP formally engaging as a valued partner in nationally-led recovery.
- **A more holistic view to resource mobilization for crisis and recovery was needed.** Even though UNDP achieved some success in both demonstrating strategic partnership thinking and accessing US\$ 124,000 from the CERF, those on the front line of the effort expended much personal capital. Strain was put on relationships with Government and UN partners alike in terms of UNDP appearing ‘desperate’ and otherwise compromising their sincerity on issues of resilience and development. Some felt the pressure on getting the CERF from higher up was unreasonable. Indeed, current draft guidelines made available during the crisis response training highlight the CERF as a key resource in times of humanitarian crisis: which it is, but perhaps not for UNDP. All

⁶⁴ In any case, considerable leniency in protocols was demonstrated by the Government of Fiji during this initial response period. Heightened international engagement was expected and provided for in section 32. (1) of Fiji’s National Disaster Act (1998).

⁶⁵ In this case the Fijian office of the Solicitor General needed time to understand the implications and risks of Government signing such a document in times of crisis – a valid concern that would have benefitted from more active engagement and follow up.

was compounded by the afore-mentioned inability of UNDP to clearly articulate the benefits of an early-recovery approach in the humanitarian agenda.⁶⁶

5.2 Operations

What worked well?

- Overall demonstrated was an **excellent will and commitment of UNDP staff** – who identified with the crisis and were motivated to engage in the response. This engagement extended beyond normal duties. The UNDP Staff Association were known to personally raise funds and deliver supplies to affected areas.
- As compared to TC Pam, **UNDP Fiji had a strong team based in Fiji** – and this strength was certainly drawn upon leading to a quicker start-up of UNDP’s response. Many had **recent experience working responding to TC Pam**, yet all were **cognisant of lessons and the need to improve** outreach and the effectiveness of the response as a function of human needs.⁶⁷
- **Tensions between incoming Surge teams and first responders with the CO were not significant** – unlike issues raised in previous AARs. A smaller number of support staff flew in, and the MCO/PO clearly led the response. Opportunities were also taken to re-recruit SBP personnel that had worked well with UNDP in the Vanuatu response 10 months earlier.
- Although the UNDP office in Fiji was undergoing a transformation at the time, there are some indications that the **crisis response served to build team strength**.
- Learning from TC Pam, operations **prepared logistical and briefing notes** for first-responders, external staff and stand-by partners, which minimised the personal attention needed for each incoming staff.
- The addition of **UNDP Security Officer was helpful** early on in the response – particularly as there was a high degree of civil-military liaison required with the Fijian, New Zealand and Australian defence forces. Paid for by the UNDP Security Office (thus, not impacting SURGE or other commitments) this deployment for the most-hecktic initial three weeks of the response was highly appreciated. Guidance provided helped set in place systems related to staff safety and security that would effectively continue throughout the response.

⁶⁶ Preparedness plans now being discussed include significant local-level exploration and strategizing for early-recovery. In principle a first responder with a dedicated role to support the CO should also help significantly and the first Crisis Board meeting should support an early deployment.

⁶⁷ In crisis response training on 19 January 2017, the team overwhelmingly prioritized as ‘measure of crisis response success’ the degree to which UNDP’s work impacts upon and changes people’s lives and the level of outreach (geographic coverage) achieved.

What could have worked better?

In terms of UNDP's Operational response, it is hard to fault what was achieved in support of the implementation of programmes. Considering that UNDP neither requested or received a general boost to its operational capacity over the crisis period, the short list of concerns below attests to the strength and flexibility of its operation overall.

- **Some operational bottlenecks were experienced** – largely due to the rapid reprogramming of funds and resulting procurement – yet these were in the main quickly and effectively overcome. Not having warehouse space in Fiji, at times the corridors and offices on the two floors in the building that UNDP occupies in downtown Suva (7th and 8th floors accessible by lift or narrow stairs) were loaded up with items such as chainsaws, shovels and wheel barrows.⁶⁸
- Although perhaps not affecting the pace of response, there was a need for more **clarity on issues such as the Activation of Fast Track**. The second CB meeting on 26 February refers to “Fast Track: RBAP to inform BMS of a request for extending current BMS Acceleration Package until 31 December 2016.” However, many of the team (operations and programme) learnt in the crisis response training that the concept of ‘fast track’ has been integrated into standard UNDP procedures and is no longer relevant.
- Although, as previously noted, UNDP's response may have served to build team strengths in some respects, there were clearly **challenges with the fact that the crisis took place in times of structural change**.⁶⁹ With the main implementation of changes ongoing between January and April 2016, TC Winston struck in the middle of the period on 20 February. Moving from the two business units of the MCO and Pacific Centre (PC) to a single Pacific Office (PO) in Fiji setup meant that **some roles were unclear** at critical times. In humanitarian cluster meetings it was known for two UNDP people to show up, each one representing a business unit of UNDP.
- **More operational support could have been lent from Suva to field teams**. Related to the noted potential improvements in programme response **integrating UNDP's crisis response into UNDP overall** would have benefited from direct operational support from Suva to field programmes. For example, field project teams also had to manage associated operational issues such as managing the payments for Cash for Work. Conversely, operations staff noted that project staff could have been more involved in clarifying specifications and actively engaging in the identification of suppliers for procurement.

⁶⁸ Preparedness plans now being discussed may move to identify options to store relief items or to have a vendor in charge of storing and delivering them as part of a contract.

⁶⁹ It is, however, the author's assessment, that UNDP was better to pursue the change at this time and not put any of it on hold.

5.3 Advocacy

What worked well?

- **Leadership:** With the RR/RC becoming HC for the third time, the application of experience and confidence in the HC role was evident. A balance seems to have been struck between representing and supporting the whole UNCT/humanitarian community and giving fair support to UNDP. The recent transformation of UNDP in the Pacific has also upgraded the DRR position to CD, which should provide necessary leadership in future crises.
- Due to the approach of UNDP, **good relationships were maintained with Government at all levels.** UNDP built upon many existing associations and promoted Government authority in the crisis response and recovery process. Today, relationships with Government remain good and UNDP largely has access at all levels – essential for engagement around resilience and development in Fiji and the region. The AAR explored if the crisis response provided an opportunity and actually yielded any gains in relationships. Although this seems to have applied for bi-lateral entities, bolstering their comprehensive renewed engagement with Fiji over the crisis period, UNDP's relationships remained steady.
- Success as noted in the paragraph above is not to be underestimated. Furthermore, the **good offices of UNDP (RR/RC)** and the **combined HC role** that the RR/RC assumed for six months, also **helped to moderate relationships overall between the Government and international humanitarian community.** Many humanitarian entities substantially and rapidly increased their presence in Fiji in response to TC Winston and some even initiated their presence with the crisis.
- **UNDP demonstrated a sense of urgency in terms of resource mobilization** for the crisis. As the timeline in this report depicts, along with the annexed CB minutes, a substantial, early effort was made by the PO, with support from HQ and RBAP, to approach donors with concept notes and funding proposals. The CB reinforced the learning that opportunities must be taken to seek commitment from donors within the first few days of the crisis. UNDP did this to a large degree but was ultimately unsuccessful – due to reasons discussed in Section 6 of this report.
- **UNDP demonstrated strategic thinking** in its approach to securing CERF funding. As had been learnt from TC Pam in Vanuatu and Tuvalu in 2015, where UNDP failed to secure any CERF funds, UNDP in Fiji combined forces with WFP and ILO and presented what were largely 'early recovery'-type needs under the food security cluster. By positioning DWM (removing and managing debris) as a core assistance for affected farmers to regain access to their land, the relevance of this approach was understood and some funding (US\$ 124,000) made available to UNDP. By doing so, UNDP also **demonstrated a practical example of integrating early-recovery action across sectors** – a central principle in UNDP's early recovery engagement in the cluster system.

- Despite some challenges discussed below, in terms of **media, UNDP succeeded in producing some personal stories and got messages out** thorough a range of media: articles, press releases, social media and blogs. Stand-by partners from MSB even contributed with blogs in which personal thoughts were balanced with highlighting UNDP and Government collaboration.⁷⁰ The two deployments of communications specialists to Fiji were of some use. Perhaps even more practical was the approach employed by project staff, in **‘taking local media’** with them to **Koro Island and Ra**. This helped ensure relatively good visibility of UNDP in local media. Also valuable was efforts local staff made to ‘tweet’ commentary and photos at the onset of the emergency, which led to significant early coverage for UNDP in international media outlets.

What could have worked better?

Early Recovery

- A consistent sentiment expressed from both within UNDP and outside was that the concept of **‘Early Recovery’ was not well articulated**. Despite the above-mentioned practical example of application within the food security cluster, overall “no clear strategy or concept” was promoted and some saw Early Recovery as an unwanted “add-on” and “drain on [humanitarian] resources.”
- At the Cluster Coordination level, even though many of the specific activities of UNDP were being appreciated, noted was the **lack of a clear “UNDP offer”** in terms of value to the Government-led, internationally-backed response. This point was raised by several even as UNDP worked with the Ministry of Agriculture to help extension officers quickly return and function in affected areas.⁷¹
- Partly as a function of the above, **‘Early Recovery’ was not positioned high in the flash appeal** (US\$ 0.9 million of US\$ 38.6 million sought). More strikingly and of concern is the number of people that the Early Recovery cluster proposed as being in need: 4,900, by far the lowest of any of the clusters that identified a caseload. Compare this with 350,000 in Health and 250,000 in WASH, from an advocacy point of view it would be hard to convince any investor that it was a priority. Unfortunately, systems are not yet in place to demonstrate the benefits (and thus beneficiaries) of Early Recovery being implemented through other sectors (which is exactly what UNDP did in Fiji).

⁷⁰ See 07 Apr 2016 Blog: *Hand in hand, we are stronger than Winston* by Tova Andersson. <http://www.asia-pacific.undp.org/content/rbap/en/home/blog/2016/4/7/In-Fiji-together-we-are-stronger-than-Winston.html>

⁷¹ Some assert that UNDP’s capacity in DWM, disaster recovery planning and coordination (with the PDNA), and support to the resumption of government services would have been a good offer if stated early and continuously. However, as discussed in section six (6) of this report, UNDP’s offer would have needed to be very robust and change the overall perception of the value of the UN.

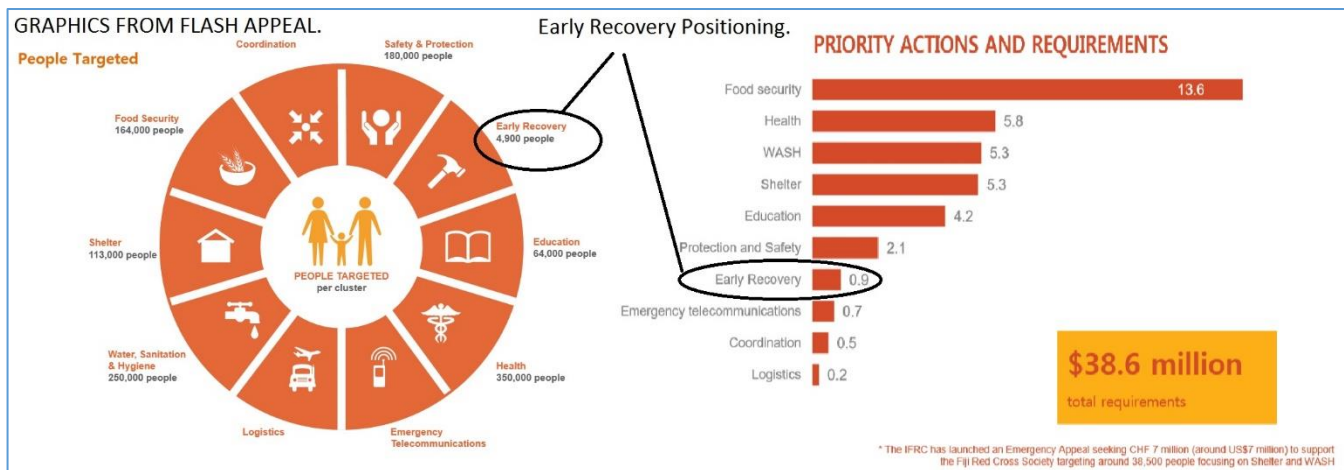


Fig. 3. Early Recovery within ten clusters of the TC Winston Flash Appeal. 4,900 people targeted. USD 900,000 sought.

Messaging and Advocacy overall

- **Government and development partners didn't understand roles and capacity of the UN.** The development community got to see the UN in action with the TC Winston response. Many emerged from it wondering how the UN works – and **who is in charge**. This especially applies to UNDP, with complex roles in crisis response, including coordination, and may have been compounded by the RC moving to an HC role. Some only learnt through the AAR process that UNDP was not a donor.
- Despite numerous human-interest stories being produced, along with some demonstration of the relevant work of UNDP in crisis response, **UNDP messages did not reflect the magnitude of the crisis or recovery needs**. Communications reviewed (12 of which are compiled and analysed in Annex F) tended to focus upon the successes of UNDP at project level, highlighting activities and achievements in the local context. Data on beneficiary numbers (if mentioned) and project funds noted were all very modest compared to the scale of the crisis. To be more effective as an advocacy tool, each message should have also dedicated a couple of sentences to the overall scale of the crisis in Fiji and the resources Government and partners needed to address.
- **Good initial efforts on resource mobilization** for crisis response and recovery **appear not to have been sustained** throughout the response. Some of this was due to no specific resource mobilization (RM) task force being in place or a long-term action plan developed – but moreover due to issues as presented in the discussion on “recovery and funding realities” in section six (6).
- Also of concern from the commencement of the review was that the **status of recovery from TC Winston remains unknown**. As the next section (6. Recovery and Funding Realities) attempts to address, a range of issues served to restrict the access of UNDP and other multi-lateral partners to even the data of the status of Fiji's recovery.

5.4 HQ and RH support

This sub-section examines the wide range of support functions of both UNDP HQ and UNDP's Regional Hub in Bangkok as graphically presented in the underlying band in 'Conceptual Framework' (Fig. 2). It includes: Policy setting and guidance; functioning of the Crisis Board and Crisis Response Standard Operating Procedure (SOP); deployment of First responders, SURGE, and standby partners; initial investment of HQ-disbursed seed funds, including Trac 1.1.3 (Cat 2) for assessment and coordination; and general support to resource mobilization at a higher level outside of the country and region.

What worked well?

- **Crisis Board meetings and unified HQ support worked very well.** The initially **frequent and comprehensively supportive nature** of meetings was appreciated by all. Many participants from the field noted that they quickly achieved clarity on expectations and HQ support functions – and that the meetings overall served to demonstrate a joined-up UNDP vision and commitment to action. The **8 November email of the CB chair was appreciated as providing a fitting summary and giving definitive closure** to UNDP's crisis response. (Minutes from all four CB meetings and the closing email are reproduced in Annex F of this report). The main deviations from UNDP's (unofficial yet largely functional) SOP for Immediate Crisis Response, as articulated in Fig. 1, were that: i. No exigency memo was produced and; ii. No Recovery Programme was endorsed by CB meeting no3 (or no. 4) as no agreement had been reached in Fiji with Government on the modalities of national recovery. An exigency memo, normally helps determine crisis response levels and aids the kick-starting crisis response actions by lining up strategic decisions by the Crisis Board in support of the CO. The memo was not used in Fiji as communication between the MCO/PC and CB were deemed to be sufficient, including documentation and justification for the release of financial and human resource support.
- Rapid **'First responder'** assistance, initially from the desk covering Fiji from the regional hub, was **central in ensuring much of the success** during the immediate phase of UNDP's crisis response. As this person was working in the region and was continually in close contact with the MCO/PO in Fiji, she arrived within a week and was immediately engaged in a range of productive management supporting the DRR and UNDP team (CSMT). Two additional first responders (arriving on 1 and 4 March) for recovery advising and communications, both with UNDP experience, were also much-appreciated contributions to the team.
- UNDP corporate arrangements with **Stand-by partners (SBPs)** were **essential contributions** to UNDP's response, providing key technical capacity that was otherwise missing from the CO team. There were **specific benefits in working with known individuals from SBPs** identified in UNDP's TC Pam response. Having demonstrated themselves to be compatible with UNDP and with proven skills, they were quickly confirmed as suitable when their names came up.

- As mentioned as an operational benefit above, the rapid deployment of a **UNDP Security Officer must be recognised as a function of the whole of UNDP approach to the crisis**. Costs for this deployment were covered by the UNDP Security Office (and do not appear in the table of contributions summarised in this report).
- **Significant funding was provided by HQ in a timely manner**. In addition to an approved US\$ 291,000 SURGE plan, by the third CB meeting on 4 March 2016, US\$ 250,000 had been released from BPPS for programmatic support and a further US\$ 100,000 from TRAC 1.1.3 for coordination, assessments, early-recovery frameworks and HC/RC support.

What could have worked better?

This sub-section is presented in terms of emerging concerns at strategic and policy levels relating to both the scale and positioning of UNDP's crisis response, 'early recovery' mandate; and the overall guiding policy and capacity for UNDP to engage in substantive post-crisis recovery programme. Many of these issues are discussed in context in the following section. What could have worked better was:

- **UNDP HQ's policy and guidance for engagement**, with a definitive offer of value, **in nationally-led recovery efforts was lacking**.⁷²
- As presented earlier, whilst initial efforts at fund-raising were substantial, it is **unclear on how much support to resource mobilization HQ (including RBAP and BERA) could have pursued**. The concept of the BPPS and Trac 1.1.3 contributions is to act as seed funding. In this case, very little leverage was achieved and HQ contributions became 80% of the crisis response.
- Although it appeared that UNDP was headed towards some engagement in Fiji's post TC Winston recovery programme, by the time of the last CB meeting on 16 March 2016, this hadn't eventuated. The degree of follow up to this issue is unclear. UNDP had deployed one of the first responders, a Senior Recovery Advisor, to the PDNA effort. Certainly some analysis and dialogue continued between the MCO/PO and HQ/RH – yet the **winding up of the formal supportive mechanism of the CB before confirming UNDP's substantive engagement in recovery may have been premature...** though it is recognised that the CB could be convened in support to a CO request. The CO and RH decided to continue liaison in a less formal way via email up to the closure of the crisis.⁷³

⁷² Addressing this appears as a specific recommendation in this report, yet the actual form of policy and practice guidance needs to be developed. In any case, it appears necessary from the onset of our crisis response

⁷³ See Annex E, consolidated CB meeting minutes, which also contains the final closure email from RBAP of 8 Nov. 2016.

6. Recovery and Funding Realities

This section is intended to shed light on issues affecting the positioning of UNDP in relation to Fiji's nationally-led recovery agenda and resource mobilization overall – essential considerations for drawing conclusions and making relevant recommendations. In summary, both the context, and the decisions UNDP made within it, are important.

Context:

- The Fijian Government has significant capacity. It prioritized, raised (and reprogrammed) resources, and continues to pursue a substantial recovery programme, managing related external support on its own terms.
- Recovery sectors were not a good fit with UNDP's in-country expertise. The priorities of recovery (private homes, public buildings, infrastructure, electricity networks), remained outside the scope of UNDP's in-country capacity - which are substantial in other areas such as detailed in table 4.
- A combination of political and economic priorities favoured bi-lateralism, meaning resources potentially available for the UN were scarce. Some UN agencies raised funds, yet only with ongoing donor-funded projects in specific sectors and in geographic areas of priority cyclone response.⁷⁴
- The Government had previous PDNA experience and several officials trained for such. However, in previous disasters, there was no history of using PDNA results for long-term recovery plans.^{75, 76} This also turned out to be the case in the TC Winston response.
- Thus, the PDNA did not lead to a recovery programme that UNDP could take part in. The MCO/PO dutifully identified and fielded a capable Senior Recovery Advisor to complement multi-lateral efforts on the PDNA. As a standard commitment of UNDP, encouraged by HQ, this effort was successful and the PDNA is known to be a very thorough, well compiled document. Yet the investment yielded little for UNDP and the international community as a whole (particularly as they are not privy to recovery-related data today). However, arguably, UNDP's investment in the PDNA did lead to funding for Fiji.

Internal CO-level UNDP capacity and decision making:

- Beyond offering support for the PDNA, UNDP was not able to assertively clarify an 'offer' to Government on what role it could play in national recovery – at least not in the terms that convinced Government. This was both a function of a lack of HQ policy guidance, and a lack of visible entry points within the national effort. All was compounded by UNDP not having ongoing programmatic

⁷⁴ Notwithstanding the above, some funding from key donors was made available to the UN. A key example is the US\$ 3.5 million UN Women received from Australia (DFAT) for the upgrading of municipal markets and facilities (for female market vendors) to withstand cyclones. The key parameters to accessing this funding was for it to be based on ongoing projects, relevant to the priorities of DFAT (education, health and women's empowerment), and relevant to the crisis response overall.

⁷⁵ UNDP 15 March 2016. SURGE plan. p.2

⁷⁶ Coincidentally, this month UNDP has drawn upon one of Fiji's PDNA-trained officials to support a light PDNA process in the Solomon Islands following earthquakes late in 2016. An example of regional capacity building.

activities in sectors related to the major recovery priorities of Government – infrastructure, schools and homes, or a strategic development partner (donor) lined up to back such an effort.

- UNDP did not seek additional staff to boost recovery engagement. The SURGE Plan approved the deployment of an Advisor, destined to support the RC/HC. This deployment was cancelled namely as there was no visible entry point for such work with Government. The ER cluster hadn't formed, Government was not amenable to the concept, and there was no clear fit with government sectors.⁷⁷
- UNDP teams were concentrating on the delivery of the CERF and reprogrammed funds – with a need to also ensure long-term development project delivery kept on track. (Fortunately, the response came early in the financial year).

Discussion

In Fiji, in response to TC Winston, the question of the state of recovery today is intriguing - both in terms of how the official framework for recovery is being managed and what the actual status of recovery is. UNDP itself, like most of the international community, has scant optics on either.⁷⁸ Concerns were heightened in December 2016 when Tropical Depression TD04F⁷⁹ set in over Fiji and produced three weeks of torrential rain.⁸⁰ Many wondered how numerous were the people remaining in tents or under tarpaulins, and what their condition was.⁸¹ No one seemed to know the answer.

Early on in the crisis response, UNDP intended to engage significantly with Fiji's recovery agenda:

- The first CB meeting noted the need for "Specific attention to be given for UNDP's longer-term strategic positioning and recovery... assessment and programming processes."
- A Senior Recovery Advisor was sought for "PDNA coordination and long-term recovery planning" and approved in the second CB meeting on 26 February 2016.⁸² This person arrived in early March and within a week was working from the Ministry of Finance, representing the UNCT with World Bank, ADB, SPC and Australia (DFAT) counterparts - all under an engaged, clear professional national lead in the Ministry of Finance's Strategic Planning Office.

⁷⁷ Some suggest that an ER advisor or an ER cluster coordinator were not of the right profile to implement the Surge plan and that a more specific recovery programme advisor could have been a better fit.

⁷⁸ Based on discussions within UNDP during this AAR.

⁷⁹ The weather event bringing heavy rain to Fiji and much of the Pacific was formally classified as Tropical Depression TD04F on 15 Dec. 2016. reliefweb.int/report/fiji/td04f-media-release-3-td04f-upgraded-tropical-depression.

⁸⁰ ABC News. 16 Dec. 2016. *Concerns for those still recovering from TC Winston as rain continues in Fiji*. Also personal concerns and discussions with UN colleagues and nationals at the time. Many roads were closed, along with Nausori airport, and bridges impassable. Needless to say, conditions for people yet to return to secure shelters would have been difficult.

⁸¹ Discussions in the final week of preparation for this report mentioned 500 – 700 families may still be living in tents as official figures, with some postulating that the figure may be much higher. In a statement issued on 19 February 2017, on the eve of the anniversary of the landfall of TC Winston, former Prime Minister Sitiveni Rabuka expressed concern about "those in tents because of TC Winston and TD04F [that] continue to suffer during the current heavy rains and wait for government assistance." <http://www.fijitimes.com/story.aspx?id=389956>

⁸² See Annex E, consolidated CB meeting minutes. The 16 April 2016 record noted the HC/RC considered it important to include Environment issues in the PDNA highlighting UNDP's potential strength with an existing large environment portfolio.

- By the fourth CB meeting on 16 April 2016, whilst overall timelines were unknown, the national Disaster Recovery Framework (DRF) and related pledging were soundly on the agenda. PDNA completion was imminent. Cabinet approval for the DRF was hoped for by 10 May - with an EU-backed pledging conference envisaged a week later. The CB noted that “UNDP positioning in implementation of the Recovery Framework will be critical.”⁸³

The PDNA was duly completed and reported to be of good quality, comprehensively assembled and in a timely manner. The DRF, however, began to lag in its pace of compilation and was never officially launched.⁸⁴ No pledging conference took place. So, what happened along the ‘road to recovery’?

Taking a step back to examine the national response to the crisis is important. With a ‘state of national disaster’ immediately called, the Government drew upon all its internal resources. National military forces and any available human resource (such as low-security prisoners) were dispatched for a first phase of clean up and control - maintaining curfews and ensuring safety with damaged roads and fallen power lines. The Prime Minister’s Office was actively engaged in the initial response, releasing funds for deliveries of basic food supplies to affected areas.⁸⁵ Overall relief coordination came together quickly and was led by the Director of the National Disaster Management Office (NDMO) under the Ministry of Rural and Maritime Development and Disaster Management. The Minister himself played an active role.

The national effort was quickly augmented by bi-lateral partners – with Fijian military command overseeing a joint operation. A rapid response from the Australian and New Zealand defence forces - on standby monitoring the cyclone in the region - brought considerable supplies, logistics capacity and personnel.⁸⁶ Naval vessels were of particular help in the outer islands of Lau and in Koro. ‘Oblique aerial photos’⁸⁷ taken by the Royal New Zealand Air Force (RNZAF) provided excellent detail on the extent of damage for much of Fiji’s coastline by the second day – allowing Government to define ‘hotspots’ for prioritizing and coordinating the response. New Zealand also provided high resolution satellite images to assist in assessments. Australian Defence Force (ADF) C17 and C130 aircraft delivered 520 tonnes of humanitarian supplies and equipment, with a further 60 tonnes on board HMAS Canberra – Australia’s naval flagship. “ADF engineers assisted with *early recovery* through repairing schools, medical centres

⁸³ Ibid.

⁸⁴ The author obtained what appears to be a final October 2016 DRF printed version (though some tables are missing). A Sept. 2016 version is available on line: http://reliefweb.int/sites/reliefweb.int/files/resources/DRF_Draft_6.pdf

⁸⁵ Substantial government deliveries were witnessed by the author in Tailevu province three days after the TC event.

⁸⁶ New Zealand alone had 120 engineering corps on the ground in Vanua Balavu for two months (conversation with NZ High Commissioner, 06 Feb. 2017). By 8 March 2016 there were 270 NZ Defence Force personnel in Lomaloma, Vanua Balavu (<http://www.radionz.co.nz/international/pacific-news/298341/nz-personnel-making-an-impact-in-remote-fiji-disaster-zone>).

⁸⁷ Photos taken from aircraft at an angle (not vertical) allow for a good recognition of the degree of damage in villages.

and critical infrastructure in affected communities.”⁸⁸ The People’s Republic of China quickly delivered tents and other humanitarian supplies to the value of US\$ 7 million.⁸⁹

The Fijian Government clearly demonstrated a capacity to manage its own affairs during the crisis – and consistently appealed to bi-lateral partners for direct support, rather than making resources available for multi-lateral partners. This stance solidified with recovery efforts.

Announcing a further month’s continuation of the state of national disaster on 21 March 2016, Government identified FJ\$ 100 million (US\$ 46.5 m) within its national budget and on 9 April and launched ‘Help for Homes’. The initiative used a voucher system for beneficiaries to withdraw building supplies from selected hardware outlets in order to rebuild their own homes.⁹⁰ The Fiji National Provident Fund (FNPF) also exceptionally released funds, and had made FJ\$ 277 million (US\$ 128 m) available to 170,000 member applicants by mid-June. With the PDNA completed in May, the ADB and World Bank both released US\$ 50 million in loans – largely for the rebuilding of shelters and schools.⁹¹

National recovery priorities, and Fiji’s chosen management of the response, were reinforced by bi-lateral partners; principally Australia, New Zealand and the People’s Republic of China – even though the European Union tops the list of contributions namely due to commitments in the sugar industry (see Annex H). A quick review of New Zealand’s post-TC Winston investments indicates support to numerous contracts for restoration of Fiji’s electrical transmission network. Work clearing large slips, repairing bridges and roads have increased. The rebuilding of schools is now firmly underway, prioritised as they have a dual function as evacuation centres for Fijian communities. Recovery in Fiji, in many respects, means infrastructure.

Also driving the preference of major donors for bi-lateralism is Fiji’s recent history. Prior to elections in 2014 and the restoration of post-coup democracy, Australia’s substantial aid to Fiji was primarily directed to, and delivered by, community groups and NGOs. Since 2014 Australia’s aid programme has been “reoriented towards working directly with Fiji government ministries, agencies, and the Fiji Parliament. In 2015-16, nine [9] Australian government agencies worked closely with their counterparts in Fiji, broadening and [conscientiously] deepening the bilateral relationship.”⁹² Annex H of this report

⁸⁸ Direct quote from ADF info graphic <http://dfat.gov.au/aid/topics/investment-priorities/building-resilience/humanitarian-preparedness-and-response/tc-winston/Pages/default.aspx>

⁸⁹ See Annex H to this report for summary (source: ADB).

⁹⁰ ‘Help for homes’ employed an electronic card supplied free from Vodafone. Beneficiaries were identified for benefits of up to FJD 7,000 in supplies if their homes were destroyed. Whilst practical and innovative in some respects, the programme ran into difficulties with a general shortage of building supplies in country and some suppliers accepting funds but not being able to deliver goods. A general lack of knowledge and owner skills and capacity to rebuild also hampered the effectiveness of the programme – although it is believed that some substantial delivery has been achieved (this review was unable to locate data to further substantiate its status).

⁹¹ ‘Emergency’ loans on special conditions. Twenty year terms with a five year grace period and 1.3% annual interest thereafter.

⁹² DFAT Sept. 2016. <http://dfat.gov.au/about-us/publications/Documents/fiji-appr-2015-16.pdf>

shows the approximate split of the first USD 100 million applied to the crisis response in Fiji – with a strong (three quarters) preference for bi-lateral or tied aid.

With a reduced appetite for multi-lateral support in Fiji, the invisibility of the DRF dealt a further blow to UNDP's chances of engagement in national recovery efforts. The planned DRF launch and associated pledging conference, that the EU was keen to support, never took place and are no longer talked about.⁹³

Adding to the complexity was the progressive transfers of crisis management and recovery responsibility within Government. The initial response had commenced with a clear command from the Prime Minister's Office and the NDMO. Yet when the PDNA and recovery plans were being formulated, with the crisis-response winding up, authority shifted to the Ministry of Finance – which itself transitioned to become the Ministry of Economy on 1 August 2016.

All multi-lateral PDNA support was focussed on the Strategic Planning Office (SPO) within the Ministry – where UNDP and partners invested staff. Today, the SPO plays some role, but actual resources for national recovery are being directed from the Ministry's Budget Section with delegated responsibility for delivery to relevant sectoral (social-service) ministries. A 'Construction Implementation Unit' (CIU) within the Ministry of Economy oversees contractual arrangements for rebuilding work. Indeed, the clearest public articulation today of national recovery intentions are within Fiji's 2016/17 national budget– with 'Help for Homes' and substantial school reconstruction clearly visible as 'cyclone response.' Many such line items, however, are marked 'R' for 'under requisition' - dependent on the availability of funds.⁹⁴ There is otherwise no public recognition of the DRF or reporting against recovery progress.

Another take on the non-inclusion of the UN in national recovery directly reflects on the behaviour (real or perceived) of the UN in the initial crisis response. Although some point to the positive attributes of OCHA's office in Suva, many new staff from OCHA and other humanitarian organizations flew in. With well-meaning exuberance, some held fast to 'humanitarian principles' and were clearly impatient with the pace of progress and the 'national sovereignty' being demanded. In this regard one must also consider the focus on respect and deference in Fijian culture.

The Government was initially reluctant to sign the UN's Flash Appeal, yet finally did so with some persuasion from the HC. Some officials seemed concerned that the funds were only destined for the UN itself⁹⁵ and, moreover, that the appeal could undermined Government's own efforts to attract response funding. However, there was also appreciation in Government for the international humanitarian effort

⁹³ No announcement was made. During interviews some remarked ... "oh yes... I remember that, the DRF. What happened to it?"

⁹⁴ Republic of Fiji, Budget Estimates 2016/2017 – as presented to Parliament (May 2016). Most cyclone-related lines are marked 'R' denoting 'Under Requisition' requiring a warrant signed by the Minister of Finance [now Minister of Economy] anticipating funding through aid. Where the aid involves cash grant; these funds will be released only upon receipt of aid funds into consolidated revenue.

⁹⁵ Although mostly directed through the UN, nearly 60 % of flash appeal funds went to implement government projects; 10 percent to national NGOs; 13 percent to international NGOs; and 18 [percent] to UN agencies. Source: Email from OCHA 27 Feb. 2017.

– and the state of natural disaster declared had allowed for foreign assistance, including from the UN and international NGOs.⁹⁶

Specific concerns were also expressed over the suitability and commitment of UN and IFI staff in Fiji. Some support to the NDMO was provided by the UN, yet the staff assigned there never stayed long and they were not always able to perform tasks requested of them.⁹⁷ Whilst inputs leading up to release of the PDNA were appreciated, the departure of the World Bank’s support team quickly thereafter also signalled a questionable multi-lateral commitment to the road ahead. Completion of the PDNA had triggered the release of World Bank and ADB loans to Government: boxes had been ticked and mutual objectives met in one respect.

Since then, Government has been proceeding progressively with deliberate recovery efforts - yet the actual status of this and the framework being used to monitor progress and gaps is unknown. By late June 2016, an estimated US\$ 340 million (coincidentally, about the value of the DRF) of response and recovery activity had taken place or was ongoing with national resources and contributions of bi-lateral partners under the control of Government.⁹⁸ At the same time the UN’s flash appeal was closing, having raised only US\$ 22 million - 56% of the US\$ 38.6 million sought.

Come the expiration of extension of the state of national disaster on 20 April, there was no formal justification for a continuation of additional international assistance. And none was requested.

So, all-in-all, the classic ‘crisis response – recovery gap’ has risen again. As discussed in the conclusion of this report, UNDP’s absence from the Fijian cyclone recovery scene is not all negative. Considering the summary documented in the preceding pages, programmatic gaps are perhaps of a lesser concern, as the Fijian Government is delivering substantial relief and recovery assistance. A major concern, however, is the persisting ‘information gap’ on the status of those affected by TC Winston in Fiji today.

⁹⁶ Section 32. (1) of Fijis National Disaster Act (1998) allows for requests to the Minister for Foreign Affairs to call for foreign assistance. sub-clause ((2) allows NGOs to also request international assistance from their respective international organizations.

⁹⁷ Example was given of two incomplete attempts to compile a review of the TC Winston Response on behalf of the NDMO.

⁹⁸ Estimated by the author of this AAR. A figure ADB agreed with as indicative of the scale of resources available to Government for response and recovery in Fiji at the time.

7. Conclusions and Recommendations

7.1 Concluding Comments

As presented in section 5 above, there are many successes of UNDP's response to TC Winston in Fiji.

Programme inputs were relevant, and operational support forthcoming. Leadership, strategic thinking, and advocacy, all played significant, beneficial roles. The totality of UNDP's temporary support structures in crisis proved to be functional. The CB, as a high-level decision making body, performed admirably. The in-county CRT, comprised of CO staff and first responders / SURGE team and heads of programmes, operations and communications, also worked well. Members of the Crisis Management Support Team (CMST) consistently backed the response.

Underwriting UNDP's functionality were a combination of capacities in the MCO/PO in Fiji, and clear unified backing in leadership, policy, and human and financial resources. CB meetings promoted clarity and accountability, and ensured a coordinated systematic approach. Meetings were frequent, and participants were probed for clarity in the 'asks' from the field. The CB also demonstrated that it was clearly accountable up to the Administrator, commiserate with the interest an L2 response warrants.

In Fiji, UNDP stepped up to fill its seat at the humanitarian table – a place largely reserved through its commitment to early recovery in the global cluster system. And UNDP performed well. Though strategically exploring food security-related ER action, some humanitarian funding was gained. UNDP's inputs to the inter-agency response were timely, relevant and comprehensive - appreciated by communities, government and the humanitarian community alike. With a solid people focus, and a crisis response squarely founded in field work, in many respects UNDP demonstrated how the humanitarian-development nexus should be addressed.

With this response, UNDP further demonstrated its relevance in crises. It proved it could adapt quickly, and that procedures and internal support systems can cope with a rapid onset of new challenges. The organization's response to TC Winston also attests to the practicality of UNDP's policy and (draft) *Corporate SOP for Immediate Crisis Response*, along with associated HQ support mechanisms. Although SOPs were not followed to the letter,⁹⁹ a coherent 'One UNDP' approach was clearly demonstrated by the CB and the CMST. Related financial and human resource support worked almost seamlessly.

However, UNDP's success is overshadowed by some concerns:

1. With a total crisis response value of US\$ 1 million (80% of which was internally funded), the scale of UNDP's contribution was modest viz overall needs;
2. UNDP's response was not solidly linked to previous, ongoing and future in-country work;

⁹⁹ Eg. No 'exigency memo' was prepared. Surge plan was light. CRT wasn't formed.

3. Apart from providing a HC, UNDP did not achieve a significant coordination role in the crisis, be it in general or through a functional 'Early Recovery' cluster, and;
4. UNDP did not achieve a role in influencing or engaging in any aspect of national recovery.

All together it was a good UNDP response of some complexity – one that can be learnt from to improve UNDP's work in Fiji, the Pacific, and globally in the future. This review exercise has also shed some important light on contextual factors that influence UNDP's overall performance. One could contend that UNDP should have fielded more staff, considerably expanded response projects, sent in high-level advocates from HQ, engaged partners to a fuller extent, and been more assertive with Government for a role in recovery. However, an appreciation of the context also points to the rationale for UNDP in Fiji making the decisions and acting to the extent that it did.

In many ways, the outcome was pre-determined. It wasn't internal UNDP decision making that led to it, but rather the context, that led UNDP to realize there were limits to its potential crisis response and recovery engagement. The most important objective was being relevant at the time, and then getting back to core business – which is largely about helping Pacific peoples become more resilient to disasters.

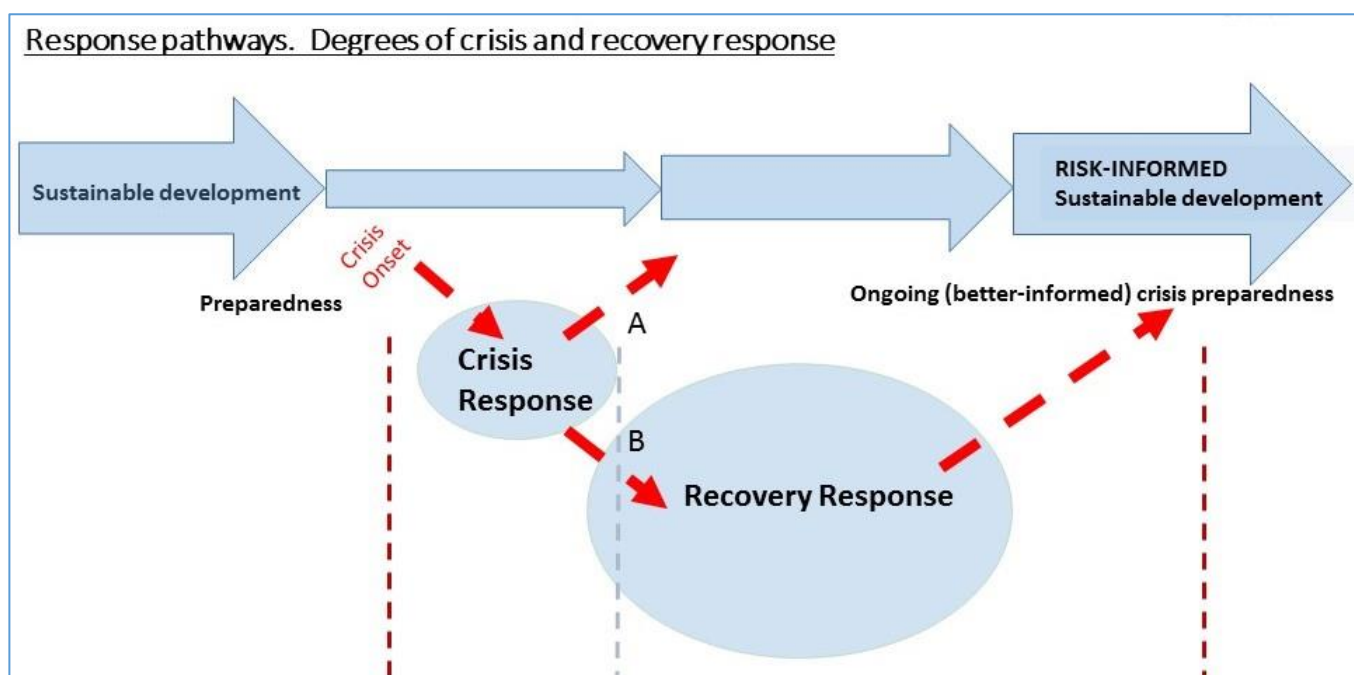


Fig. 4. Response pathways. Crisis response and possible (but not automatic) UNDP recovery programming

Fig. 4 above is based on the Conceptual Framework for the AAR (Fig. 2, page 18), and represents conversations emerging within the UNDP PO in Fiji in the later stages of the review - which included helping the office strategize and articulate recovery for future crises. In response to TC Winston, UNDP ended up on a 'pathway' demonstrated by arrow 'A', rapidly returning a focus to ongoing development programming without entering into substantive recovery.

The absence of a functional recovery framework, as discussed in section 6 above, precluded UNDP's involvement in national recovery. Without the DRF, the pathway marked 'B' was simply not open - not for any multi-lateral entity. UNDP could not pursue recovery work in any aspect: neither in supporting national coordination, nor programmatically, nor for any amount of resource mobilization for recovery.

Future strategic discussions in UNDP, therefore, need to explore what would need to be done to ensure an opening – what preparedness work, relationship building and 'value offers' need to be clarified before-hand. This is likely to build upon UNDP's engagement in the PDNA process, but more actively engaged with IFIs as mentioned in concluding comments below.

Overall, considering UNDP's crisis response work in the Pacific since floods in the Solomon Islands in 2014, and TC Pam in 2015, a clear evolution of progress is evident. TC Winston was a case where UNDP couldn't afford to remain disengaged from the crisis response. By committing as it did, even if the metrics of success appear to be modest from a distance, the benefits of being a partner to the Fijian people and authorities through thick and thin will, over time, pay inestimable dividends.

7.2 Recommendations

7.2.1 Recommendations for the Pacific Office in Fiji

Although this AAR studied UNDP's response to TC Winston in Fiji, considering that the PO has a multi-country remit, recommendations apply to the Pacific in general. With the likelihood of another such crisis in Fiji or the region being high, some immediate actions are needed at country level:

- **Complete simplified but functional guidelines for crisis response and recovery** for the office (at sub-regional level): guidelines that reflect corporate SOPs and account for local realities.
- **Complete specific crisis preparedness plans** for each country, progressively once SOPs in place.
- **Ensure regular updating and refreshing of staff around local SOPs and preparedness plans.** It is envisaged that this could be a light process once plans and systems are established. Plans should be revisited twice per year – and certainly each October prior to the TC season.
- **Ensure all ongoing or future donor negotiations explore the possibility of creating greater flexibility for realignment in times of crisis response and recovery.** Programmes such as risk-resilience, climate change adaptation, environment, governance, and economic empowerment, all with strong gender elements, should have a significant capacity to contribute to crisis response

in times of need.¹⁰⁰ Geographical targeting and fund reprogramming in case of a crisis should be foreseen and discussed in advance with donors.¹⁰¹

- **Consider what types of UNDP project could be more easily adapted to crisis response and proactively design future projects with this in mind.** Over time build up UNDP's project portfolio aiming for a high degree of re-programmability, or receptivity to the addition of funds in times of crisis.¹⁰² Donor mapping should also be pursued in earnest on a continual basis.
- **Engage and brief with Government partners beforehand on UNDP's required mechanisms** for engaging – such as with formalised prodocs that normally require a Government signature.
- **Consider arrangements for easier access to humanitarian supplies...** especially locally. Whilst this AAR stops short of recommending that UNDP maintains stocks of commonly used tools for DWM (chainsaws, wheel barrows etc.) and other early-recovery activities, it would be worth examining further lessons from the procurement of these items in Fiji in response to TC Winston. Pre-arranged agreements with suppliers may be good to keep updated.
- **Analyse and maintain a local network of potential first responders** – and keep track of experienced national staff. With deployments to the Pacific being expensive, work on the capacity of regionally-based assets.
- **Analyse how to support volunteerism in Fiji.** Fijian society is based on the mobilization of communities. UNDP needs to consider how it could better promote volunteerism, in normal times and those of crisis. This could include national UNVs.
- **With HQ support, and ideally with development partner-backing, assess the benefits of risk-resilience work in terms of leading to reduced requirements for crisis-response overall.** This would make an important contribution to UNDP's work in the risk-resilience, preparedness, response, recovery, development continuum. This would need to be done in conjunction with academic institutions and lead on from important initial work such as Ingrid Johnston's 2014 study of the relationships between relief expectations and local resilience in the north of Fiji.¹⁰³
- **Examine where UNDP's support to innovation and private sector partnerships could be better tapped, and 'marketed' as a UNDP comparative advantage in crisis response and recovery.** Considering that UNDP also houses UNCDF's PFIP, as promoting private sector financial and

¹⁰⁰ The actual format of this needs to be developed. Potentially this could be a dedicated output or a set of activities in project documents. It could also relate to overall UNDP positioning such as with the UNDAF, and in related CPDs.

¹⁰¹ The impression garnered from consultations with donors during this review was that they would not be averse to this sort of thinking and positioning – as long as it didn't tie funds up unused (eg. as in contingency) and if all remained within their priority substantive and geographical areas.

¹⁰² The aforementioned example of UN Women being in a position to receive considerable crisis-response and recovery funds should be replicated in UNDP.

¹⁰³ Johnston (2014)

insurance services, as well as the innovative use of technology, there could be significant potential for UNDP to develop this as a crisis and recovery-relevant mechanisms. The presence of a UNDP-OCHA supported *Connecting Business Initiative network* in Fiji and in the Pacific is an additional element to take into consideration for crisis preparedness, response and recovery.

- **Engage with Government and development partners in Fiji on mutual understanding.** Opportunities in this regard could relate to upcoming UNDAF planning and discussions around the Framework for Resilient Development in the Pacific (FRDP).
- **Analyse and clarify cross-team programming in terms of resilience and recovery - in broader terms beyond programming for a crisis-response.** Getting cross-team programming right would increase chances to influence Government-led national recovery in the future.

7.2.2 Recommendations for UNDP

- **Complete UNDP's corporate SOP for immediate crisis response, confirm endorsement** and make available on the intranet – but clearly situate the crisis-response and recovery within a framework of UNDP's ongoing in-country development presence, as the conceptual framework in this exercise has endeavoured to do.
- **Study and provide clear policy and guidance on UNDP's engagement in recovery.** This needs to include an analysis and justification for continued participation in the PDNA process, how to practically engage in recovery-related information gathering during a crisis¹⁰⁴, and guidance to COs on how strategize if a government chooses not to finalizing PDNAs and pursue recovery. The transition from response to recovery should be done more formally, with the SURGE plan and UNDP recovery documents providing a solid foundation for monitoring progress.
- **Provide guidance for UNDP's in-country and external messaging in crisis and recovery situations.** Guidance needs to include senior level strategic messaging – and whilst personal stories and project level facts are important, portraying the scale of crisis impacts and human need should be the overarching goal.
- **Continue the model of crisis response training with active preparedness planning** as demonstrated by the CRU/BPPS team in Suva on 16-20 January 2017.
- **Embrace the re-programming of funds as a bona-fide measure of success for UNDP in crises.** Whilst a strategic approach to the CERF (and lots of work) may yield modest results, internal reprogramming of funds links crisis response to longer-term development commitments, and can

¹⁰⁴ Some respondents were concerned with demands on a crisis-hit CO to include recovery indicators and targets, and detail long-term recovery activities in project documents, when requesting initial seed funding at the time of immediate response.

potentially yield much more. It also enforces links between the responders themselves and staff associated with longer-term programming in country.¹⁰⁵

- **Conduct exit interviews with outgoing first responders, SBPs and other response staff.** These could simply be in the form of the annexed interview questions. MSB's paper on lessons learned (Annex H) is helpful. These interviews would assist in a more thorough compiling of AARs and would capture sentiments closer to the time.

A note on UNDP's overall strategy in crisis situations.

This review has once again pointed to the struggle UNDP has as a humanitarian actor. Clearly there is a significant rationale for being involved in response to crises – just as this review has justified UNDP's interventions in Fiji. However, UNDP is largely trying to approach crises from a group of practice areas dominated by humanitarians. UNDP has long fought to maintain the ER cluster – and this should not be given up. Yet, as this review has also demonstrated, the recovery dimension has again been elusive. With the current UNDP / EU / World Bank agreement already underway, perhaps a better approach would also require UNDP to get closer to IFIs and approach recovery from this perspective. However, this route would also be challenging and, as with humanitarian funding, also come up against a structural gap in global financial mechanisms.¹⁰⁶ Some innovative, convincing, strategic partnership work is sorely needed – lest the well-known recovery gap will prevail well into UNDP's future.

8. Annexes

- J. References
- K. Terms of Reference for the AAR exercise
- L. List of interviewees
- M. Summary of Questions / Areas of Enquiry
- N. Crisis Board meeting minutes
- O. Analysis of UNDP articles and messages
- P. MSB lessons learned summary paper
- Q. Estimates of funding sources, first US\$ 100 million to Fiji's TC Winston response
- R. Notes on Fiji's Disaster Recovery Framework (DRF)

¹⁰⁵ The specific format of this needs to be determined. It could include a dedicated output or a set of activities in the project documents – but, as noted, funds should not be tied up in contingency allowances. Using existing project documentation would also help HQ swiftly channel funds from UNDP's 'funding window' on emergency development for response and recovery.

¹⁰⁶ Just as CERF funds largely target 'life saving' activities, and thus become difficult for UNDP to justify access to, PDNA-related / recovery funding is usually channeled from partners such as the EU directly to the World Bank / other IFIs as part of larger ongoing development commitments. UNDP would also be challenged to take a lead within this context.

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Annex A

References are grouped by subject area. Footnotes in text refer to author date relating to references below. Sometimes a relevant link is also embedded in the footnote.

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After Action Review of the Crisis Response to Tropical Cyclone Winston, 2016**Background on Tropical Cyclone Winston**

On 20 and 21 February 2016, Category 5 Severe Tropical Cyclone (TC) Winston cut the path of destruction across Fiji. The Cyclone was one of the most severe ever to hit the South Pacific: Over 40 people were confirmed dead and an estimated 350,000 people living in the cyclone's path have been affected. The Cyclone caused widespread damage in all four divisions of the country – Eastern, Northern, Western and Central. The hardest hit areas were the Lau group and Lomaiviti groups in the Eastern Division, Rakiraki and Tavua in Western Division, Taveuni and Cakaudrove in Northern Division.

In view of the emergency, the Fiji Government requested assistance from international partners to deal with the situation. The National Disaster Management Office (NDMO) took the lead in coordinating efforts and activated National and Divisional Emergency Operations Centers (EOCs). Fiji national clusters were tasked to identify specific needs and working in cooperation with international and national partners. Shelter, health, food, water, sanitation and hygiene, education and protection were identified as the most urgent needs for the affected population.

Within UNDP, a dedicated Crisis Board and Crisis Management [Support] Team were established soon after the cyclone landed. The first Crisis Board meeting held on 22 February designated the Winston as a UNDP Level 2 crisis. The second Crisis Board meeting decided on a light SURGE planning process to develop an integrated programmatic and operational plan for an initial period of three months, which was extended to 6 months later on.

Since early 2016, UNDP is in the process of finalizing its new Crisis Response Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) as well as some of its tools for early recovery programming called crisis response packages. TC Winston L2 crisis was part of the very initial testing ground for its newly designed SOP and the crisis response packages – particularly the one on emergency livelihoods through community infrastructure, and debris/solid waste management crisis.

In this context, and as per corporate procedures corresponding to this magnitude of crisis, UNDP would like to conduct an After Action Review (AAR) exercise in order to obtain a comprehensive assessment of UNDP's response to TC Winston, gather facts and perceptions related to UNDP's response and further inform the continuous enhancements of UNDP's crisis response systems, tools and processes. Key learnings from this review may be shared with partners as a part of collective learnings and shall serve as a basis towards the improvement of the timeliness and effectiveness of UNDP response to emergencies resulting from disasters due to natural hazards.

Objective and Scope of the AAR

The objective of the AAR is to examine the performance of UNDP with respect to the immediate response to TC Winston, and highlight lessons learned that would help strengthen the functioning, performance and efficiency of UNDP response to disasters, including elements pertaining to UNDP's corporate and country level programmatic and operational response; UN and interagency coordination; contribution to PDNA and recovery processes. The AAR will draw forward looking recommendations for the corporate crisis preparedness and response tools in view of their application to future crisis response situations. The AAR exercise will address directly or indirectly the following areas:

Overall Response

Examine the UNDP's response in the context of an L2 crisis with special emphasis on compliance with crisis response systems and processes (e.g. SOP) at global, regional and country level. This includes i) timeliness and effectiveness of strategic decisions

and actions by decision makers and other key stakeholders in the organization in order to respond to the crisis; ii) internal communication and coordination flows within UNDP to support the CO's efforts to respond to the crisis; iii) timeliness and effectiveness to quickly scale up UNDP Pacific Island Center (PIC) capacity to undertake immediate crisis response activities and pose the foundations for recovery;

Review UNDP's overall preparedness for response [CO, Regional, global] including the decision-making processes and their efficiency in the context of corporate response - with the view of further informing the finalization of the SOPs for UNDP's immediate crisis response.

Examine UNDP's ability to take on a "whole of UNDP" approach to the response and recovery efforts;

Assess how UNDP technical and programmatic expertise was leveraged during the TC Winston response;

Programmatic Response

Review the application of relevant UNDP's Crisis Response Packages' approach and elements.

Review the timeliness and pertinence of UNDP's recovery programme formulation and the choices that were made in terms of programme priorities; the reasons why those choices were made; and overall programmatic performance in the six months following the onset of the crisis;

Review what and how programmatic responses have laid the foundation for long-term recovery, including UNDP engagement in the PDNA process.

Examine whether adjustments were made to the existing country programme in response to the cyclone (including the identification of new programmes);

Draw lessons on the sustainability of initial UNDP programmatic activities and on the initial positioning by UNDP to have in place programme activities aimed at responding to the crisis and supporting recovery;

Examine the role SURGE Advisors played in positioning UNDP to respond to the crisis and support recovery actions, programme development and implementation, programme realignment and resources mobilization;

Analyze the added value provided by the SURGE Advisors in the elaboration and delivery of programmes at the Country Office level;

Examine the collaboration between the experts deployed under the SURGE modality and the Programmatic staff in country, at global level and in the Regional Hub;

Operational Response

Review the timeliness and effectiveness of the overall response operation and the compliance and application of the SOPs and decision-making processes. This part of the review will focus on country, regional and HQ level responses, in addition to the interaction between these dimensions of the response;

Review the efficiency and effectiveness of immediate crisis response Standard Operating Procedures (SOP), as well as analyze their application in the context of the response. This includes but is not limited to the application of Fast Track procedures, rapid response processes and the operations elements of the relevant crisis response packages (financing, deployments, recruitment, procurement, etc.);

Review the relevance and timeliness of the SURGE work plan, and quality of SURGE deployments, including UNDP Stand-by partners, and management of SURGE advisors in country;

Examine the operational bottlenecks and constraints faced by the CO in terms of both operations and programme implementation;

UN and Interagency Coordination:

The effectiveness and adequacy of UNDP's engagement with the broader humanitarian action. Including a review of:

The extent of UNDP's coordination and cooperation with key humanitarian partners on the ground;

UNDP's leadership of the Early Recovery (ER) approach on the ground in supporting recovery and UNDP capacity to attract partners and resources to the approach;

Clarity of UNDP's role and actions vis-à-vis other partners, including but not limited to other clusters, IFIs, and NGOs;

UNDP's ability to link immediate early recovery to longer term recovery efforts;

UNDP's support to Government coordination capacities and UNDP's engagement in the wider planning processes for recovery with the government, IFIs and other key stakeholders.

UNDP's ability to build synergies and mainstream the recovery agenda in the needs assessment processes (such as MIRA and PDNA) and humanitarian funding instruments;

Communication and Resource Mobilization:

Examine the timeliness and effectiveness of communication, including relationship with media, and resource mobilization efforts;

Review UNDP's level of success in mobilizing funds from humanitarian funding sources, including but not limited to Flash Appeal and CERF Rapid Response Grant. Assess the total amount of the resources actually mobilized for the recovery programme against the SURGE plan and analyze effectiveness and challenges of resource mobilization.

Examine internal and external factors that impacted donor funding decisions, identifying areas for improvement.

Assess donor response to the UNDP programme, identifying gaps and areas for improvement;

Assess donor response to the overall ER agenda and UNDP leadership of the ER cluster;

Deliverables

The review will cover UNDP's response to the cyclone and will focus on the immediate crisis response period of six months starting from the onset of the crisis on 20th February 2016. The review cover UNDP HQ, regional presence in Bangkok and the UNDP Pacific Office in Fiji (PIC) as well as all aspects of UNDPs response and its role in the interagency arenas.

The recommendations will have a forward-looking view, with aim to identifying best practices and innovations that can be systematized, as well as practices that need to be avoided in the future. It will also define areas for further investment and improvement in the response. In addition the ARR will provide:

A work plan with methodology and timeline for the AAR exercise based on the elements outlined in the objective and scope section of the ToR that will be prioritized with UNDP

- A timeline with an overview of facts and events;
- An overview of recommendations implemented / not implemented from past AARs, if any;
- An inception report on the initial findings from the desk review;
- A draft report on best practices, lessons learned and recommendations, focusing on key issues as highlighted in objectives above;
- A forward looking Action Plan for implementing recommendations with a focus on operationalizing the new corporate SOP for immediate crisis response and relevant UNDP crisis response packages, and UNDP's role in transcending the humanitarian-development divide in a post-disaster context;
- A final report on best practices, lessons learned and recommendations, focusing on key issues as highlighted in objectives above;
- A two pager document summarizing the key findings and recommendations of the AAR exercise;
- A debriefing meeting with Suva colleagues as well as a multi-stakeholder sharing of the findings and recommendations, such as a presentation to key UNDP stakeholders from UNDP PIC, Bangkok and New York (done remotely).

Methodology, Timeline and Travel

An independent contractor will be recruited to conduct the After action review. He/she will report to the Crisis Response Unit (CRU) Rapid Response and Preparedness Team who will oversee the day-to-day management of the team, with support from the Crisis Coordination Team (Asia Pacific, Arab States and ECIS) and the Regional Bureau for Asia and the Pacific (RBAP). The final report will be presented to RBAP and CRU for final endorsement.

Timeline for the review will be December 2016-January 2017.

The consultancy will be home-based. Information will be gathered remotely from primary and secondary sources. This includes desk reviews, key informant interviews with central and regional bureaus involved, the country office, deployed personnel, but also partners and other stakeholders. Final presentation of findings (one for CO and one for HQ/Regional Hub) will also be organised remotely.

Description of Responsibilities :

Under the direct supervision of the Programme Specialist (CRU Rapid Response and Preparedness Team), and in consultation with CRU Crisis Response Coordination Team (Asia Pacific, Arab States and ECIS) as well as RBAP, the consultant for the AAR exercise will:

- Lead the AAR exercise from preparation to final delivery in close collaboration with CRU, RBAP and the PIC Office.
- Lead the development of questionnaire, methodology, interview schedule and work plan for the AAR.
- Gather and review all the necessary documents related to the Global, Regional and Country level response, including relevant procedures and practices.
- Draft an inception report on initial findings, including an overview of recommendations implemented / not implemented from past AARs, and an overview of the facts and events.
- Lead the consultations processes related to the AAR, including preparatory meetings, surveys, focus group discussions, debriefings and final report presentation by reaching out, liaising and coordinating with all relevant stakeholders.
- Produce a draft AAR report, compile and address comments that arise from the draft report internal circulation.
- Produce a final and consolidated AAR report, a two pager document summarizing the key findings and recommendations, as well as a forward looking Action Plan for implementing recommendations for submission to the UNDP CRU and RBAP.
- Facilitate a multi- stakeholder workshop to present the AAR findings and recommendations to Both CO as well as HQ/Regional Hub colleagues.

Respondents – and interview timetable

ANNEX C

	Name / Email	Title	Bur.	D/S	Crisis Role	Role in TC Winston Response (funding)	Interview Status
	UNDP Pacific Office (PO) in Fiji						
1	Osnat Lubrani <osnat.lubrani@one.un.org>	RC/HC/RR		Fiji	CB	Lead in UN Country response	In touch.
2	Akiko Fujii <akiko.fujii@undp.org>	Deputy RR (DRR)		Fiji (Now Vietnam)	CMST	UNDP PO focal point for response	Wed. 11 Jan 1530 – by skype
3	Bakhodir Burkhanov bakhodir.burkhanov@undp.org	CD MCO (incl. Fiji) – and Regional Policy chief.		Fiji (since Jul 2016)		New CD – largely after response	Met Dec. 2016. Plan also later in Jan. 2016
4	Sonja Bachmann sonja.bachmann@undp.org	PDA.. close advisor to the RR/RC		Fiji		PDA- but actively involved in some response projects	Continuous
5	Asenaca Ravuvu <asenaca.ravuvu@undp.org>	Programme Officer		Fiji	CMST	Now heads IRMU	Met
6	Kevin Petrini <kevin.petrini@undp.org>	Team leader RSD team Regional Policy Specialist		Fiji		AAR Focal point in Fiji	Met Dec. 2016. Briefed 09 Jan. Ongoing
7	Winifereti Nainoca winifereti.nainoca@undp.org	Worked on how to re-programme funds		Fiji			9 Jan. 2016 1430
8	Vasiti Vuiyasawa Vasiti.vuiyasawa@undp.org	Worked on how to re-programme funds				Identified reprogramming potn. In projs for Winifereti	Added to above 9 Jan.
9	Asif Chida asif.chida@undp.org .	Team leader for inclusive growth (IG)		Fiji		Worked on the PDNA	11 Jan.
10	Patrick Tuimalealiifano patrick.tuimalealiifano@undp.org	Deputy team leader IG		Fiji		Had a youth prog. CfW debris clear. (US\$50,000)	Consulted during training
11	Alifereti Bulivou 9925811 alifereti.bulivou@undp.org	Project Manager for our TC Winston project		Fiji		Funded by BPPS (US\$250,000)	Met 23 Jan. Cafe
12	Moortaza Jiwani < moortaza.jiwani@undp.org >;	PRRP Programme Manager		Fiji		Provided inputs through the prog. / led dev of CERF prop.	13 Jan.
13	Manoa Malani 3227518 manoa.malani@undp.org	PRRP– National Programme Officer for Fiji		Fiji		Provided “face” of UNDP to government counterparts	Several times
14	Elena Wakolo elena.wakolo@undp.org	Operations team leader		Fiji			11 Jan.
	SURGE and Stand-by partners (SBP) to UNDP Fiji in 2016 #	Role				Funding / Time-frame	
	First Responders						
15	Naoko Takasu <naoko.takasu@undp.org>	Programme Management Specialist for TC Winston.				First Responder 29 Feb. – 19 Mar. 2016.	Helpful with docs. Done. Skype. Several

16	Arnoldus Gijsbertus (Noud) Leenders <agleenders@gmail.com>	Senior Recovery Advisor for TC Winston.				First Responder 1 Mar. – 30 Jun 2016.	In frequent touch in Suva.
17	Romain Desclois redesclois@hotmail.com	Communications Specialist for TC Response				First Responder. 3 weeks only 04 – 22 Mar. 2016	Skype 25 Jan.
	SBP						
18	Camille Laude camille.laud@gmail.com	Debris and Waste Management Advisor				MSB funding . Full 3 mths. 18 Mar. – 18 Jun.	18 Jan. Skype
	UNDP HQ/RH						
19	Nick Rene Hartmann <nick.rene.hartmann@undp.org>	Chief, Partnership Group	BERA	New York	CB		Focus group discuss / 24 Jan.
20	Adam Cathro <adam.cathro@undp.org>	Communication Specialist	BERA	New York	CMST		Focus group discuss / 24 Jan.
21	Notonegoro <notonegoro@undp.org>	Management Specialist(formerly NY)	BMS	Now Samoa	CMST		Training 16-20 Jan.
22	Yasumitsu Doken <yasumitsu.doken@undp.org>	Policy Specialist, Crisis Liaison & Coordination	BPPS	New York	CMST		Focus group discuss / 24 Jan.
23	Bruno Lemarquis <bruno.lemarquis@undp.org>	Deputy Director	CRU	New York	CB	Oversight - Management of the support	Phone 2. Feb. contact
24	Bettina Woll <bettina.woll@undp.org>	Team Leader, Crisis Resp.Coord. (Asia-Pac)	CRU	New York	CMST	Oversaw Crisis Response Coordination	Focus group discuss / 24 Jan.
25	Fabrizio Andreuzzi <fabrizio.andreuzzi@undp.org>	Programme Specialist	CRU	New York	Other	Not immediate in TC Winston. So AAR Focal point in NYC	Frequent communication
26	Rebecca Reynolds <rebecca.reynolds@undp.org>	Team Leader, Rapid Response Team	CRU	New York	Other	Oversaw SURGE support / deployments. Fiji 16- 20 Jan. 2017 for training	Training 16-20 Jan.
27	Rekha Das <rekha.das@undp.org>	Early Recovery Advisor	CRU	Geneva	Other	Support from GCER. Fiji 16-20 Jan. 2017 for training support	Training 16-20 Jan.
28	Nicholas Rosellini <nicholas.rosellini@one.un.org>	Director, Bangkok Regional Hub	RBAP	China (for. BKK)	CB	Lead - CB chair (now RC in China)	Now in China. Skype 2 Feb.(NY) 2017
29	Devanand Ramiah <devanand.ramiah@undp.org>	Head of East Asia and Pacific Cluster	RBAP	Bangkok	CMST		Training 16-20 Jan.2017
	Other UN						
30	Mark Flaming - UNCDF / UNDP Pacific Financial Inclusion Programme mark.flaming@uncdf.org	Programme Manager - PFIP		Fiji		Arr. Feb. 2016. Some input with private sector	Telecon. 13 Feb. 2017
31	Sune Gudnitz	Head of OCHA Pacific		Fiji		Co-chaired UN humanitarian response with RC/HC	Discussed Dec. 2016.
32	Peter Grzic	OCHA Humanitarian Affairs Officer		Fiji		9 mths in Fiji. Feb. – Nov. 2016. Oversaw cluster coordination.	Discussed Dec. 2016.
33	Anna Parini	UN Women. Markets for Change. Proj. Manager		Fiji		Secured USD 3.5 million from DFAT as additional crisis response fund.	Several conversations

34	Niki Abrishamian	UNICEF PIC Chief of Education		Fiji			Brief phone call 26 Jan.
35	Iosefo Voalu	UNICEF Education Officer, Cluster lead		Fiji		Active in long-term cluster relationships.	Brief phone call 26 Jan.
36	Tim Westbury	Un ESCAP – Deputy head of sub-regional office		Fiji		Engaged in DRR and other work, also UNDAF	
Government							
37	Hon. Inia Seruiratu MINISTER	Minister of Agriculture AND Rural and Maritime Development and Disaster Management		Fiji		Senior Government official for the disaster response and much of the recovery (agric.)	In person. Office visit. Tues. 7 Feb.
38	Akapusi Tuifagalele akapusi.tuifagalele@govnet.gov.fj	NDMO Director		Fiji		Key national coordinator for the response.	In person. Office visit. Friday 3 Feb.
39	Syann Williams swilliams.ndmo.fj@gmail.com	Advisor on National Humanitarian Policy		Fiji		Australian funded – supports NDMO	Met NDMO 7 Feb.
40	Vatimi Rayalu VRayalu@agriculture.gov.fj ;	Chief Economist		Fiji		Chair of Food Security Cluster & Agriculture	In person. Office visit. Tues 31 Jan.
41	Jone V. Sovalawa jone.sovalawa@govnet.gov.fj ;	Director Agric.Extension		Fiji		TC Winston Operations Relief Distributor	In person. Office visit. Tues 31 Jan
42	Epeli Dugucagi	Principal Agric. Officer (PAO) Eastern Division		Fiji		Oversees extension work -UNDP intervention area	Met with above. Tues 31 Jan.
Regional Organizations / NGO							
43	Masi Latianara	Country Director – Habitat for Humanity		Fiji		Involved in shelter recovery programme	Lunch meet 03 Feb.
44	Anthony Blake	Pacific Community (SPC)				Involved in PDNA	Café. 25 Jan.
Development Partners / Donors - IFIs							
45	Stephanie Werner steph.werner@dfat.gov.au +679 7071278 DFAT, Australia	DFAT. Second Secretary (Humanitarian),				Central in funding decisions for DFAT	25 Jan. at DFAT
46	Ray Bojczuk raymond.bojczuk@dfat.gov.au	DFAT – Hum. Officer				Central DFAT decisions	25 Jan. at DFAT
47	Mark Ramsden	NZ High Commissioner				NZ High Com.	06 Feb. at Cafe
48	Brenden Sherry	First Secretary – Dev.. NZ High Com.				Directs NZ's bilateral recovery efforts	07 Feb. at MFAT
49	Rob Jauncey rjauncey@adb.org +679 9920508 Asian Development Bank (ADB)	ADB Regional Director, South Pacific.				Oversees region. Central in post-crisis relief loans.	19 Jan at ADB
50	Christopher Wensley cjwensley@gmail.com +679 7272461	ADB Consultant. Post-disaster assessment / Recovery Planning				Assessment/Recovery Planning. Works on SPO / Ministry of Economy	25 Jan. at Café

Summary Questions / Areas of Enquiry.

ANNEX D

After Action Review of UNDP Response to Severe Tropical Cyclone Winston (TCW) in Fiji. Feb. – Dec. 2016.

Used as of 22 Dec. to accompany request to interview / discuss. Working reasonably effectively to aid discussions to 9 Jan . 2017

Summary of objectives and areas of review

This note captures the objectives of the After Action Review (AAR) of UNDP's response to the destructive effects of Category 5 Severe Tropical Cyclone Winston (TCW or 'Winston') in Fiji on 20 - 21 February 2016.

Building upon its presence in country and a range of ongoing development projects, UNDP sought additional support (staff and finances), and reprogrammed some existing project resources in order to make a timely, relevant contribution within a coordinated UN response to humanitarian and recovery efforts led by the Government of Fiji.

Examining the performance of UNDP in the immediate response, AAR objectives include:

- Highlighting lessons learned to help strengthen the functioning, performance and efficiency of UNDP's response to disasters - at CO level, regional and corporate levels, in both programmatic and operational capacities
- Examining issues of UNDP in interagency coordination; contribution to PDNA and recovery processes.
- Providing inputs into a recent application of UNDP's new Crisis Response Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) - also for informing a Crisis Response Training for the Pacific planned in Suva, Fiji 16-20 January 2017

Below is a comprehensive tabulation of areas of interest to the review as extracted from the TOR. In discussion or in written correspondence during the review process **PLEASE ONLY CONSIDER AREAS THAT ARE RELEVANT TO YOUR EXPERIENCE IN THE RESPONSE.**

Area – Key issues. Points to consider	What worked well? Why?	Could work better?
1.0 Overall Response		
1.1 UNDP's response in the context of an L2 crisis with special emphasis on compliance with crisis response systems and processes (e.g. SOP) at global, regional and country level. Including:		
i) timeliness and effectiveness of strategic decisions and actions by decision makers and other key stakeholders in the organization in order to respond to the crisis;		
ii) internal communication and coordination flows within UNDP to support the CO's efforts to respond to the crisis;		
iii) timeliness and effectiveness to quickly scale up UNDP Pacific Island Center (PIC) capacity to undertake immediate crisis response activities and pose the foundations for recovery;		
1.2 UNDP's overall preparedness for response [CO, Regional, global] including the decision-making processes and their efficiency in the context of corporate response		
1.3 Examine UNDP's ability to take on a "whole of UNDP" approach to response and recovery		
1.4 How UNDP technical and programmatic expertise was leveraged during response		

2. Programmatic Response	What worked well? Why?	Could work better?
2.1 Application of relevant UNDP's Crisis Response Packages' approach and elements.		
2.2 Timeliness and pertinence of UNDP's recovery programme formulation and choices on programme priorities; reasons choices made; and overall programmatic performance in the six months following the onset of the crisis;		
2.3 What and how programmatic responses laid a foundation for long-term recovery, including UNDP engagement in the PDNA process.		
2.4 Whether adjustments were made to the existing country programme in response to the cyclone (including the identification of new programmes)		
2.5 Lessons on the sustainability of initial UNDP programmatic activities and on the initial positioning by UNDP to have in place programme activities aimed at responding to the crisis and supporting recovery;		
2.6 The role SURGE Advisors played in positioning UNDP to respond to the crisis and support recovery actions, programme development and implementation, programme realignment and resources mobilization;		
2.7 Added value provided by SURGE Advisors in the elaboration and delivery of programmes at the Country Office level		
2.8 Examine the collaboration between the experts deployed under the SURGE modality and the Programmatic staff in country, at global level and in the Regional Hub		
3.0 Operational Response		
3.1 Timeliness and effectiveness of the overall response operation and the compliance and application of SOPs and decision-making processes - country, regional and HQ level responses, in addition to the interaction between these dimensions of the response		
3.2 Efficiency / effectiveness of immediate crisis response SOP and application in context of response. This includes but is not limited to the application of Fast Track procedures, rapid response processes and the operations elements of the relevant crisis response packages (financing, deployments, recruitment, procurement, etc.);		
3.3 Relevance and timeliness of the SURGE work plan, and quality of SURGE deployments, including UNDP Stand-by partners, and management of SURGE advisors in country		
3.4 Bottlenecks and constraints faced by the CO in terms of both operations and programme implementation		
4.0 UN and Interagency Coordination: Effectiveness and adequacy of UNDP's engagement with the broader humanitarian action. Including:		
4.1 Extent of UNDP's coordination and cooperation with key humanitarian partners on the ground		
4.2 UNDP's leadership of the Early Recovery (ER) approach on the ground in supporting recovery. UNDP capacity to attract partners and resources to the approach.		
4.3 Clarity of UNDP's role and actions vis-à-vis other partners, including but not limited to other clusters, IFIs, and NGOs;		
4.4 UNDP's ability to link immediate early recovery to longer term recovery efforts		
4.5 UNDP's support to Government coordination capacities and UNDP's engagement in the wider planning processes for recovery with the government, IFIs and other key stakeholders.		

4.6 UNDP's ability to build synergies and mainstream the recovery agenda in the needs assessment processes (such as MIRA and PDNA) and humanitarian funding instruments		
5.0 Communication and Resource Mobilization:		
5.1. Timeliness and effectiveness of communication, including relationship with media, and resource mobilization efforts		
5.2 UNDP's level of success in mobilizing funds from humanitarian funding sources, including but not limited to Flash Appeal and CERF Rapid Response Grant. Assess the total amount of the resources actually mobilized for the recovery programme against the SURGE plan and analyze effectiveness and challenges of resource mobilization.		
5.3 Internal and external factors that impacted donor funding decisions, identifying areas for improvement.		
5.4 Assess donor response to the UNDP programme, identifying gaps and areas for improvement		
5.5. Donor response to the overall ER agenda and UNDP leadership of the ER cluster		

COMBINED Minutes of four (4) UNDP Crisis Board Meetings on the Pacific Response to Tropical Cyclone Winston 23, 26 Feb and 4,16 March 2016.

First CB meeting. Tues. 23 Feb. 2016

1. Date and time: 13:30 Suva time and 08:30 BKK time **Tuesday 23 Feb**, 20:30 Monday 22nd Feb NY time
2. Participants:
 - RBAP New York: Haoliang Xu, Nicholas Rosellini, Elena Tischenko, Sitara Syed
 - Pacific Office: Osnat Lubrani, Asenaca Ravuvu, Kevin Petrini, Moortaza Jiwanji, Winifereti Nainoca, Elena Wakolo
 - CRU New York: Bruno Lemarquis, Bettina Woll
 - Bangkok Regional Hub: Caitlin Wiesen, Devanand Ramiah, Sanny Ramos Jegillos, Peter Waa, Francisco Santos-Jara Padron, Cedric Monteiro, Naoko Takasu
 - BPPS New York: Jo Scheuer, Craig Hawke, Krishna Vatsa, Owen Shumba, Rita Missal, Yasumitsu Doken
 - BERA New York: Laurel Patterson, Adam Cathro
 - BMS New York: Bruce McCarron, Martha Helena Lopez, Notonegoro, Naira Grigoryan

3. Key decisions/follow-up points:

- (a) Level of crisis: Designated as Level 2 Crisis
- (b) Pacific Office to immediately submit proposal for Sweden, Stockholm liaison office can support if needed. Pacific Office to also work on Flash Appeal/CERF proposal with remote support from BPPS/RPPS.
- (c) A proposal to be shared to BERA for wider circulation and solicit interest from other donors.
- (d) CRU to share Crisis Response Packages tools to the Pacific Office.
- (e) BRH (COSQA) and CRU to finalize with the Pacific Office list of immediate deployment needs (First Responders) in coordination with CRU, BPPS, RPPS on staff availability.
- (f) CRU has allocated USD100K from TRAC1.1.3 to support coordination, needs assessment, and initiate early recovery framework. The Pacific Office was requested to utilize this fund for HC/RC coordination support.
- (g) Communications: The first press release is out on the Global Website. As existing projects and programmes are being re-phased to support TC Winston response, dedicated stories and information on this needs to be prepared and disseminated. Communication profile to be included as one of the First Responders.
- (h) OCHA's designation of Osnat as Humanitarian Coordinator is taking place (approved as of cob 22 Feb NY time.)
- (i) Working-level Crisis Management Team to be established. Each Bureau is requested to nominate one focal point.
- (j) Message to the Pacific Office staff from the Administrator has already been disseminated. The draft letter from the Administrator to the Fiji Government is submitted for final clearance.
- (k) Next CBM will be Friday 26 Feb 13:30 Suva and 08:30 BKK, Thu 20:30 NY time.

4. Other key points discussed/raised:

- (a) Early Recovery Cluster: waiting for the Government decision. Pacific Office to advocate while also working through other clusters.
- (b) PDNA: It is important that UN/UNDP liaises with government and is and fully involved in the PDNA process. RC/RR to meet with EU, WB, ADB in Suva.
- (c) Specific attention to be given for UNDP's longer-term strategic positioning and recovery programming, as part of the assessment and programming processes.

Minutes of 2nd CB Meeting. Friday 26 Feb. 2016

1. Date and time: 13:30 Suva time and 08:30 BKK time Friday 26th Feb, 20:30 Thursday 25th Feb NY

2. Participants:

RBAP New York: Nicholas Rosellini, Sitara Syed, Stanislav Saling

Pacific Office: Osnat Lubrani, Akiko Fujii, Asenaca Ravuvu, Moortaza Jiwanji, Elena Wakolo

CRU New York: Bettina Woll

Bangkok Regional Hub: Caitlin Wiesen, Devanand Ramiah, Sanny Ramos Jegillos, Rajesh Sharma, Tomislav Condic, Cedric Monteiro, Naoko Takasu

BPPS New York: Jo Scheuer, Krishna Vatsa, Rita Missal, Yasumitsu Doken

BERA New York: Laurel Patterson, Adam Cathro

BMS New York: Bruce McCarron, Notonegoro, Emily Chakavarika

3. Key decisions/follow-up points:

- (a) Pacific Office to ensure UNDP submission for Flash Appeal and CERF. Flash Appeal deadline will be most likely Monday 29 Feb. CRU to re-send guidance for UNDP COs on CERF application to ensure life-saving aspect to be included in UNDP CERF submission.
- (b) PDNA: There is a discussion to start PDNA around 14 March. Timing needs to be carefully planned and decided, taking challenges in data collection and Easter holidays into account. It was agreed to make most use of national staff capacity in the Pacific Office for sectoral assessments while overall coordination will be supported by a First Responder. BPPS to share good PDNA examples from other countries.
- (c) Early Recovery Cluster: Not yet established. Pacific Office will continue advocating for it, while participating other clusters to mainstream early recovery components in other clusters' work.
- (d) First Responders list of four has been approved: (1) Programme Management Specialist for SURGE planning and coordination as well as programing and proposal writing support; (2) Communications; (3) Senior Recovery Advisor for PDNA coordination and long-term recovery planning; and (4) Early Recovery Cluster Coordinator. Naoko to be deployed and arrive at Suva by 29 Feb for 3 weeks. Pacific Office requested (3) and (4) to stay for 2 months. CRU will continue searching candidates and deploy other 3 profiles next week.
- (e) In addition to the above, a need for immediate deployment of Security Advisor was tabled. In order to support UNDP staff to travel and start implementing activities in the affected areas, Tomislav to be deployed to Fiji as soon as possible, and the funding will come from UNDP Security Office. The RC/HC also raised the potentially upcoming need for Aid/Donor Coordination to support the Fiji Government. This was noted and would be included in the SURGE Plan once confirmed.
- (f) SURGE planning: Naoko, in close consultation with other First Responders, to support the Pacific Office in elaborating a SURGE Plan. UNDP NY and BKK will provide remote support and advise as needed.
- (g) Approx. USD150K will be reprogrammed from existing projects for immediate response work. Pacific Office to ensure documenting and communicating activities, results and the amount (USD) spent from existing projects so that UNDP action on the ground will be widely disseminated.
- (h) A proposal for Sweden has been submitted by RBAP and already transmitted to Stockholm. BERA to circulate the same "Chapeau" document of USD5 mil to other potential donors. According to Tokyo Office, Japan will not provide Emergency Grant through international agencies for TC Winston (USD1 million concept note submitted on 21 Feb did not go through.)

- (i) Pacific Office made strong appeal for BPPS seed funding (PIP). BPPS will discuss internally and get back on the possibility. Pacific Office to prepare PIP document for BPPS consideration.
- (j) Pacific Office (with Naoko and Communications First Responder) to prepare 1-2 pager for each component to share with donors who are interested in funding specific areas.
- (k) Fast Track: RBAP to inform BMS of a request for extending current BMS Acceleration Package until 31 December 2016.
- (l) Next CBM will be Friday 4 March 13:30 Suva and 08:30 BKK, Thursday 3 Mar 20:30 NY time.

4. Other key points discussed/raised:

- (a) OCHA will provide one Humanitarian Affairs Officer for dedicated support to Osnat as HC.
- (b) Responding to a query, it was informed that PDNA funding will likely come from WB (and possibly EU); however such funding will not cover UN's support to the exercise. Government has experience and capacity in conducting PDNA.
- (c) HC/RC consider it important to include Environment issues in PDNA in Fiji, and UNDP can play a strong role with existing large Environment portfolio.
- (d) BPPS and Pacific Office to have a separate call to discuss more details on PDNA.
- (e) DFAT (Canberra) approached UNDP and expressed interests in three areas: support the restoration of basic service; support the resuscitation of markets and livelihoods; and support protection measures. Deputy Regional Director to pitch during annual consultation with Australia on 26 Feb in NY.

Minutes of 3rd CB Meeting. Friday 4 March 2016

1. Date and time: 13:30 Suva time and 08:30 BKK time Friday 4th March, 20:30 Thursday 3rd March NY time

2. Participants:

Chair: Nicholas Rosellini, RBAP

Pacific Office: Osnat Lubrani, Akiko Fujii, Kevin Petrini, Moortaza Jiwanji

RBAP New York: Sitara Syed, Stanislav Saling

CRU New York: Bettina Woll

Bangkok Regional Hub: Caitlin Wiesen, Devanand Ramiah, Sanny Ramos Jegillos, Rajesh Sharma, Tomislav Condic, Cedric Monteiro, Naoko Takasu

BPPS New York: Jo Scheuer, Rita Missal, Yasumitsu Doken, Rossana Dudziak

BERA New York: Narue Shiki, Adam Cathro

BMS New York: Notonegoro, Emily Chakavarika

3. Key decisions/follow-up points:

- (a) The RC/HC undertook a field visit, which included one of the most affected island.
- (b) **Flash Appeal:** Pacific Office submitted project proposals to Flash Appeal (total of USD1.1 million which includes USD900K under Early Recovery and USD200K under Food Security) and CERF (USD75K for Food Security).
- (c) Seed Funding: BPPS announced that it would have USD250K available. Pacific Office to submit the Project Document incorporating already-prepared several proposals including draft PIP. BPPS indicated once the proposal is received the allocation would be swift.
- (d) **First responders/SURGE:** The programme specialist and the Security Advisor already deployed. The Senior Recovery Advisor and Communications Specialist will be arriving by the 6th March. The deployment of the Early Recovery Advisor profile has been put on hold at the request of the Pacific Office, due to the ER cluster not being activated. The need for this profile will be revisited.
- (e) The RC/HC informed that a Humanitarian Coordination Support Officer from OCHA was deployed to support the HC. Her office has also retained an Aid/donor coordination person locally. This person used to work for EU.
- (f) **Resource mobilization:** USD50K Emergency Cash Grant was mobilized from OCHA, which has been used for procurement of debris clearance equipment.
- (g) CO already reprogrammed USD130K worth of existing funds for programmes.
- (h) Chapeau Document of USD5 million has been developed and shared with the Government of Sweden and other donors. This proposal will be further strengthened based on the above Project Document and latest information.

- (i) **Japan proposal:** USD1 million for 3 months has also been developed and shared with Tokyo Office on 21 Feb. This was to be shared with BERA, to follow up with the Japan Permanent Mission in the context of the Flash Appeal being launched.
- (j) RBAP, BERA and CRU to follow up with **Sweden** on the proposal submitted. It was anticipated that Sweden might consider the proposal under the flash appeal.
- (k) Proposals have also been submitted to China and Russia as suggested by Haoliang. BERA indicated they will follow up.
- (l) African, Caribbean and Pacific Group of States (ACP) has reached out to BPPS to explore possible partnerships to support the Pacific. While it is not clear yet whether we will receive funding, this is a very positive step. It is important to coordinate this well with the Brussels office who will meet with the ASG Secretariat and the Ambassadors.
- (m) **Communications:** 2-pager on UNDP Response has been developed/uploaded onto the website with the help from BRH and India CO.
- (n) **SURGE Plan** is being developed by Naoko with input from CO. Draft will be circulated to working level CMT next week. Plan to submit the final version to CB for approval in the next CB meeting.
- (f) CO also looking at additional reprogramming of ongoing programmes. The importance of doing things on the ground with the seed funding and re-programmed funds was emphasized.
- (o) Next CBM is tentatively scheduled for Friday 11 March 13:30 Suva and 08:30 BKK, Thursday 10 Mar 20:30 NY time – date and time to be confirmed

Minutes of 4th CB Meeting. Wed. 16 March 2016

1. Date and time: 13:00 Suva time and 08:00 BKK time Wednesday 16 March, 21:00 Thursday 15 March NY time

2. Participants:

Chair: Nicholas Rosellini, RBAP

Pacific Office: Osnat Lubrani, Akiko Fujii, Rebecca VonSchreeb

RBAP New York: Sitara Syed

CRU New York: Bettina Woll

Bangkok Regional Hub: Vineet Bhatia, Devanand Ramiah, Tomislav Condic, Naoko Takasu

BPPS New York: Rossana Dudziak, Rita Missal, Yasumitsu Doken

BERA New York: Nick Hartmann, Adam Cathro

BMS New York: Bruce McCarron, Notonegoro

3. **Key decisions/follow-up points:**

(a) **Seed Funding:** BPPS has approved an allocation of USD250,000 to support the Cyclone Winston Response and Recovery project.

(b) **PDNA:** While the official letter has yet to be issued, PDNA is scheduled to start from 29 March for 3 weeks. It will be a Government-led process, and development partners including UN will be supporting the Government. Secretariat of the Pacific Community (SPC) will be conducting 1-week training of the Government officials from 21 Mar. Briefing sessions for UN and other development partners are taking place this week. UNDP will be involved in overall coordination/assessment, Environment, and Livelihoods.

(c) **Recovery Framework/Pledging Conference:** While the plan is still up in the air, PDNA is expected to be finalized by the end of April, both PDNA results and Recovery Framework to be approved by Cabinet by 10 May, and a pledging conference to be done around 17 May. EU expressed interest in supporting the Fiji Government to hold a pledge conference in Suva. UNDP positioning in implementation of the Recovery Framework will be critical.

(d) **Flash Appeal:** Early Recovery is not yet funded (UNDP portion from CERF erroneously reported under the Early Recovery but this will be shifted to Food Security cluster.) Advocacy activities by HC to Canberra on Friday and Wellington on Monday will be done by video conference.

(e) **Resource mobilization:** UNDP so far received USD50K Emergency Cash Grant, USD124K from CERF, and USD250K from BPPS.

(f) **Programming/re-programming:** UNDP's response to a Government request with re-programmed USD130K and USD50K from the Emergency Cash Grant was highly appreciated and highlighted during the Diplomatic Corps meeting,

and UNDP name was mentioned immediately after the largest donor of Australia. Additional USD50K is being reprogrammed from Fiji Youth Project and Strengthening Citizen Engagement in Fiji Initiative project.

(g) **First responders/SURGE:** One of MSB Debris and Waste Management Advisor arrived and already traveled to Koro Islands. The Pacific Office requested for extension of Senior Recovery Advisor and another Communications Specialist deployment for 2 months which are included in the SURGE Plan.

(h) **SURGE Plan:** was presented and endorsed by the Board.

(i) **Regular Crisis Board Meetings** were completed today and ad-hoc meeting will be held if/when requested by the Pacific Office. [end]

8 Nov. 2016 Nicolas Rosellini email Closing UNDP crisis response

To: Izumi Nakamitsu; Bruno Lemarquis; Magdy Martinez-Soliman; Sarah Poole; Jens Wandel; Bruce McCarron; Michael O'Neill; Gulden Turkoz-Cosslett; Luc Vandamme; Martha Helena Lopez Cc: Haoliang Xu; Bettina Woll; Vineet Bhatia; Devanand Ramiah; Sanny Ramos Jegillos; Caitlin Wiesen; Osnat Lubrani; Akiko Fujii; Jo Scheuer; Elena Tischenko; Mohammad Younus; Sitara Syed; Mitsuhiro Inaba; Peter Waa; Tomislav Condic; Naoko Takasu; Saumik De; Asenaca Ravuvu; Rebecca Reynolds; Rattaphol Vihokrat; Kevin Petrini; Cedric Monteiro; Stanislav Saling; Chantana Supprasit; Sirinporn Santavanond; Tshering Pem

Dear Crisis Management Board Members,

I am sending this email to bring an official closure to the UNDP crisis response to Tropical Cyclone Winston.

After the Category 5 TC Winston hit Fiji on 20/21 February, we organized four Level 2 Crisis Board Meetings from 23 Feb to 16 March, and the SURGE Plan for 3 months till June was approved at the last meeting. UNDP HQ disbursed a track 1.1.3 cat. II allocation as well as a BPPS allocation to quick start debris clearance amounting at USD 350,000, and committed USD 291, 000 under the surge plan from CRU. UNDP Pacific Office in Fiji also leveraged about USD 174,000 from CERF and Emergency Cash Grant.

With support from 4 First Responders and additional 3 SURGE Advisors (2 of which deployed through agreement with Swedish Contingency Agency - MSB) as well as remote technical support from colleagues in NY and BKK, the Pacific Office in Fiji has achieved the following:

Winston Recovery Project: UNDP assisted 19 affected villages with more than 680 people engaged in debris management activities in the remote island of Koro and Ra Province, indirectly benefited over 3,500 affected population. In Koro Island, UNDP assisted livelihoods and food security recovery by supporting home gardening of 672 households in all 14 villages. UNDP assisted women's livelihoods recovery by replanting 6,000 pandanus suckers for weaving.

Communications and Media: A number of communications materials, such as articles, status updates, and blogs, were produced to highlight UNDP's support, many of which resulted in wide media coverages in Fiji. Some key website articles are as listed below.

<http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/04/08/in-fiji-youth-are-key-to-cyclone-winston-recovery.html>

<http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/06/16/tokatoka-farms-help-arrest-land-wastage-build-resilience-and-food-security-post-cyclone-winston-in-fiji.html>

<http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/06/17/rural-women-help-early-recovery-efforts-in-fiji-make-and-sell-green-handicrafts-.html>

<http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/05/25/cash-for-work-brings-smiles-to-cyclone-battered-villages-helps-speed-up-massive-debris-cleaning.html>

<http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/05/22/koro-island-villages-show-resolve-to-clean-up-after-cyclone-winston.html>

<http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/04/18/youths-clear-debris-in-koro-and-regain-strength-for-recovery.html>

Post Disaster Needs Assessment (PDNA) and Disaster Recovery Framework (DRF): UNDP provided coordination and technical support to the Government of Fiji to conduct the Post-Disaster Needs Assessment (PDNA) and prepare a Disaster Recovery Framework (DRF). The specific areas of support included livelihoods and environment sectors. The final PDNA is attached for your information. The estimated value of damage and losses is F\$1.99 billion (USD 0.9 billion), with housing sector and agriculture sector suffering the most in terms of damage and losses. This is equivalent to one fifth of Fiji's 2014 GDP.

Disaster Waste Management (DWM): Based on lessons learned from its debris management project, the Pacific Office in Fiji is exploring partnership with EU/SPREP's PacWaste project and JICA's J-PRISM (Japanese Technical Cooperation Project for Promotion of Regional Initiative on Solid Waste Management in PICs) projects to link disaster waste management and resilience building by improving waste management practices in normal times from health, environment, livelihoods and disaster preparedness points of views. UNDP was invited to the Clean Pacific Roundtable on 25-28 July in Suva to chair a session on disaster waste management, and establishment of a regional working group on Disaster Waste Management has been decided.

<https://sprep.org/waste-management-pollution-control/disaster-waste-in-the-spotlight-at-clean-pacific-roundtable>

Now that the SURGE advisors have completed their assignments, and as per UNDP Standard Operation Procedures (SOPs) for immediate Crisis Response, an After Action Review will be carried out to reflect on, draw best practices and lessons learned as well as make relevant recommendations for improving the efficiency and effectiveness of UNDP corporate response to crisis situation. CRU will reach out to the Pacific Office in Fiji and relevant bureaus in due time to facilitate such a learning process.

While the corporate crisis response mechanism will be closed with this email, our Pacific Office in Fiji will continue its recovery project till March 2017, and will also need to be prepared for the upcoming Cyclone seasons. We count on everyone's continued support to the Office.

As a Chair of the Crisis Management Board, I would also like to take this opportunity to thank and express my appreciation to all those who contributed to this response.

[END]

Twelve (12) articles were examined as a sample, including the six in the closing email of 8 Nov.2016. All messages were focused at the project level, and consistently failed to point to the scale of the crisis in Fiji, and response and recovery need.

UNDP Media piece title / date / reference	Focus / Key messages
<u>22 Feb. 2016 Press release:</u> UNDP stands ready to assist Fiji following TC Winston http://www.undp.org/content/undp/en/home/presscenter/pressreleases/2016/02/22/undp-stands-ready-to-assist-fiji-following-tc-winston.html	Expressed support to Govt. of Fiji in humanitarian and recovery efforts. Highlighted UNDP's global experience and expertise to support rapid and efficient recovery / restoration of livelihoods. Stated UNDP Fiji capacity in existing programmes that can be directed towards early recovery activities: includes the Pacific Risk Resilience Programme (PRRP), livelihoods, capacity building component of UN Women Market for Change Project and other on-going programmes... <u>Good expression of intent.</u>
<u>4 Mar. 2016. Press release:</u> Mobilising Youths to Support Government's Early Recovery Efforts http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/pressreleases/2016/03/04/mobilising-youths-to-support-government-s-early-recovery-efforts-.html	Focuses on UNDP's "re-diversion of funding into immediate relief work" for "Cash for Work" FJD\$100,000 (US\$ 50,000) to "support the Government's rehabilitation and recovery efforts." "The funding, which is being made available through the UNDP-funded Fiji Youth Strengthening Project and the European Union-funded Strengthening Citizen Engagement in Fiji Initiative (SCEFI) Project, is <u>expected to mobilize around 500 youths in hard-hit areas under the guidance of the National Disaster Management Office (NDMO)</u> and the use of the "Cash for Work" modality to provide financial assistance for youth workers to support the recovery work." <u>Misses opportunity to highlight overall recovery needs.</u>
<u>11 Mar. 2016. Article.</u> Recognizing Women Market Vendors' Achievements on Intl. Women's Day http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/03/11/recognizing-women-market-vendors-achievements-on-the-international-women-s-day.html	Celebrates Market women on (near) International Women's day in Fiji. Yet only three weeks after TC Winston. <u>Makes no mention of cyclone and does not highlight recovery needs.</u>
<u>15 Mar. 2016 Press release.</u> Cyclone devastation calls for extraordinary partnerships http://www.asia-pacific.undp.org/content/rbap/en/home/presscenter/pressreleases/2016/03/15/cyclone-devastation-calls-for-extraordinary-partnerships.html	Focuses on EU, UNDP, SPC "innovative partnership" with the Pacific Community (SPC) and Ministry of Agriculture facilitating messages (SMS) on safe water consumption and agriculture. "For devastation of this magnitude, it will require real partnerships to ensure messages reach those that are most affected and as the largest telecommunications network in the country, "While the full impact of this disaster is being assessed, UNDP and its partners stand ready to assist the Fiji Government with humanitarian and recovery efforts". Good in the way private sector support is highlighted, and that "disaster response and recovery is everyone's business" – as well as the need for partnership to address information gap between Government departments and communities in disasters. <u>Hints at a big crisis event – yet the partnership referred to is the SMS messaging. Misses a chance to describe the magnitude of cyclone impact.</u>
<u>07 Apr 2016 Blog:</u> Hand in hand, we are stronger than Winston by Tova Andersson http://www.asia-pacific.undp.org/content/rbap/en/home/blog/2016/4/7/In-Fiji-together-we-are-stronger-than-Winston.html	Largely, upbeat personal thoughts on experience in debris management (Koro Island). Highlights Fiji Ministry of Youth and Sport in collaboration with UNDP (yet this is the only direct reference to UNDP). <u>Misses opportunity to advocate for recovery resources.</u>

<u>08 April Article on UNDP Website</u> <i>In Fiji, youth are key to Cyclone Winston recovery.</i> http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/04/08/in-fiji-youth-are-key-to-cyclone-winston-recovery.html	Good story giving details on Disaster Waste Management, and links to other sectors – eg health and sanitation . Only figures mentioned beyond the 320 km/h wind speed are 130 youth from four villages, including 20 women within the UNDP project, “reprogrammed US\$ 50,000 and, together with the Ministry of Youth and Sports, started a cash-for-work programme for up to 500 youths”. Text says the winds “destroying every house” yet photo shows youth being consulted in front of many intact houses (and UNDP wasn’t reconstructing houses). <u>Misses opportunity to denote the scale of the crisis and advocate for recovery resources.</u>
<u>18 April Article</u> <i>Youths clear debris in Koro and regain strength for recovery</i> http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/04/18/youths-clear-debris-in-koro-and-regain-strength-for-recovery.html	Explains youth engagement in cash for work. Numbers: “UNDP reprogrammed FJ \$100,000 and, together with the Ministry of Youth and Sports, started a Cash-for-Work programme for up to 300 youths of the most affected villages:” <u>Article misses chance to put recovery needs in perspective.</u>
<u>22 May 2016 Article: Responding to Cyclone Winston UNDP Update (as of May 2016)</u> http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/05/22/responding-to-cyclone-winston-undp-update-as-of-may-2016.html	“Two months after the Cyclone, the response to Severe Tropical Cyclone Winston is steadily moving into the early recovery phase.” UNDP support is aligned right behind priority needs identified by the Government. Highlights PDNA process underway focussing on key early, medium and long-term recovery and reconstruction needs in all key sectors, documenting these in a Recovery Framework. “As <u>Fiji emerges</u> from one of the worst natural disasters in its history, UNDP is extending an assistance of close to US\$ 480,000 for restoration of pre-dominantly rural, farm-based livelihoods in the wake of Severe Tropical Cyclone Winston. The path to early recovery, however, was paved by financial and technical support for the critical tasks of debris clearance and waste management. UNDP allocated US\$ 130,000 from existing programmes to assist the Ministry of Agriculture. UNDP has reprogrammed US\$ 50,000 from its on-going projects to support the Ministry of Youth and Sports for enlisting village-level youth under Cash for Work initiative for rehabilitation efforts and debris clearance in Koro Island that witnessed severe devastation to homes and livelihoods. Other support extended includes debris clearing materials for the communities in most needed areas. These funds support life-saving needs and aim at ensuring Fiji can build back better. UNDP and its partners can, together, help the country emerge from this crisis, and be a stronger and more resilient Fiji. <u>Overall appears as a problematic article. Messages are mixed and there is no campaign for recovery funds.</u>
<u>22 May 2016 Article: Koro Island Villages Show Resolve to Clean Up After Cyclone Winston</u> http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/05/22/koro-island-villages-show-resolve-to-clean-up-after-cyclone-winston.html	<u>Good article that starts to demonstrate the scale of debris removal. Good photo.</u> However, data mentioned: “When work is completed over 2000 people will benefit from the UNDP-supported debris clearance and waste management activities in eight villages of Koro Island and 12 villages in the Ra province...” Makes links between remoteness and self-help. “Even in the best of times, the estimated 3,700 Koro islanders remained relatively cut off from the mainland, or at best, just sparsely connected...” <u>Article misses chance to put recovery needs in perspective.</u>

<u>25 May 2016. Article. Cash for Work Brings Smiles to Cyclone-battered Villages, Helps Speed Up Massive Debris Cleaning</u> http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/05/25/cash-for-work-brings-smiles-to-cyclone-battered-villages-helps-speed-up-massive-debris-cleaning.html	Title mentions “massive” – but no data or indication of size/scale of damage or recovery needs given. Explains the importance of livelihoods connection to the natural environment. <u>No mention of ongoing needs / degree of recovery achieved.</u>
16 June 2016. Article. Tokatoka Farms Help Arrest Land Wastage, Build Resilience and Food Security Post Cyclone Winston in Fiji http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/06/16/tokatoka-farms-help-arrest-land-wastage-build-resilience-and-food-security-post-cyclone-winston-in-fiji.html	Demonstrates good link to crisis preparedness of UNDP’s work in resilience building. <u>However, uses no figures. Has no solid argument. No mention of ongoing needs / degree of recovery achieved.</u>
17 June. Article. Rural Women Help Early Recovery Efforts in Fiji, Make and Sell ‘Green’ Handicrafts. http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/articles/2016/06/17/rural-women-help-early-recovery-efforts-in-fiji-make-and-sell-green-handicrafts-.html	Good story of over 200 women in nine villages of Yakete Personal. Human. <u>No mention of ongoing needs / degree of recovery achieved</u>
16 Oct. 2016. Press release. A look back as Koro continues to rebuild post Winston http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/presscenter/pressreleases/2016/10/16/a-look-back-as-koro-continues-to-rebuild-post-winston.html	Written eight months into TC Winston recovery, illustrates some UNDP recovery efforts in partnership with the Fiji Government – noting they are “progressively underway”. <u>No mention of ongoing needs / degree of recovery achieved.</u>



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Recommendations / Lessons learnt



Myndigheten för
samhällsskydd
och beredskap

Note: This compilation of lessons learnt refers to the deployment of 3 experts by MSB to support UNDP in the implementation of debris/disaster waste management activities in response to TC Winston between the 9th of March and 16th of June 2016.

The points presented below refer to a specific context of intervention (intervention supporting

1. UNDP internal organization during the response

a. Direct involvement of permanent UNDP staff

It would be highly valuable to study mechanisms to have some permanent UNDP staff directly involved as part of the response team during the whole intervention period (3-6 months). This staff could be involved partially (ex: 20-30 % of their time), but still participate actively in the planning and implementation of the activities (instead of phasing out when the MSB staff is deployed). This would allow to:

- have an effective transfer of knowledge / lessons learnt acquired during the disaster response (the Training of Trainers should involve UNDP staff and could be done in a day-to-day basis);
- improve the general capacity of UNDP in humanitarian response in general and in particular in relation to Debris and Disaster Waste Management (assessment, drafting of project proposals, implementation, etc.);
- initiate the implementation of activities before the arrival of MSB/SURGE staff;
- facilitate the link between humanitarian response and development projects - Early Recovery and coordination between different components (Climate change & Resilience, DRR, Governance, Environment, etc.);
- improve UNDP general capacity with Waste Management and possibility of institutionalizing and developing its intervention in this thematic area;
- ensure a sustainable hand-over and exit strategy.

This UNDP staff (or team) would also be a key for the effective and efficient program activities by supporting the MSB team in liaison with relevant counterparts (particularly government) and operational matters. This would allow MSB experts to concentrate more on technical issues and maximize the capacity of UNDP staff with knowledge on local context and connections. It would also avoid the MSB team to be involved too deeply in some simple but time consuming activities such as participant registration, cash for works payments, material distributions, etc.

The establishment of such mechanism to enable longer involvement of UNDP permanent staff in disaster recovery program makes particular sense in the case of UNDP Pacific multi-country office, since the region is stroke by a major disaster event almost every year.

b. Procurement / Logistic

The Debris Management activities involve the need of supplying of quite significant quantities of equipment, including unusual equipment and services, adding a significant amount of works in term of operation, procurement and logistics. Therefor UNDP capacity in these areas shall be adapted during the project implementation period to ensure an effective implementation of activities on the field:

- **procurement capacity:** additional staff to go physically to the suppliers, check material quality etc
- **logistic capacity:** identification of warehousing options, possibly to be shared with local or international partners.

2. Coordination with counterparts/partners

a. Debris Clearance & the Emergency Cluster system

The cluster system is essential to ensure good coordination between actors. However ***debris management activities are not always clearly identified as part of a specific cluster***, which creates gaps in coordination of activities (risk of overlaps, and significant differences in the approaches, guidelines, etc.).

- Early Recovery cluster: the ER cluster might not be the more appropriate for debris-related activities for several reasons:
 - Debris Management activities shall be implemented in an Early Recovery perspective, but not necessarily more than other areas (food security, shelter, etc.);
 - Debris Management activities have a very strong Emergency component (some activities have to be implemented quickly during first weeks of intervention to be effective);
 - The Early Recovery cluster might take more time to be activated than other clusters (if activated, in many case ER remains a transversal component and not a core cluster);
- WASH cluster: many of the partners implementing debris-related activities (Cash-for-work, clean up campaigns, etc.) are part of the WASH cluster (NGOs: Oxfam, Save the Children, etc.), and for this reason it might make sense to integrate Debris Management activities in this cluster;
- Other clusters: Debris management could also possibly be integrated in other clusters such as Food Security or Shelter, considering the possible connections with recovery of agriculture livelihoods or reconstruction effort.

Whatever the choice of the most appropriate cluster, it is important to have Debris Management activities clearly identified as part of this unique cluster, and for all partners (international community, NGO, Government) to clearly know that UNDP is a key partner to coordinate with on this topic and a potential source of expertise.

b. Government coordination

As with counterpart in the international community, the coordination with Government is also essential for an effective implantation of activities. The UNDP TC Winston intervention was very positive in this sense with direct liaison with several Ministries:

- Ministry of Youth and Sport for youth-oriented clean-up in Koro;
- Ministry of Agriculture for clean-up of farming lands in Ra;
- Ministry of Environment and Local Government for the “Debris and Disaster Waste” chapter of the PDNA and ER framework;

- Ministry of Forestry for design and implementation of solutions for management of green debris (fallen trees), including training, etc.;
- Ministry of Rural and Maritime Development and National Disaster Management for direct coordination on the field (through District Officers, Rokos, etc.);
- Ministry of Employment linking of debris clearance with employment and livelihood opportunities (together with ILO).

Staff from the different ministries was very supportive on the ground and had a very important role in the success of the implementation. However, the multiplication of direct counterparts tended to create an overload in the coordination mechanism for the project, as well as a lack of visibility in the leadership from Government side on this debris/disaster waste thematic.

It would be highly recommendable if, at the early stage of a disaster (or even better before the disaster), Government was encouraged to create and activate a working group to coordinate Debris / Disaster Waste management activities, with a clear identification of the leading entity. Ministry of Rural and Maritime Development and National Disaster Management could be recommended as leading entity on the Government side, as their presence on the ground is essential for coordination and following up of activities on the ground (in particular in rural areas).

If there would be a "Disaster waste and debris management focal point" employee at UNDP, this could be the one setting up the contact with a governmental focal point to setup such task force.

3. Design and implementation of debris clearance program

a. Project design and preparation

- Prepare macro assessment of the debris / disaster waste situation in the first 2-3 weeks after the disaster (can be updated when more information gets available):
 - Areas affected (cities / rural areas);
 - Estimated quantities;
 - Estimated costs (full packages, cost per village, etc.);
 - Priorities of intervention (locations / specific issue);
 - Identify other actors planning similar/related intervention;
 - Identify gaps;
- Have maps available before the disaster, locating key information for design and monitoring of debris clearance in areas of interventions:
 - Land use (Agriculture/Forestry);
 - Housing; Rivers/roads/bridges (key infrastructures);
- Have activities packages ready beforehand (adapted from previous interventions);
- Include key supporting equipment for debris clearance (in particular for green debris) from the beginning in the project design/costing:
 - chainsaws; wood chipper;
- Discuss strategy to have a large-scale impact on priorities thematic in parallel to local/small scale interventions, including awareness at all levels of Governance:
 - how to avoid burning of dangerous materials in the first weeks of disaster;

- how to reuse available resources among debris to support livelihood recovery;
- Discuss final removal options from the beginning and consider different options for different types of debris (+ estimate costing of heavy equipment).

b. Implementation of activities

- Take decisions quickly about location (selection of villages) and strategy of intervention (equipment list, etc.); Start early on the process of procurement of key equipment needing to be imported (having standard list of equipment ready as well as identification of suppliers from previous interventions will help accelerating this process); Always associate delivery of equipment and tools (to Government, communities) with clear purpose, responsibility and arrangement for reporting / monitoring; Formalize lessons learnt after implementation.

c. CfW

- CfW shall not be presented/discussed as an activity *per se*, but as a mode of implementation of specific community activities (as debris clearance for example);
- Ensure that CfW is clearly identified as temporary solution for short term employment to inject cash into local economy and giving activities to affected people, but not as livelihood solution;
- Small communities in rural areas shall be given the choice between CfW or more equipment / community infrastructure;
- Many programs create misunderstandings on the criteria of participants (ex: Save the Children = 1 person per household);
- Re-think how to **have a better gender distribution among participants** in rural communities, in particular considering the difficulties of women to commit to 8 hours day work in parallel of their “domestic” activities, in particular in the first weeks/months following the disaster;
- Talk to women group before signing up to understand better the needs and demands of women situations, and how to integrate their input in the design of CfW program.

c. Connection to Livelihood and Recovery

- Recycling of debris (plastic, metal, etc.) is a very limited source of direct income in the specific context of small rural villages in island countries;
- The **connection of debris management with livelihood should concentrate on how to enable the re-use of debris** to support recovery of existing livelihoods, and possibly the “build-back better” of these livelihoods:
 - Re-use of construction debris to enable quick start of agriculture recovery and emergency constructions (in particular: corrugated iron for home gardening, emergency shelter, etc.);
 - Processing of green debris (fallen trees) giving input material for:
 - Reconstruction of houses and furniture (timber);
 - Establishment of best practice for agriculture (mulching, etc.) as alternative to burning to prevent erosion and enrich soils;
 - Connection to reforestation programs to recover and increase the tree resources lost during the cyclone (wood / crop trees).

4. MSB support

- Start earlier (if possible);
- UNDP focal point could enter in contact with MSB on early stage and have technical exchanges on a distance, for example to discuss the program design, etc. (possibility to prepare an administrative process for this kind of support);
- MSB: request key information to country office (preliminary assessments, UNDP portfolio, etc.) /
- UNDP: brief SURGE staff of key information about UNDP country office (portfolio, programs, projects, etc.)
- Continue with trainee program;
- Consider 6 month support, if funding available;
- Consider to send short term Communication / Information Specialist to document MSB works;
- Have packages ready from past disasters (activity packages / training material / etc.);
- Increase technical capacity for advising on solutions for wood / forestry processes (in particular at community level).

- [end]

Notes on initial crisis and recovery funding for Fiji

ANNEX H

Draft table showing approximate first US\$ 100 m international contribution (grants) to Fiji's TC Winston response. Concurs largely with ADB's analysis that 75% was tied– only 25% available for partners.

May 2016. Prior to release of concurrent ADB and World Bank US\$ 100 million total in loans.

Development Partner	Type of Assistance	Duration	In kind/tied (All US\$)	Cash / for projs (US\$)
European Union	Transport Humanitarian assist., planting materials	2016	4,800,000	
European Union	Agriculture and sugar industry support	2016-17	25,000,000	
Australia	Humanitarian Asst. Human resources. Relief supplies		12,000,000	
Australia	Repairs to 26 schools		770,000	
Australia	Recovery & reconstruction		10,000,000	5,000,000
Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF)	Various UN / Initiatives	2016		8,020,000
People's Republic of China	Tents, blankets, first aid kits, gens, water pur. Tablets		7,200,000	
People's Republic of China	Relief Grant			1,000,000
People's Republic of China	IFRC / FRC	2016		20,000
New Zealand	Hum. asst.; hum.res., surveys, relief sup.	2016	3,380,000	
New Zealand	Infrastructure. reconstruction	2016-17	4,900,000	2,000,000
Indonesia	Reconstruction support	2016	3,000,000	2,000,000
ADB	Relief Grant	2016		2,000,000
European Commission	Various organizations	2016		1,120,000
India	Relief Grant	2016		1,000,000
USA	Tech./Humanitarian Aid	2016	950,000	
Sweden	Tech./Humanitarian assistance	2016	840,000	
Solomon Islands	Relief grant	2016		620,000
Canada	For IFRC and UNICEF	2016		740,000
France	Aid in Kind	2016	210,000	
Vanuatu	Relief grant	2016		100,000
Samoa	Relief grant	2016		50,000
Germany	Aid in Kind	2016	110,000	
Japan	Tents, etc.	2016	170,000	
Republic of Korea	Humanitarian assistance	2016		50,000
Nauru	Relief grant	2016		70,000
Papua New Guinea	Humanitarian assistance	2016		20,000
		US\$	73,330,000	23,810,000
			75%	25%

Annex J. DRAFT table. Work in progress. Roughly compiled from various sources: Asian Development Bank, Fiji's Ministry of Finance (Economy) and Australia (DFAT). Some proportions the author's estimate.

The DRF itself is a light document of 24 pages including tables and clearly draws upon the PDNA. Presented are needs of FJ\$ 731 million (US\$ 340 million) prioritized within the PDNA's estimate of US\$ 1.3 billion of damage and losses.

RECOVERY PRIORITY	TOTAL BUDGET (FJ\$ million)	GOVERNMENT commitment (FJ\$ million)	DONOR (Committed to date) (FJ\$ m)	UNMET (Financing gap) (FJ\$ million)
1. Rebuilding homes	183.94	72.14	0	111.80
2. Restoring livelihoods	169.65	36.07	9.89	123.70
3. Repairing / strengthening critical infrastructure	353.39	25.79	12.04	315.57
4. Building resilience	23.88	0	0	23.88
All FJ\$ million	730.86	134.00	21.93	574.95
US\$ million Equiv.	340.00			

Extract from DRF Oct. 2016. Projected cost of recovery programmes by 'recovery priority' mid 2016-mid 2018.

What seems to be allocated in the 2016/2017 national budget of Fiji is FJ\$ 269 million for:

1. Rebuilding homes: FJ\$ 20 million
2. Restoring livelihoods: FJ\$ 43 million
3. Critical infrastructure: FJ\$ 206 million, in main part the reconstruction of many cyclone-affected schools, which could also serve as 'evacuation centres' during crisis when constructed to new, reinforced standards. In this regard Fiji is addressing recovery and preparedness.
4. Allocations for building resilience in the current budget are not apparent. These would include measures on disaster risk reduction and management, the voluntary relocation of villages and other efforts to adapt to climate change.

It is interesting to note that priorities two and four of the DRF relate directly to UNDP's potential capacity in livelihoods support and building resilience.
